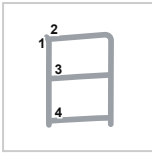
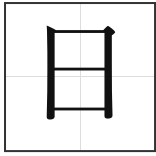


Kanji through 3rd grade

All 440 kanji taught in Japanese elementary school years 1–3, ordered by how often they appear in newspaper text — most common first. Numbers on each diagram give the stroke order. Tick them off as you learn to write them.

日 1	一 2	国 3	会 4	人 5	年 6	大 7	十 8	二 9	本 10	中 11	長 12	出 13	三 14	同 15	時 16
事 17	自 18	行 19	社 20	見 21	月 22	分 23	後 24	前 25	生 26	五 27	癸 28	間 29	対 30	上 31	部 32
東 33	者 34	地 35	合 36	市 37	業 38	内 39	相 40	方 41	四 42	定 43	今 44	回 45	新 46	場 47	金 48
員 49	九 50	入 51	立 52	開 53	手 54	米 55	力 56	学 57	問 58	高 59	代 60	明 61	実 62	円 63	決 64
子 65	動 66	京 67	全 68	目 69	表 70	通 71	外 72	言 73	理 74	調 75	体 76	化 77	田 78	当 79	八 80
六 81	主 82	題 83	下 84	首 85	意 86	来 87	作 88	用 89	度 90	強 91	気 92	小 93	七 94	期 95	公 96
持 97	野 98	取 99	都 100	和 101	平 102	山 103	思 104	家 105	話 106	世 107	受 108	区 109	多 110	県 111	進 112
正 113	安 114	数 115	記 116	院 117	女 118	北 119	午 120	指 121	心 122	界 123	第 124	百 125	点 126	教 127	書 128
活 129	原 130	先 131	名 132	交 133	予 134	川 135	向 136	勝 137	面 138	委 139	文 140	反 141	元 142	重 143	近 144
千 145	考 146	画 147	海 148	壳 149	組 150	知 151	道 152	集 153	物 154	引 155	使 156	所 157	次 158	水 159	半 160
品 161	計 162	死 163	係 164	感 165	投 166	打 167	男 168	始 169	島 170	直 171	両 172	朝 173	式 174	村 175	運 176
終 177	西 178	台 179	広 180	電 181	住 182	談 183	真 184	流 185	有 186	口 187	局 188	少 189	放 190	町 191	校 192
工 193	語 194	球 195	空 196	土 197	急 198	止 199	送 200	役 201	木 202	聞 203	身 204	切 205	由 206	転 207	食 208
車 209	研 210	何 211	南 212	石 213	足 214	消 215	神 216	番 217	配 218	算 219	宮 220	究 221	育 222	楽 223	起 224
万 225	着 226	乗 227	店 228	想 229	線 230	病 231	農 232	州 233	声 234	待 235	族 236	銀 237	助 238	早 239	親 240
追 241	商 242	葉 243	形 244	落 245	頭 246	毎 247	医 248	仕 249	去 250	味 251	負 252	門 253	写 254	守 255	美 256
命 257	福 258	整 259	横 260	白 261	深 262	字 263	答 264	夜 265	音 266	申 267	様 268	港 269	注 270	帰 271	谷 272
古 273	天 274	階 275	歌 276	買 277	光 278	路 279	悪 280	科 281	細 282	図 283	週 284	丸 285	他 286	室 287	太 288
橋 289	步 290	岸 291	客 292	風 293	紙 294	登 295	母 296	黒 297	火 298	戸 299	速 300	花 301	春 302	央 303	赤 304
号 305	青 306	竹 307	右 308	森 309	館 310	屋 311	読 312	根 313	色 314	友 315	苦 316	走 317	園 318	具 319	左 320
秋 321	馬 322	休 323	父 324	林 325	夏 326	鉄 327	顔 328	王 329	返 330	短 331	油 332	昭 333	植 334	宿 335	薬 336
習 337	船 338	倍 339	駅 340	玉 341	波 342	羽 343	洋 344	旅 345	級 346	幸 347	岩 348	練 349	軽 350	等 351	角 352
曲 353	庭 354	池 355	血 356	温 357	星 358	庫 359	坂 360	服 361	寺 362	息 363	遠 364	絵 365	夕 366	板 367	列 368
曜 369	遊 370	君 371	雨 372	弱 373	草 374	飲 375	肉 376	章 377	酒 378	悲 379	秒 380	晴 381	暗 382	鳥 383	勉 384
陽 385	冬 386	皮 387	里 388	齒 389	昼 390	茶 391	柱 392	祭 393	雪 394	筆 395	童 396	弟 397	畑 398	毛 399	緑 400
礼 401	詩 402	昔 403	牛 404	魚 405	兄 406	泳 407	荷 408	黄 409	雲 410	鳴 411	矢 412	炭 413	丁 414	犬 415	耳 416
湖 417	虫 418	湯 419	箱 420	豆 421	暑 422	妹 423	氷 424	寒 425	帳 426	姉 427	拾 428	漠 429	糸 430	才 431	麦 432
鼻 433	貝 434	刀 435	弓 436	皿 437	羊 438	笛 439	汽 440								



day / sun

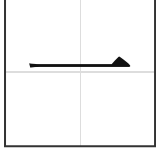
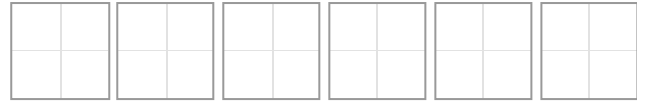
ON ニチ ジツ KUN ひ び か

A picture of the sun. The old form was a circle with a dot in the middle; the brush squared the circle off, and the dot became the line inside.

日 ひ day; sun

今日 きょう today

日本 にほん Japan



one

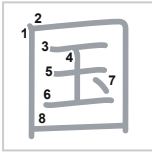
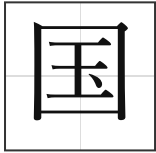
ON イチ イツ KUN ひと ひとつ

One finger laid flat on the table. One stroke, one thing — the simplest kanji there is.

一つ ひとつ one (thing)

一人 ひとり one person; alone

一番 いちばん number one; the most



country

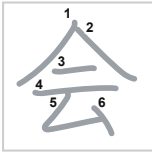
ON コク KUN くに

A jewel (玉) locked inside a border wall (口). A country is its treasure, kept safe inside its borders.

国 くに country

外国 がいこく foreign country

国会 こっかい the Diet (Japan's parliament)



meet / association

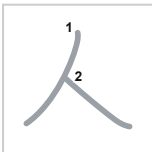
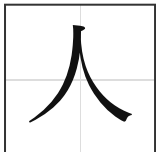
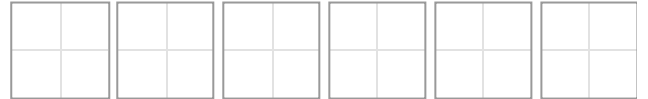
ON カイ エ KUN あ・う あ・わせる あつ・まる

People (人) gathering under one roof, with 云 (a cloud of chatter) underneath. A meeting.

会う あう to meet

会社 かいしゃ company

社会 しゃかい society



person

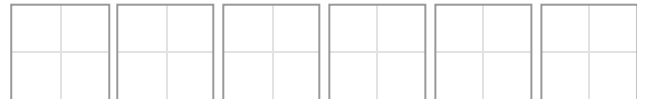
ON ジン ニン KUN ひと ひと

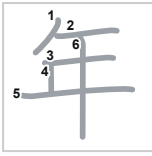
A person seen from the side, mid-stride — two legs walking.

人 ひと person

日本人 にほんじん Japanese person

二人 ふたり two people





year #6 G1 6 strokes

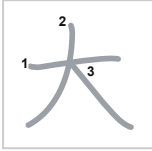
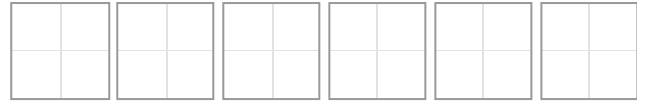
ON ネン KUN とし

A person carrying the harvested grain home on their back. One harvest = one year.

年 とし year; age

今年 ことし this year

去年 きょねん last year



big #7 G1 3 strokes

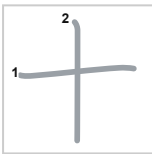
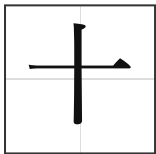
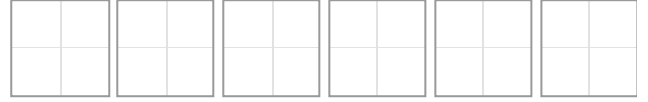
ON ダイ タイ KUN おお おお・きい おお・いに

A person (人) standing with both arms thrown out wide — "it was THIS big!"

大きい おおきい big; large

大学 だいがく university

大人 おとな adult



ten #8 G1 2 strokes

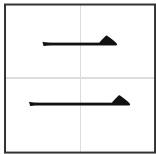
ON ジュウ ジツ ジュツ KUN とお と そ

Two hands crossed over each other — all ten fingers, complete.

十 じゅう ten

十日 とおか the 10th; ten days

十分 じゅうぶん enough; sufficient



two #9 G1 2 strokes

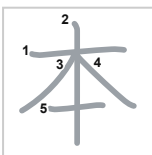
ON ニ ジ KUN ふた ふた・つ ふたたび

Two fingers laid flat, one above the other. Two strokes, two.

二つ ふたつ two (things)

二人 ふたり two people

二月 にがつ February



book / origin / main #10 G1 5 strokes

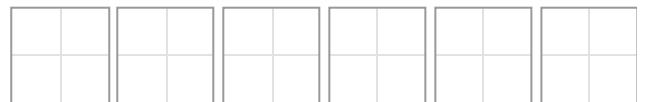
ON ホン KUN もと

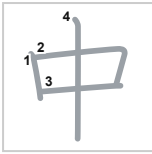
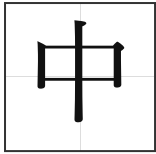
A tree (木) with a mark at its base — pointing at the ROOT, the origin. The paper for books comes from that same tree.

本 ほん book

日本 にほん Japan

本当 ほんとう true; really





middle / inside

#11 G1 4 strokes

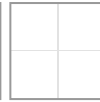
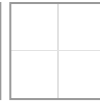
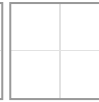
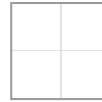
ON チュウ KUN なか うち あた・る

A line driven straight through the centre of a box — dead centre.

中 なか inside; middle

中学校 ちゅうがっこう junior high school

一日中 いちにちじゅう all day long



long / chief

#12 G2 8 strokes

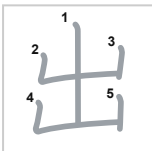
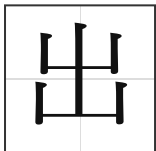
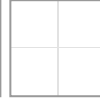
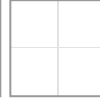
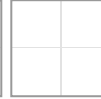
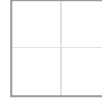
ON チョウ KUN なが・い おさ

An elder with long flowing hair leaning on a stick. Long hair, long life — and so, the leader.

長い ながい long

社長 しゃちょう company president

校長 こうちょう school principal



exit / go out

#13 G1 5 strokes

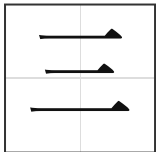
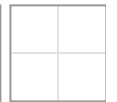
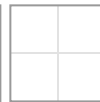
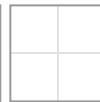
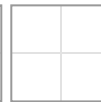
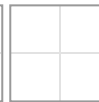
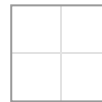
ON シュツ スイ KUN で・る で だ・す

One mountain (山) stacked on another — pushing UP and OUT of the ground.

出る 出る to go out; to leave

出す だす to take out; to submit

出口 でぐち exit



three

#14 G1 3 strokes

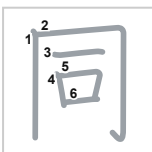
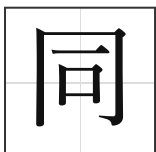
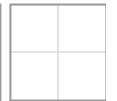
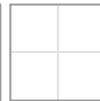
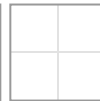
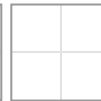
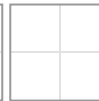
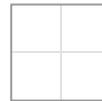
ON サン ゾウ KUN み み・つ みっ・つ

Three fingers laid flat, one above the other. Note the proportions when you write it: the middle stroke is the shortest and the bottom stroke the longest, so the character sits steady rather than toppling.

三つ みっつ three (things)

三人 さんにん three people

三月 さんがつ March



same

#15 G2 6 strokes

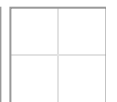
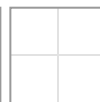
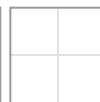
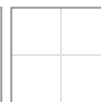
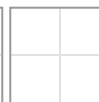
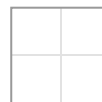
ON ドウ KUN おな・じ

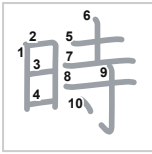
One (一) mouth (口) speaking from under the same roof (冂) — everyone saying the same thing.

同じ おなじ the same

同時 どうじ at the same time

同級生 どうきゅうせい classmate





time / hour

#16 G2 10 strokes

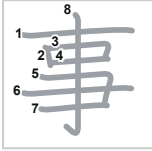
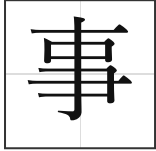
ON ジ KUN とし とき

The sun (日) over the temple (寺) — the temple bell marks the hour by the sun.

時 とき time; when

時間 じかん time; an hour

何時 なんじ what time



matter / thing

#17 G3 8 strokes

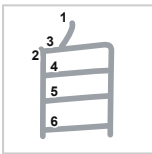
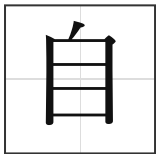
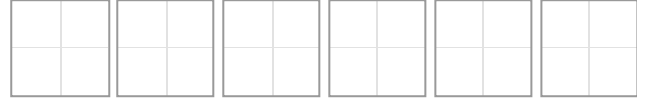
ON ジ ズ KUN こと つか・う つか・える

A hand (手) holding a brush straight down, recording the affairs of state. Business, matters, things.

事 こと thing; matter (abstract)

仕事 しごと work; job

食事 しょくじ meal



self

#18 G2 6 strokes

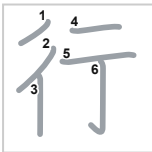
ON ジ シ KUN みずか・ら おの・ずから おの・ずと

Originally a drawing of a nose. In Japan people point at their own nose to mean "me".

自分 じぶん oneself; myself

自動車 じどうしゃ automobile

自由 じゆう freedom



go / line

#19 G2 6 strokes

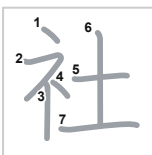
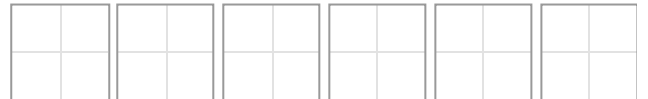
ON コウ ギョウ アン KUN い・く ゆ・く ゆ・き

A crossroads seen from above — the place where you GO one way or the other.

行く いく to go

銀行 ぎんこう bank

旅行 りょこう travel; trip



company / shrine

#20 G2 7 strokes

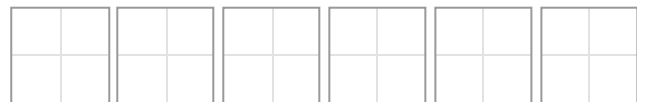
ON シャ KUN やしろ

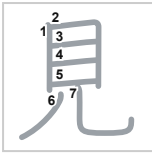
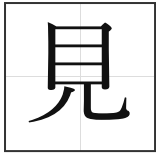
The altar radical (礷) beside earth (土) — a mound of sacred earth, a shrine. Companies grew out of these local associations.

会社 かいしゃ company

社会 しゃかい society

神社 じんじゃ Shinto shrine





see #21 G1 7 strokes

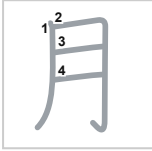
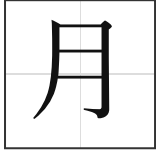
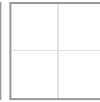
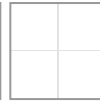
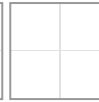
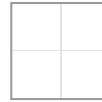
ON ケン KUN み・る み・える み・せる

A big eye (目) up on a pair of legs (儿) — an eye walking around, looking at everything.

見る みる to see; to watch

見せる みせる to show

意見 いけん opinion



month / moon #22 G1 4 strokes

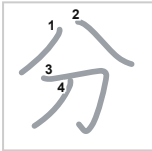
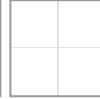
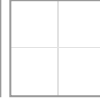
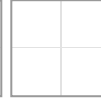
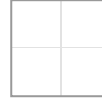
ON ゲツ ガツ KUN つき

A crescent moon on its side. One moon-cycle = one month.

月 つき moon

月曜日 げつようび Monday

今月 こんげつ this month



divide / minute / understand #23 G2 4 strokes

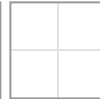
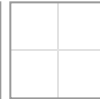
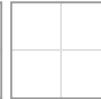
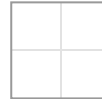
ON ブン フン ブ KUN わ・ける わ・け わ・かれる

A sword (刀) cutting something into eight (八) parts — dividing. Once it is divided up, you can understand it.

分かる わかる to understand

分ける わける to divide; to share out

五分 ごふん five minutes



after / behind #24 G2 9 strokes

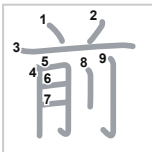
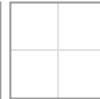
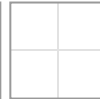
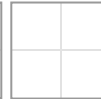
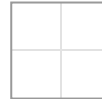
ON ゴ コウ KUN のち うし・ろ あと

Walking (イ) with a thread (纟) dragging behind slow feet (夊) — you fall BEHIND, you come AFTER.

後ろ うしろ behind; the back

午後 ごご afternoon; p.m.

後で あとで later



before / in front #25 G2 9 strokes

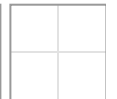
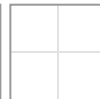
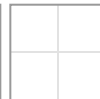
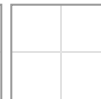
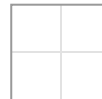
ON ゼン KUN まえ

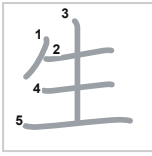
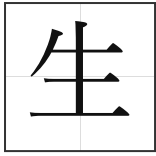
A knife (刂) trimming the meat (月) into eight (八) — you cut it BEFORE serving. What is cut goes out FRONT.

前 まえ in front; before

午前 げぜん morning; a.m.

名前 なまえ name





life / birth / raw

#26 G1 5 strokes

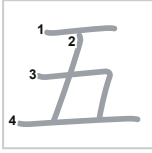
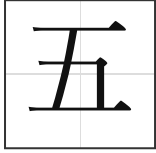
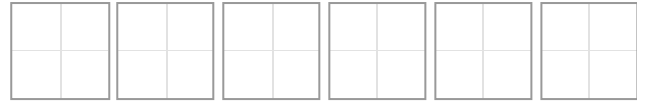
ON セイ ショウ KUN い・きる い・かす い・ける

A young plant pushing up out of the ground (土) — new life sprouting.

生まれる うまれる to be born

生きる いきる to live

先生 せんせい teacher



five

#27 G1 4 strokes

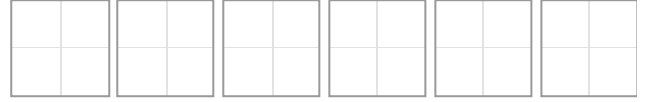
ON ゴ KUN いつ いつ・つ

An hourglass pinched between two lines — a hand with all five fingers folded in.

五つ いつつ five (things)

五人 ごにん five people

五月 ごがつ May



depart / emit

#28 G3 9 strokes

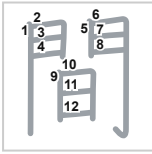
ON ハツ ホツ KUN た・つ あば・く おこ・る

Two feet stepping apart (𠂔) above a bow being loosed — the arrow is DISCHARGED and DEPARTS.

発表 はっぴよう announcement; presentation

出発 しゅっぱつ departure

発見 はっけん discovery



interval / between

#29 G2 12 strokes

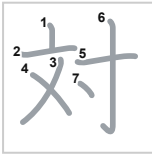
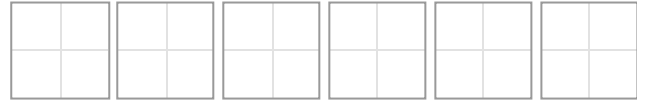
ON カン ケン KUN あいだ ま あい

The sun (日) shining through a gate (門) — the GAP between the two doors.

間 あいだ between; interval

時間 じかん time; hour

人間 にんげん human being



opposite / versus

#30 G3 7 strokes

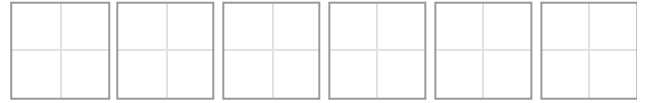
ON タイ ツイ KUN あいて こた・える そろ・い

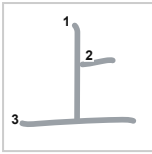
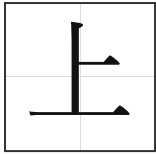
A text (文) and a hand (寸) facing each other across a table — two sides FACING off.

反対 はんたい opposition; the opposite

対する たいする to face; regarding

絶対 ぜったい absolutely





above / up

#31 G1 3 strokes

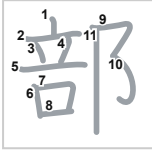
ON ジョウ ショウ シャン KUN うえ うわ かみ

A ground line with a mark standing UP above it. Write the tall vertical first, then the short right-hand tick, then the base line last — and remember it as the exact mirror of 下, which hangs its mark below the line instead.

上 うえ above; on top

上がる あがる to go up; to rise

上手 じょうず skilful; good at



section / department

#32 G3

11 strokes

ON ブ KUN ベ

A village (部) split into standing (立) mouths (口) — the town divided into DEPARTMENTS.

部屋 へや room

全部 ぜんぶ all; everything

部長 ぶちょう department head



east

#33 G2 8 strokes

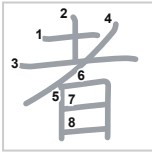
ON トウ KUN ひがし

The sun (日) caught in the branches of a tree (木) — sunrise seen through the trees is the EAST.

東 ひがし east

東京 とうきょう Tokyo

東口 ひがしぐち east exit



person (-er)

#34 G3 8 strokes

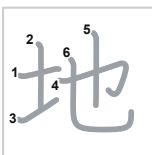
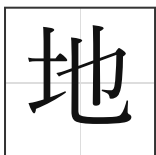
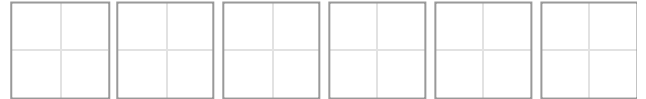
ON シャ KUN もの

An elder (者) speaking over the sun (日) — the one who does the telling. This is the "-er" on the end of a job.

者 もの person (formal/humble)

医者 いしゃ doctor

若者 わかもの young person



ground / earth

#35 G2 6 strokes

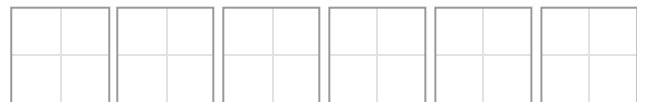
ON チ ジ KUN —

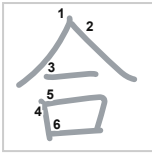
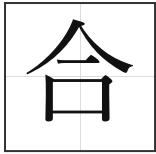
Earth (土) plus 也 — soil stretching out flat in every direction.

地図 ちず map

地下 ちか underground

地方 ちほう region; the provinces





fit / join

#36

G2

6 strokes

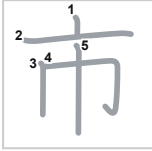
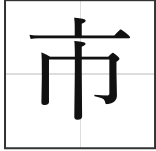
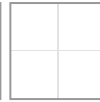
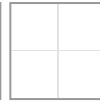
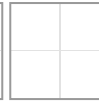
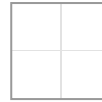
ON ゴウ ガッ カッ KUN あ・う あ・い あ・わす

A lid coming down neatly onto a pot (口) — it FITS perfectly.

合う あう to fit; to match

場合 ばあい case; situation

試合 しあい match; game



city / market

#37

G2

5 strokes

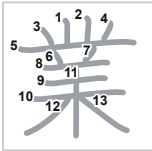
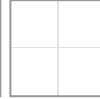
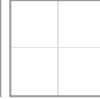
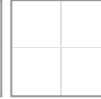
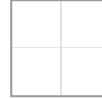
ON シ KUN いち

A cloth banner (巾) hanging under a lid — the flag over the marketplace, which grew into the CITY.

市 し city

市民 しみん citizen; resident

市役所 しやくしょ city hall



business / vocation

#38

G3

13 strokes

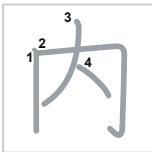
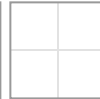
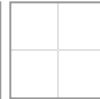
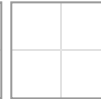
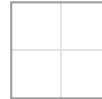
ON ギョウ ゴウ KUN わざ

A heavy wooden rack piled high with work — the craftsman's loaded bench. That is his TRADE.

授業 じゅぎょう class; lesson

卒業 そつぎょう graduation

産業 さんぎょう industry



inside

#39

G2

4 strokes

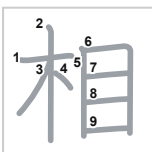
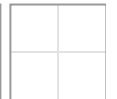
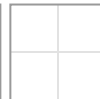
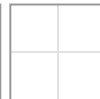
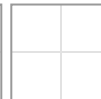
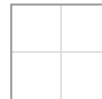
ON ナイ ダイ KUN うち

A person (人) tucked in under a roof (門) — safely INSIDE.

内 うち inside; within

案内 あんない guidance; showing around

国内 こくない domestic; within the country



mutual / minister

#40

G3

9 strokes

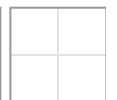
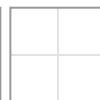
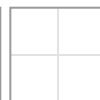
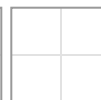
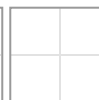
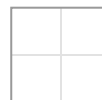
ON ソウ ショウ KUN あい

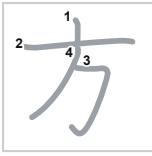
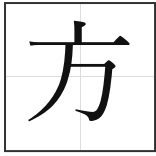
An eye (目) looking at a tree (木) — and the tree "looks" back. Two things facing EACH OTHER.

相手 あいて the other party; partner

相談 そうだん consultation; discussion

首相 しゅしょう prime minister





direction / person (polite)

#41

G2

4 strokes

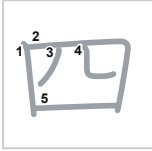
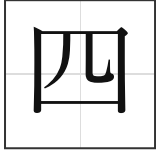
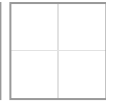
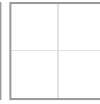
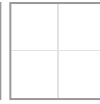
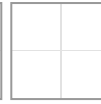
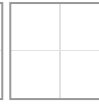
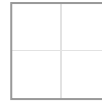
ON ホウ KUN かた がた

A plough turning at the end of a furrow — it points the way. The DIRECTION you turn.

方 かた person (polite); way of doing

方法 ほうほう method; way

夕方 ゆうがた evening



four

#42

G1

5 strokes

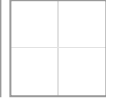
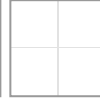
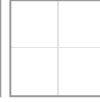
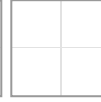
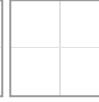
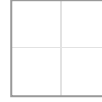
ON シ KUN よ よ・つ よっ・つ

A mouth (口) with two legs hanging inside — four was too many strokes to draw, so they boxed it in.

四つ よっつ four (things)

四人 よにん four people

四月 しがつ April



determine / fix

#43

G3

8 strokes

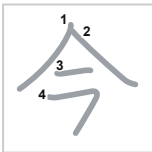
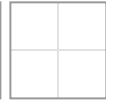
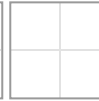
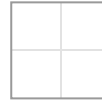
ON テイ ジョウ KUN さだ・める さだ・まる
さだ・か

Under a roof (宀) a foot comes to rest — you stop wandering and SETTLE the matter.

定める さだめる to lay down; to establish

予定 よてい plan; schedule

決定 けってい decision



now

#44

G2

4 strokes

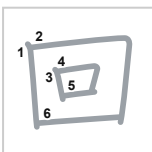
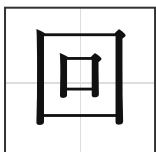
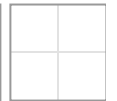
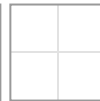
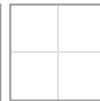
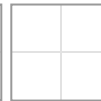
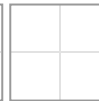
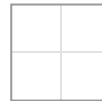
ON コン キン KUN いま

A roof over a single mark — this very moment, caught and held under cover.

今 いま now

今度 こんど next time; this time

今週 こんしゅう this week



times / revolve

#45

G2

6 strokes

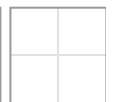
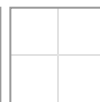
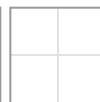
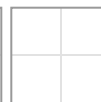
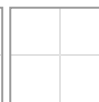
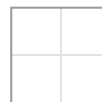
ON カイ エ KUN まわ・る まわ・り まわ・す

A box inside a box, spiralling inward — going round and round.

回る まわる to turn; to go around

一回 いったい once; one time

今回 こんかい this time





new #46 G2 13 strokes

ON シン KUN あたら・しい あら・た あら

An axe (斤) cutting a standing (立) tree (木) — freshly cut timber is NEW wood.

新しい あたらしい new

新聞 しんぶん newspaper

新年 しんねん the New Year



place #47 G2 12 strokes

ON ジョウ チョウ KUN ば

Earth (土) where the sun (日) beats down on open ground — a wide, flat PLACE.

場所 ばしょ place; location

会場 かいじょう venue

工場 こうじょう factory



gold / money #48 G1 8 strokes

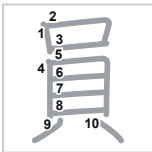
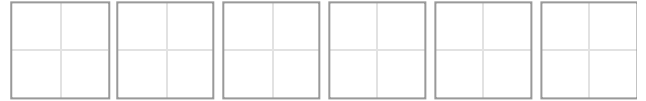
ON キン コン ゴン KUN かね かな がね

A roof over the earth with two nuggets buried underneath — metal in the ground. Gold, and so money.

お金 おかね money

金曜日 きんようび Friday

金 きん gold



member / staff #49 G3 10 strokes

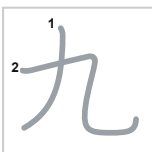
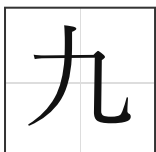
ON イン KUN —

A mouth (口) above a shell of money (貝) — one more mouth on the payroll. A member of staff.

会社員 かいしゃいん company employee

店員 てんいん shop assistant

全員 ぜんいん everyone; all members



nine #50 G1 2 strokes

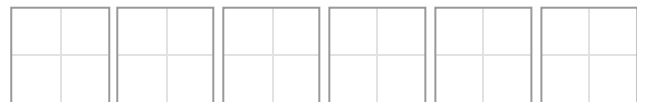
ON キュウ ク KUN ここの ここの・つ

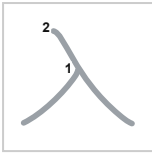
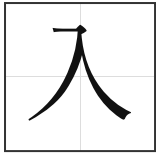
A bent elbow — nine is one short of ten, so the arm is still crooked.

九つ ここのつ nine (things)

九月 くがつ September

九日 ここのか the 9th; nine days





enter #51 G1 2 strokes

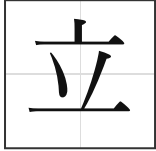
ON ニュウ ジュ KUN い・る い・り い・れる

An arrow-head pointing down into an opening — going IN. (Compare 人: 入 has the left stroke on top.)

入る はいる to enter

入れる いれる to put in

入口 いりぐち entrance



stand #52 G1 5 strokes

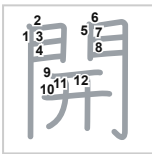
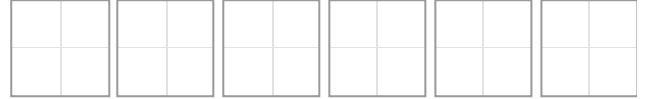
ON リツ リュウ リットル KUN た・つ た・ち た・てる

A person standing on the ground line, feet planted apart.

立つ たつ to stand

立てる たてる to stand (sth) up; to make (a plan)

国立 こくりつ national (state-run)



open #53 G3 12 strokes

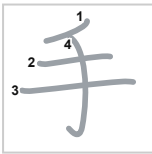
ON カイ KUN ひら・く ひら・き びら・き

Two hands lifting the bar off a gate (門) — swinging it OPEN.

開ける あける to open (sth)

開く ひらく to open; to hold (an event)

開始 かいし start; commencement



hand #54 G1 4 strokes

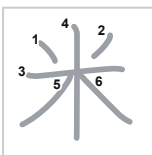
ON シュ ズ KUN て た

A hand with the fingers and wrist drawn in — the long hook is the arm.

手 て hand

手紙 てがみ letter

切手 きって postage stamp



rice / America #55 G2 6 strokes

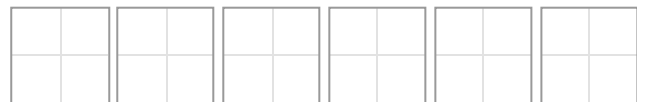
ON ベイ マイ メエトル KUN こめ よね

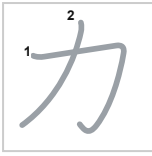
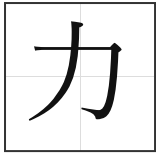
Grains of rice scattered off the stalk in all four directions.

米 こめ uncooked rice

米国 べいこく the United States

新米 しんまい new-crop rice; a novice





power / strength #56 G1 2 strokes

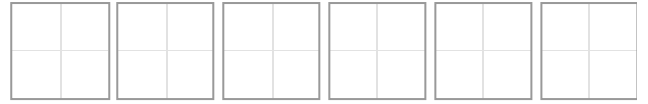
ON リョク リキ リイ KUN ちから

A flexed arm with the muscle bulging — or a plough biting the earth. Raw STRENGTH.

力 ちから strength; power

体力 たいりよく physical strength; stamina

協力 きょうりよく cooperation



study / learning #57 G1 8 strokes

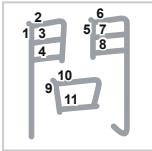
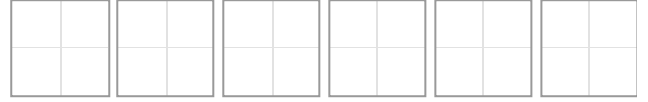
ON ガク KUN まな・ぶ

A child (子) under a roof with knowledge sprinkled on top — a child at school.

学ぶ まなぶ to learn; to study

学校 がっこう school

科学 かがく science



question / ask #58 G3 11 strokes

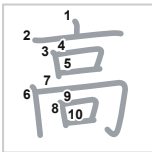
ON モン KUN と・う と・い とん

A mouth (口) at the gate (門) — knocking and ASKING to be let in.

問う とう to ask; to question

問題 もんだい problem; question

質問 しつもん question



tall / expensive #59 G2 10 strokes

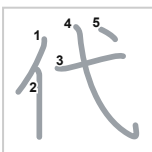
ON コウ KUN たか・い たか だか

A tall watchtower with a roof, a window, and a gate below — a HIGH building.

高い たかい tall; high; expensive

高校 こうこう high school

最高 さいこう the best; the highest



substitute / generation #60 G3

5 strokes

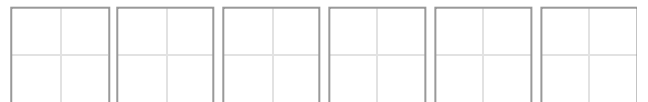
ON ダイ タイ KUN か・わる かわ・り がわ・り

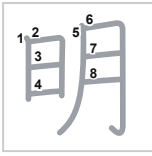
A person (イ) taking someone else's stake (代) — stepping in to REPLACE them.

代わる かわる to take the place of

代表 だいひょう representative

現代 げんだい the present day; modern





bright / clear

#61 G2 8 strokes

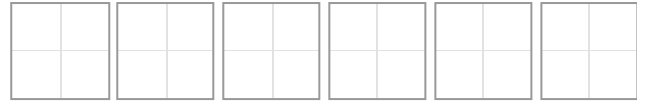
ON メイ ミョウ ミン KUN あ・かり あか・る
い あか・るむ

The sun (日) and the moon (月) side by side — the two
brightest things there are.

明るい あかるい bright; cheerful

説明 せつめい explanation

明日 あした tomorrow



reality / fruit

#62 G3 8 strokes

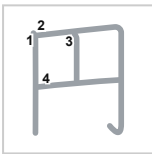
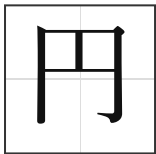
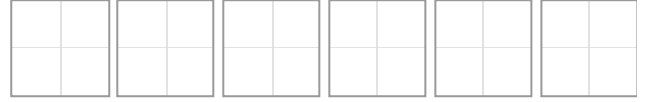
ON ジツ シツ KUN み みの・る まこと

Under a roof (宀), the harvest hangs heavy — the real
FRUIT of the year. What is actually there.

実は じつは actually; to tell the truth

事実 じじつ fact

実行 じっこう putting into practice



circle / yen

#63 G1 4 strokes

ON エン KUN まる・い まる まど

A round enclosure with a line inside — a coin. Japan's
money is literally "the round thing".

円 えん yen

千円 せんえん 1,000 yen

円い まるい round



decide

#64 G3 7 strokes

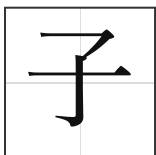
ON ケツ KUN き・める ぎ・め き・まる

Water (氵) bursting through a dam — once the bank
breaks the matter is SETTLED, no going back.

決める きめる to decide

決まる きまる to be decided

解決 かいけつ solution; resolution



child

#65 G1 3 strokes

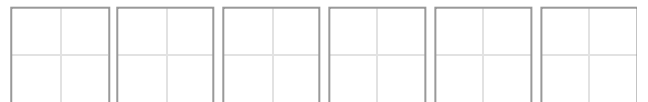
ON シ ス ツ KUN こ ね

A baby in swaddling clothes, arms out, legs wrapped
together.

子ども こども child

男の子 おとこのこ boy

女の子 おんなのこ girl



動

1 11
2 7
3 4 5 6
8
9 10

move #66 G3 11 strokes

ON ドウ KUN うご・く うご・かす

Something heavy (重) plus strength (力) — put your back into it and it MOVES.

動く うごく to move

動物 どうぶつ animal

運動 うんどう exercise; movement

京

1
2 4
3 5
7 6 8

capital #67 G2 8 strokes

ON キョウ ケイ キン KUN みやこ

A tall gate-tower standing over the city — the grandest building, in the CAPITAL.

東京 とうきょう Tokyo

京都 きょうと Kyoto

上京 じょうきょう going up to Tokyo

全

1 2
3 4
5 6

whole / all #68 G3 6 strokes

ON ゼン KUN まった・く すべ・て

A king (王) under one roof (人) — everything he owns, the WHOLE lot, gathered in.

全部 ぜんぶ all; everything

全然 ぜんぜん not at all

安全 あんぜん safety

目

1 2
3
4
5

eye #69 G1 5 strokes

ON モク ボク KUN め ま

An eye stood on its end — the two lines inside are the pupil and lid.

目 め eye

目的 もくてき purpose; aim

目立つ めだつ to stand out

表

1 2
3
4 5 8 7
6

surface / express / table #70 G3

8 strokes

ON ヒョウ KUN おもて あらわ・す あらわ・れる

A robe (衣) with the pattern showing on the OUTSIDE — the face it shows the world.

表 おもて the front; the surface

表す あらわす to express; to represent

表現 ひょうげん expression

通

10 strokes

pass through / commute

#71

G2

10 strokes

ON ツウ ツ KUN とお・る とお・り どお・り

A road (い) running straight through — traffic PASSING along it.

通る とおる to pass through

通う かよう to commute; to attend regularly

交通 こうつう traffic; transport

外

5 strokes

outside

#72

G2

5 strokes

ON ガイ ゲ KUN そと ほか はず・す

Evening (夕) plus a fortune stick (卜) — telling fortunes after dark, out beyond the walls.

外 そと outside

海外 かいがい overseas

以外 いがい except for; other than

言

7 strokes

say / word

#73

G2

7 strokes

ON ゲン ゴン KUN い・う こと

A mouth (口) with sound waves rising out of it in lines — speech made visible.

言う いう to say

言葉 ことば word; language

方言 ほうげん dialect

理

11 strokes

logic / reason

#74

G2

11 strokes

ON リ KUN ことわり

A jewel (王) being polished along the grain of the field (里) — following the natural LOGIC of the thing.

理由 りゆう reason

料理 りょうり cooking; dish

無理 むり impossible; unreasonable

調

15 strokes

investigate / tune

#75

G3

15 strokes

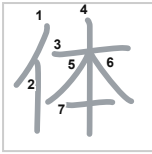
ON チョウ KUN しら・べる しら・べ ととの・う

Words (言) going all the way round (周) a thing — checking it from every side.

調べる しらべる to look up; to investigate

調子 ちょうし condition; tone

体調 たいちょう physical condition



body #76 G2 7 strokes

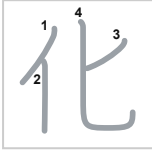
ON タイ テイ KUN からだ かたち

A person (イ) plus their root/origin (本) — the BODY is the base a person stands on.

体 からだ body

体育 たいいく physical education

大体 だいたい roughly; generally



change / transform #77 G3 4 strokes

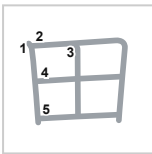
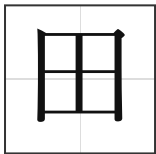
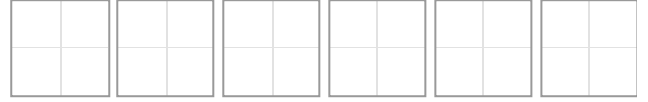
ON カ ケ KUN ば・ける ば・かす ふ・ける

A person standing (イ) beside a person bent over (匕) — the same person, TRANSFORMED.

文化 ぶんか culture

変化 へんか change

化ける ばける to transform; to disguise oneself



rice field #78 G1 5 strokes

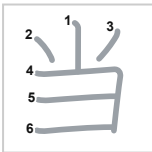
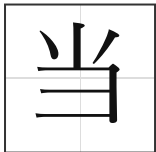
ON デン KUN た

A paddy seen from above — a square field divided into four plots by its irrigation paths.

田 た rice field

田んぼ たんぼ rice paddy

田舎 いなか the countryside; one's home town



hit / appropriate #79 G2 6 strokes

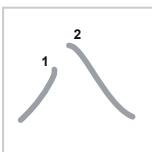
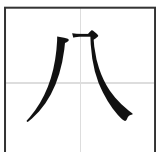
ON トウ KUN あ・たる あ・たり あ・てる

A small (丶) hand (扌) reaching out and landing right on the mark — a direct HIT.

当たる あたる to hit; to be correct

弁当 べんとう boxed lunch

当然 とうぜん naturally; of course



eight #80 G1 2 strokes

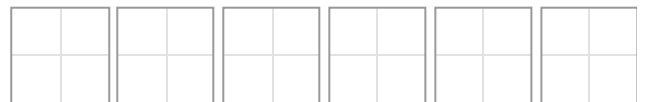
ON ハチ ハツ KUN や や・つ やっ・つ

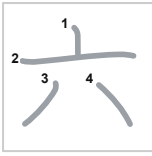
Two strokes splitting apart — eight is the number that divides and divides again.

八つ やっつ eight (things)

八月 はちがつ August

八日 ようか the 8th; eight days





six #81 G1 4 strokes

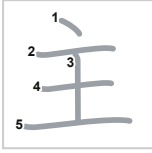
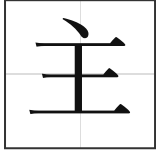
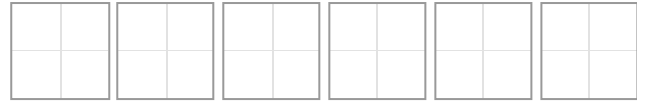
ON ロク リク KUN む む・つ むっ・つ

A little hut with a roof and two legs — six is the shape you can stand up.

六つ むっつ six (things)

六月 ろくがつ June

六日 むいか the 6th; six days



master / main #82 G3 5 strokes

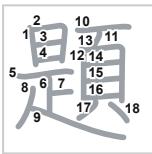
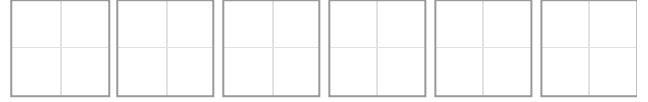
ON シュ ス シュウ KUN ぬし おも あるじ

A lamp burning on a stand — the one steady flame the whole household gathers round. The MASTER.

主人 しゅじん husband; master of the house

主に おもに mainly

主張 しゅちょう assertion; claim



topic / title #83 G3 18 strokes

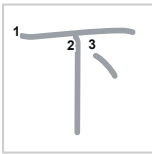
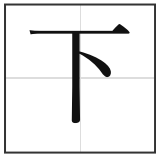
ON タイ KUN —

A head (頁) turned toward what is correct (是) — the heading at the top of the page. The TOPIC.

問題 もんだい problem; question

宿題 しゅくだい homework

話題 わだい topic of conversation



below / down #84 G1 3 strokes

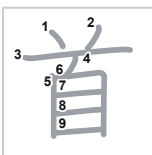
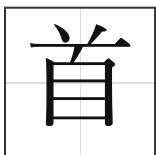
ON カ ゲ KUN した しも もと

A mark hanging DOWN below the ground line — the exact mirror of 上.

下 した below; under

下がる さがる to go down; to fall

以下 いか below; less than



neck / head #85 G2 9 strokes

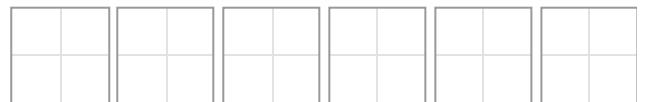
ON シュ KUN くび

Hair above an eye (目) — the head, and the NECK that carries it.

首 くび neck

首都 しゅと capital city

首相 しゅしょう prime minister



意

意

idea / mind

#86

G3

13 strokes

ON イ KUN —

A sound (音) rising from the heart (心) — what the heart is trying to say. Your MEANING, your intent.

意味 いみ meaning

注意 ちゅうい caution; attention

用意 ようい preparation

来

来

come

#87

G2

7 strokes

ON ライ タイ KUN く・る きた・る きた・す

A wheat plant with grain hanging down — the harvest that COMES to you at the end of the year.

来る くる to come

来週 らいしゅう next week

出来る できる to be able to; to be made

作

作

make

#88

G2

7 strokes

ON サク サ KUN つく・る つく・り づく・り

A person (イ) with a saw cutting notches — a craftsman MAKING something.

作る つくる to make

作品 さくひん a work (of art)

作文 さくぶん composition; essay

用

用

use / business

#89

G2

5 strokes

ON ヨウ KUN もち・いる

A wooden bucket with its slats and handle — a plain tool you USE every day.

用いる もちいる to use; to employ

使用 しょう use; employment

利用 りょう utilisation; making use of

度

度

degree / occurrence

#90

G3

9 strokes

ON ド ト タク KUN たび た・い

Under a shelter (广), a hand measuring off a span — marking DEGREES on a scale.

一度 いちど once; one time

温度 おんど temperature

態度 たいど attitude

強

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11

strong #91 G2 11 strokes

ON キョウ ゴウ KUN つよ・い つよ・まる つよ・める

A bow (弓) with an insect (虫) — even a beetle is armoured and STRONG for its size.

強い つよい strong

勉強 べんきょう study

強力 きょうりよく powerful

気

1 2 3 4 5 6

spirit / air / mood #92 G1 6 strokes

ON キ ケ KUN いき き

Steam curling up off cooking rice — invisible energy in the AIR. Mood, spirit, weather.

元気 げんき healthy; lively

天気 てんき weather

気持ち きもち feeling

小

1 2 3

small #93 G1 3 strokes

ON ショウ KUN ちい・さい こ お

One thing split by two tiny slivers falling away — cut small, and smaller.

小さい ちいさい small

小学校 しょうがっこう elementary school

小学生 しょうがくせい elementary school pupil

七

1 2

seven #94 G1 2 strokes

ON シチ KUN なな なな・つ なの

A cross with a hooked tail — a knife cutting; seven is what is left after the cut.

七つ ななつ seven (things)

七月 しちがつ July

七日 なのか the 7th; seven days

期

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12

period / term #95 G3 12 strokes

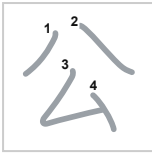
ON キ ゴ KUN —

The moon (月) coming round to the same place again — one full cycle. A fixed PERIOD.

期間 きかん period; term

学期 がっき school term

期待 きたい expectation; hope



public / official

#96

G2

4 strokes

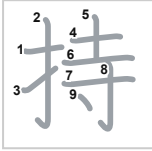
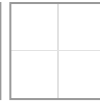
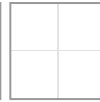
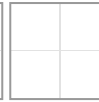
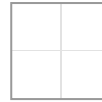
ON コウ ク KUN おおやけ

Something private (厶) being split open (八) — once it is opened up to everyone, it is PUBLIC.

公園 こうえん park

公務員 こうむいん public servant

公共 こうきょう public; communal



hold / have

#97

G3

9 strokes

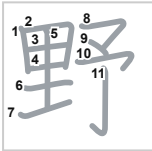
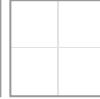
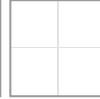
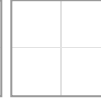
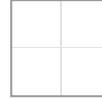
ON ジ KUN も・つ も・ち も・てる

A hand (扌) at the temple (寺) — holding the offering steady. To HOLD, to carry.

持つ もつ to hold; to have

持ち物 もちもの belongings

金持ち かねもち a rich person



field / plain

#98

G2

11 strokes

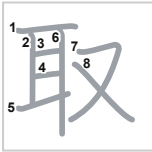
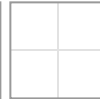
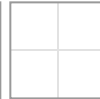
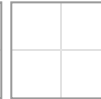
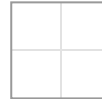
ON ヤ ショ KUN の

A village field (里) stretching out ahead (予) — open, wild country.

野菜 やさい vegetables

野球 やきゅう baseball

分野 ぶんや field; area of study



take

#99

G3

8 strokes

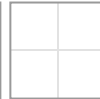
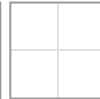
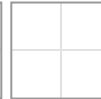
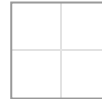
ON シュ KUN と・る と・り ど・り

A hand (又) grabbing an ear (耳) — in old wars you TOOK the ear as proof. Grim, but unforgettable.

取る とる to take

受け取る うけとる to receive; to accept

取引 とりひき transaction; business deal



metropolis / capital

#100

G3

11 strokes

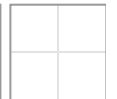
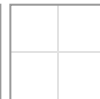
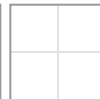
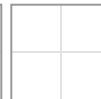
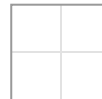
ON ト ツ KUN みやこ

A village (阝) full of people (者) — so many that it becomes the CAPITAL.

都市 とし city

都会 とかい the city; urban area

都道府県 とどうふけん prefectures of Japan





harmony / Japanese-style #101 G3

8 strokes

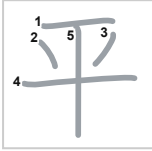
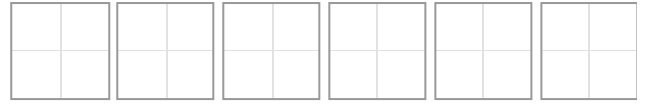
ON ワ オ カ KUN やわ・らぐ やわ・らげる
なご・む

Grain (禾) shared out to every mouth (口) — everyone fed, everyone at peace. HARMONY.

平和 へいわ peace

和食 わしょく Japanese cuisine

昭和 しょうわ the Showa era (1926-1989)



flat / even / peace #102 G3 5 strokes

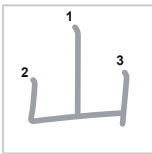
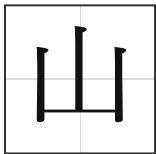
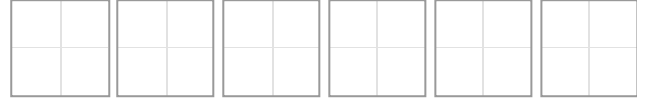
ON ヘイ ビョウ ヒョウ KUN たい・ら たい・らげる ひら

A balance beam hanging perfectly level — nothing tips. FLAT, even, peaceful.

平日 へいじつ weekday

平気 へいき unconcerned; fine

平ら たいら flat; level



mountain #103 G1 3 strokes

ON サン セン KUN やま

Three peaks rising from a ridge — a mountain range drawn in three strokes.

山 やま mountain

火山 かざん volcano

富士山 ふじさん Mount Fuji



think #104 G2 9 strokes

ON シ KUN おも・う おもえら・く おぼ・す

The brain (田, the skull's grid) sitting on the heart (心) — head and heart together. THINKING.

思う おもう to think; to feel

思い出す おもいだす to recall

不思議 ふしぎ strange; mysterious



house / family #105 G2 10 strokes

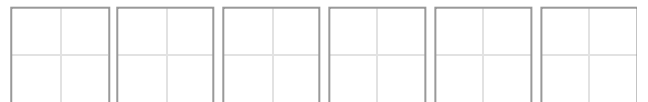
ON カ ケ KUN いえ や うち

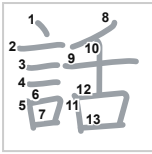
A pig (豕) under the roof (宀) — in old China the family pig lived in the house. That was a HOME.

家 いえ house; home

家族 かぞく family

家庭 かてい household; home life





talk / story

#106 G2 13 strokes

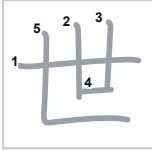
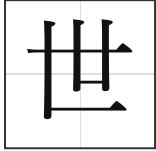
ON ワ KUN はな・す はなし

Words (言) coming off the tongue (舌) — TALKING.

話す はなす to speak

話 はなし story; talk

電話 でんわ telephone



generation / world

#107 G3 5 strokes

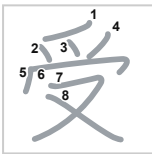
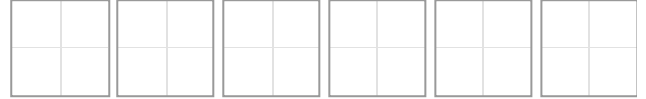
ON セイ セ ソウ KUN よ

Three tens (十) joined along one line — thirty years, one GENERATION.

世界 せかい the world

世の中 よのなか society; the world

世紀 せいき century



receive

#108 G3 8 strokes

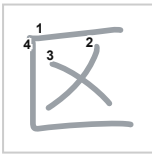
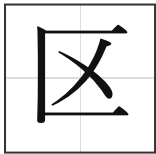
ON ジュ KUN う・ける う・け う・かる

A hand reaching down (𠂇) and a hand reaching up (又), with a table between — passing something over. RECEIVING.

受ける うける to receive; to take (an exam)

受付 うけつけ reception desk

受験 じゅけん taking an examination



ward / district

#109 G3 4 strokes

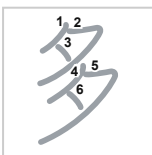
ON ク オウ コウ KUN —

Things sorted inside a box (匚) — the city chopped up into WARDS.

区 く ward (city district)

区役所 くやくしょ ward office

地区 ちく district; area



many

#110 G2 6 strokes

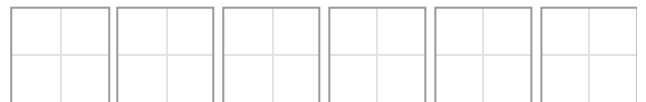
ON タ KUN おお・い まさ・に まさ・る

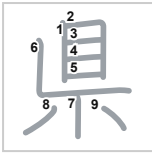
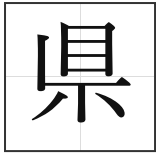
Two evenings (夕) stacked up — one evening after another after another. They add up to MANY.

多い おおい many; numerous

多分 たぶん probably; perhaps

多く おおく much; many; most





prefecture

#111

G3

9 strokes

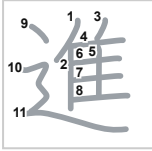
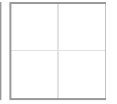
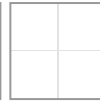
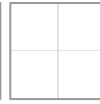
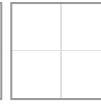
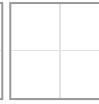
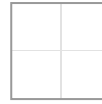
ON ケン KUN か・ける

An eye (目) watching over a small (小) region — the province the governor keeps an eye on.

県 けん prefecture

県庁 けんちょう prefectural office

県立 けんりつ prefectural (run by the prefecture)



advance

#112

G3

11 strokes

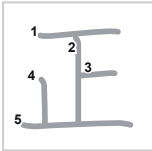
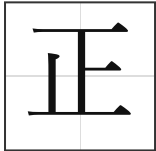
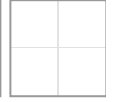
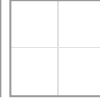
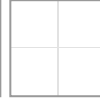
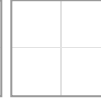
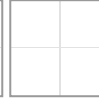
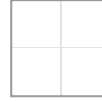
ON シン KUN すす・む すす・める

A bird (佳) on the road (辶) — birds only ever hop FORWARD, never back.

進む すすむ to advance; to proceed

進める すすめる to push forward

進歩 しんぽ progress



correct / righteous

#113

G1

5 strokes

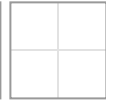
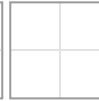
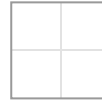
ON セイ ショウ KUN ただ・しい ただ・す まさ

A foot (止) stopping exactly on the line (一) — right on the mark. CORRECT.

正しい ただしい correct; right

正月 しょうがつ New Year

正解 せいかい correct answer



cheap / peaceful

#114

G3

6 strokes

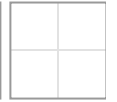
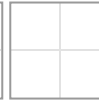
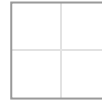
ON アン KUN やす・い やす・まる やす

A woman (女) at rest under the roof (宀) — the house is calm, and life is CHEAP and easy.

安い やすい cheap

安心 あんしん relief; peace of mind

不安 ふあん anxiety; uneasiness



number / count

#115

G2

13 strokes

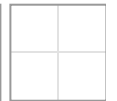
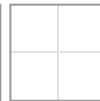
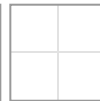
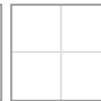
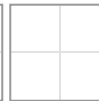
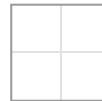
ON スウ ス サク KUN かず かぞ・える しばしば

A woman (女) with rice (米) and a stick (攴) — tallying up the grain, one stroke at a time. COUNTING.

数 かず number; quantity

数える かぞえる to count

数字 すうじ numeral; figure



記

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
記

write down / record

#116

G2

10 strokes

ON キ KUN しる・す

Words (言) tied to oneself (己) — writing it down so it stays yours. A RECORD.

日記 にっき diary

記録 きろく record

記念 きねん commemoration; memorial

院

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
院

institution / house (of parliament)

#117

G3

10 strokes

ON イン KUN —

A walled compound (𡩿) that is complete (完) in itself — a hospital, a temple, a chamber of parliament.

病院 びょういん hospital

入院 にゅういん being admitted to hospital

大学院 だいがくいん graduate school

女

1 2 3
女

woman

#118

G1

3 strokes

ON ジョ ニョ ニョウ KUN おんな め

A figure kneeling with arms crossed in her lap — the old pictograph of a woman.

女 おんな woman

女性 じょせい woman; female

彼女 かのじょ she; girlfriend

北

1 2 3 4 5
北

north

#119

G2

5 strokes

ON ホク KUN きた

Two people standing back to back — turning your back on the cold. That way is NORTH.

北 きた north

北海道 ほっかいどう Hokkaido

北口 きたぐち north exit

午

1 2 3 4
午

noon

#120

G2

4 strokes

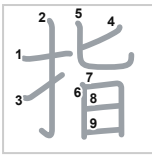
ON ゴ KUN うま

A pestle standing straight up — at noon the sun casts no shadow, straight overhead.

午前 ごぜん morning; a.m.

午後 ごご afternoon; p.m.

正午 しょうご noon



finger / point at #121 G3 9 strokes

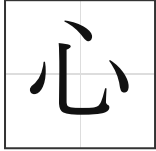
ON シ KUN ゆび さ・す さ・し

The hand radical 扌 beside 旨, a spoon 匕 over the sun 日 — the hand reaches out and its finger points at what it wants a taste of.

指 ゆび finger

指す さす to point at

指定 してい designation; specifying



heart / mind #122 G2 4 strokes

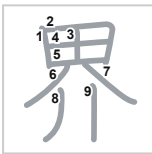
ON シン KUN こころ ごころ

A picture of the organ itself: the curved bowl of the muscle with three drops of blood flicking off it. Write the hook first, then the three strokes around it.

心 こころ heart; mind

心配 しんぱい worry

安心 あんしん relief; peace of mind



world / boundary #123 G3 9 strokes

ON カイ KUN —

A rice field 田 sitting on 介, a person 人 wedged between two strokes — the man standing in the gap that divides one field from the next. A boundary, and so a world.

世界 せかい the world

世界中 せかいじゅう all over the world

業界 ぎょうかい industry; the trade



number (prefix) #124 G3 11 strokes

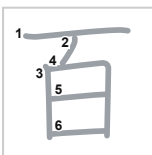
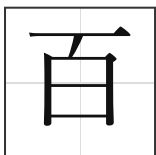
ON ダイ テイ KUN —

Bamboo 竹 laid over 弔, a bow 弓 bound with cord — bamboo grows one joint after another, and the cord is wound round in order. 第 marks a thing's number in the sequence.

第一 だいいち first; number one

第二 だいに second

次第 しだい as soon as; depending on



hundred #125 G1 6 strokes

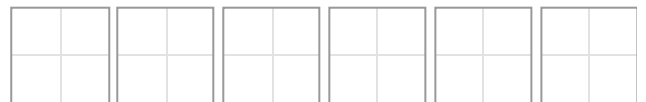
ON ヒャク ビャク KUN もも

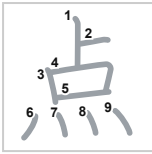
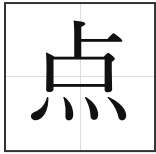
One — stroke laid on the head of 白, white — add a single mark to the white and the count jumps to a hundred. Write 一, then 白 underneath.

百 ひゃく hundred

百円 ひゃくえん a hundred yen

何百 なんびゃく hundreds of





point / dot

#126 G2 9 strokes

ON テン KUN つ・ける つ・く た・てる

占, a fortune-teller reading the crack ト and speaking it with the mouth 口, standing on the four fire dots 火 — sparks speckling the dark. Each speck is a point.

点 てん dot; point

点数 てんすう score; marks

交差点 こうさてん intersection



teach / doctrine

#127 G2 11 strokes

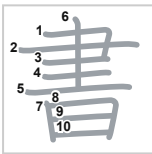
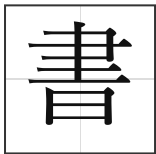
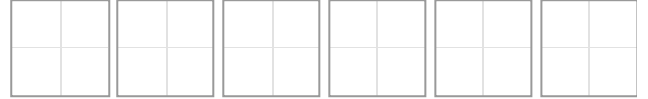
ON キョウ KUN おし・える おそ・わる

孝, an elder 孝 bending over a child 子, next to 父, a hand holding a switch — the old picture of teaching: the generations and the stick.

教える おしえる to teach; to tell

教室 きょうしつ classroom

教育 きょういく education



write / document

#128 G2 10 strokes

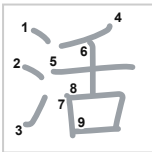
ON ショ KUN か・く が・き

聿, a hand gripping an upright brush, coming down onto 日, the tablet below — brush meets surface and the writing happens. Draw the brush and its three crossbars first, then 日.

書く かく to write

書類 しよるい documents; paperwork

辞書 じしょ dictionary



lively / living

#129 G2 9 strokes

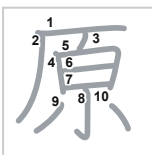
ON カツ KUN い・きる い・かす い・ける

Water 氵 beside a tongue 舌 — a tongue still wet is a tongue still moving, and the creature is alive.

生活 せいかつ daily life; living

活動 かつどう activity

活用 かつよう putting to use



origin / plain

#130 G2 10 strokes

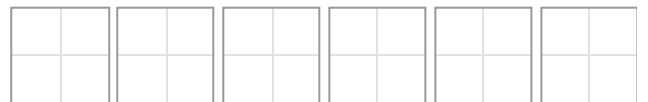
ON ゲン KUN はら

A cliff 厩 with a spring under it — 白 for the pool and 小 for the water running away. The spring at the foot of the cliff is where the river originates, and the plain it waters is the field.

原因 げんいん cause

原則 げんそく principle; as a rule

野原 のはら field; open plain



先

1 3
2
4 5 6

ahead / previous

#131

G1

6 strokes

ON セン KUN さき ま・ず

A toe stepping out above a pair of walking legs 儿 — the foot that gets there first. Ahead, earlier, previous.

先 さき ahead; the tip

先生 せんせい teacher; doctor

先週 せんしゅう last week

名

1 2
3 4
5 6

name / famous

#132

G1

6 strokes

ON メイ ミョウ KUN な

Evening 夕 over a mouth 口 — it is too dark to see who is coming, so you open your mouth and call out your name.

名前 なまえ name

有名 ゆうめい famous

氏名 しめい full name

交

1
2 3 4
5 6

mingle / exchange

#133

G2

6 strokes

ON コウ KUN まじ・わる まじ・える ま・じる

A lid 冫 above 父 — a figure sitting with the legs crossed over each other. Where lines cross, things mix and meet.

交通 こうつう traffic; transport

交番 こうばん police box

交流 こうりゅう exchange; interaction

予

1 2
3 4

beforehand

#134

G3

4 strokes

ON ヨ シャ KUN あらかじ・め

A 丩 hook holding 了 — the weaver's shuttle already threaded and passed forward before the cloth exists. Everything 予 touches happens in advance.

予定 よてい plan; schedule

予約 よやく reservation; appointment

予報 よほう forecast

川

1 2 3

river

#135

G1

3 strokes

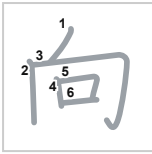
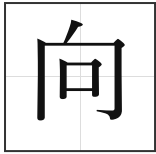
ON セン KUN かわ

Two banks with the current running between them — three strokes straight down, the middle one shorter where the water is deepest.

川 かわ river

小川 おがわ brook; stream

河川 かせん rivers (formal)



face toward

#136 G3 6 strokes

ON コウ KUN む・く む・い む・き

A ridge stroke 丿 for the roof, walls 冂, and a window 口 cut into the wall — the house turns its window toward you. To face, to head for.

向く むく to face; to turn toward

向かう むかう to head for

向こう むこう the other side; over there



win / victory

#137 G3 12 strokes

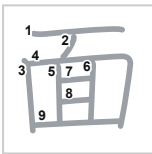
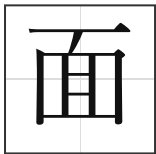
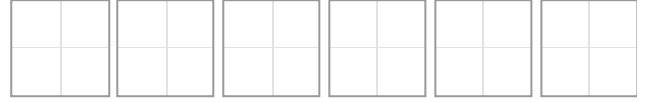
ON ショウ KUN か・つ が・ち まさ・る

The flesh 月 of the arm beside 券 — two 二 and a person 人 over strength 力. Put arm and body and strength together and you win.

勝つ かつ to win

勝手 かって one's own way; selfish

勝負 しょうぶ match; contest



face / surface

#138 G3 9 strokes

ON メン ベン KUN おも おもて つら

A face drawn inside its own outline: the outer frame is the head, the box inside is the eye staring out. A mask, a face, and by extension any flat surface or aspect.

面 めん surface; aspect

面白い おもしろい interesting; fun

面接 めんせつ interview



entrust / committee

#139 G3 8 strokes

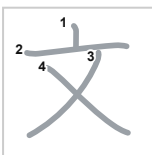
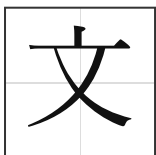
ON イ KUN ゆだ・ねる

Grain 禾 bending its heavy head over a woman 女 — the harvest is handed into her keeping. To entrust, and so a committee of people entrusted with something.

委員 いいん committee member

委員会 いいんかい committee; board

委員長 いいんちょう committee chair



sentence / culture

#140 G1 4 strokes

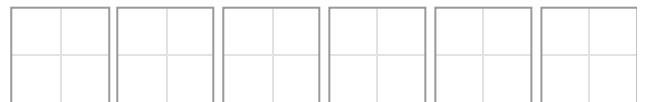
ON ブン モン KUN ふみ あや

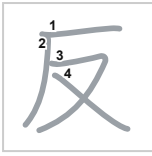
A lid 丷 over a cross 乂 — the crossed pattern marked on a chest, the oldest writing there was. Sentences, letters, and the culture they carry.

文 ぶん sentence

文化 ぶんか culture

文字 もじ letter; character





anti- / oppose #141 G3 4 strokes

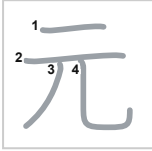
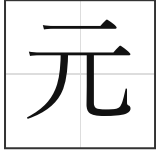
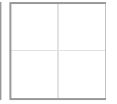
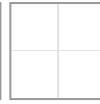
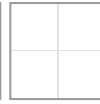
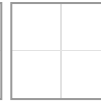
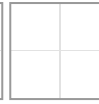
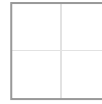
ON ハン ホン タン KUN そ・る そ・らす かえ・す

A hand 又 shoved against a cliff face 厩 — pushing back the way you came, turning the thing over. Against, contrary, opposed.

反対 はんたい opposition; the opposite

反応 はんのう reaction; response

反省 はんせい reflection; regret



origin / former #142 G2 4 strokes

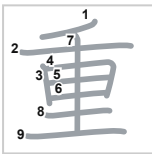
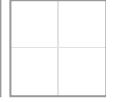
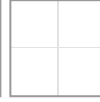
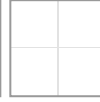
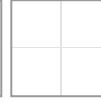
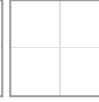
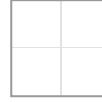
ON ゲン ガン KUN もと

Two 二 lines for the head sitting on a pair of legs 儿 — the top of a person, where they start. The origin, the former state.

元 もと origin; former state

元気 げんき well; energetic

地元 じもと local area; hometown



heavy / important #143 G3 9 strokes

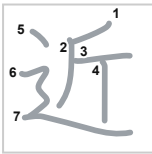
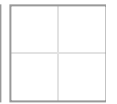
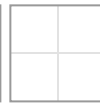
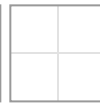
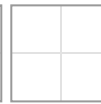
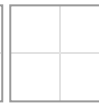
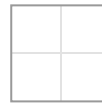
ON ジュウ チョウ KUN え おも・い おも・り

A thousand 千 pressed straight down onto a village 里 — a load that heavy bends the back, and what weighs the most is what matters the most.

重い おもい heavy

重ねる かさねる to pile up; to stack

重要 じゅうよう important



near / recent #144 G2 7 strokes

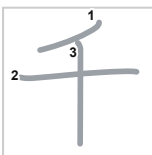
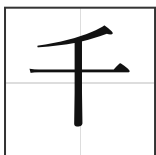
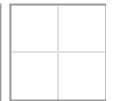
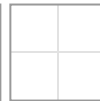
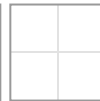
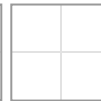
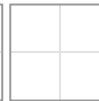
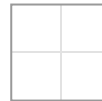
ON キン コン KUN ちか・い

The road radical 辶 carrying an axe 斤 — close enough to reach with one swing of the blade. Near in space, and recent in time.

近い ちかい near; close

近く ちかく nearby; the vicinity

最近 さいきん recently



thousand #145 G1 3 strokes

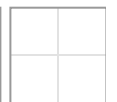
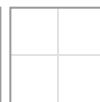
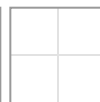
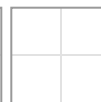
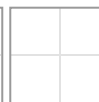
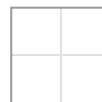
ON セン KUN ち

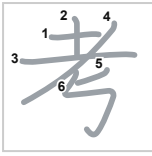
One slanting stroke 丿 laid across ten 十 — one more mark on the ten and the count runs away with itself. A thousand. Do not confuse it with 干 or 干's cousin 午.

千 せん thousand

千円 せんえん a thousand yen

千円札 せんえんさつ thousand-yen bill





think / consider #146 G2 6 strokes

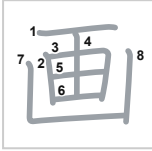
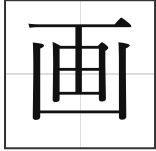
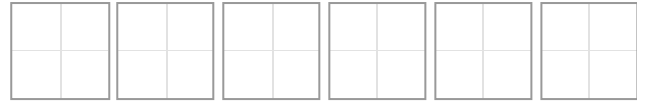
ON コウ KUN かんが・える かんが・え

An old man 耄 leaning on a bent stick 丐 — he is in no hurry, and he turns the matter over before he answers.

考える かんがえる to think; to consider

考え かんがえ idea; thought

考え方 かんがえかた way of thinking



picture / stroke #147 G2 8 strokes

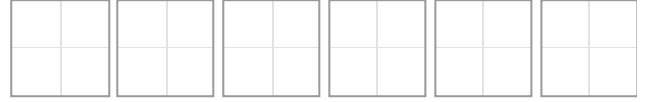
ON ガ カク エ KUN えが・く かく・する かげ・る

A brush ruling out a boundary: 一 across the top, then a rice field 田 closed in by its frame 凵. The lines the brush draws, and the picture they make.

映画 えいが movie

計画 けいかく plan

画面 がめん screen



sea / ocean #148 G2 9 strokes

ON カイ KUN うみ

Water 氵 beside 每, every — every drop of water on earth ends up in the same place. The sea.

海 うみ sea; ocean

海外 かいがい overseas; abroad

北海道 ほっかいどう Hokkaido



sell #149 G2 7 strokes

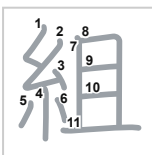
ON バイ KUN う・る う・れる

A signboard 士 over an awning 冂 standing on legs 儿 — a market stall set up in the street with its sign out. Selling.

売る うる to sell

売り場 うりば sales floor; counter

売店 ばいてん kiosk; stand



group / assemble #150 G2 11 strokes

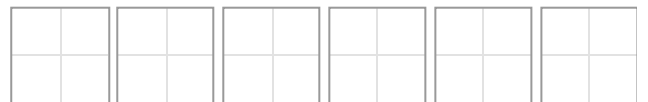
ON ソ KUN く・む くみ ぐみ

Threads 糸 beside 且, a stack of layers — you braid the strands one over another until they hold together. A group, a team, a thing put together.

組む くむ to put together; to team up

組 くみ class; group

番組 ばんぐみ TV or radio program





know / wisdom

#151

G2

8 strokes

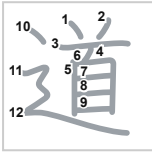
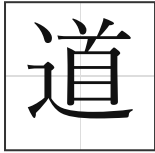
ON チ KUN し・る し・らせる

An arrow 矢 flying out of a mouth 口 — words that go straight to the mark, because the one speaking already knows.

知る しる to know

知らせる しらせる to inform; to let know

知識 ちしき knowledge



road / way

#152

G2

12 strokes

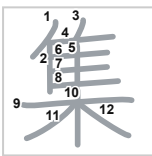
ON ドウ トウ KUN みち いう

A head 首 — self the nose over 目 the eye — moving along the road radical 辶. You walk it head first, and it becomes your way.

道 みち road; way

道路 どうろ road; highway

水道 すいどう water supply; tap water



gather / collect

#153

G3

12 strokes

ON シュウ KUN あつ・まる あつ・める つど・う

A short-tailed bird 隹 perched on a tree 木 — where one lands, the whole flock comes down. Gathering.

集める あつめる to collect; to gather

集まる あつまる to gather (intransitive)

集中 しゅうちゅう concentration



thing / object

#154

G3

8 strokes

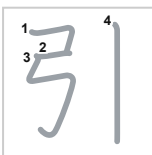
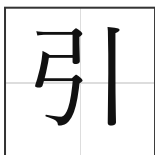
ON ブツ モツ KUN もの

A cow 牛 next to 勿, a banner with its streamers flying — livestock and goods, the things people actually own and carry.

物 もの thing; object

買い物 かいもの shopping

荷物 にもつ luggage; baggage



pull / draw

#155

G2

4 strokes

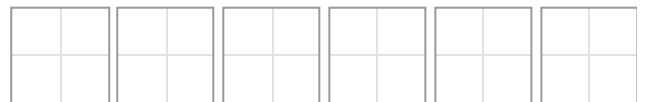
ON イン KUN ひ・く ひ・ける

A bow 弓 with the drawn string | standing beside it — the archer pulls. To pull, to draw, to deduct.

引く ひく to pull; to subtract

引っ越し ひっこし moving house

割引 わりびき discount



使

1 3 7
5 6
4 2
8

use / envoy #156 G3 8 strokes

ON シ KUN つか・う つか・い づか・い

A person 人 standing beside 吏, an official — the officer puts the man to use and sends him off with the message.

使う つかう to use

使い方 つかいかた how to use something

使用 しょう use; usage

所

1 5
2 6 7
4 3 8

place #157 G3 8 strokes

ON ショ KUN ところ どころ ところ

A door 戸 with an axe 斤 beside it — the spot where the woodcutter sets up and works. A place.

所 ところ place

場所 ばしょ place; location

住所 じゅうしょ address

次

1 3
4 5 6
2

next / order #158 G3 6 strokes

ON ジ シ KUN つ・ぐ つぎ

Two drops 丶 in front of a man 欠 with his mouth open in a yawn — he sighs and waits his turn. What comes next.

次 つぎ next

次回 じかい next time

目次 もくじ table of contents

水

1 3
2 4

water #159 G1 4 strokes

ON スイ KUN みず

A stream running straight down the middle with two splashes flying off either side. Water.

水 みず water

水曜日 すいようび Wednesday

水道 すいどう tap water; water supply

半

1 5 2
3 4

half #160 G2 5 strokes

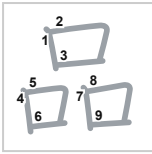
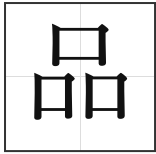
ON ハン KUN なか・ば

An ox split straight down the middle: the two dots and 二 on top, cut through by the vertical of 十. Two equal halves.

半分 はんぶん half

半年 はんとし half a year

半日 はんにち half a day



goods / article

#161

G3

9 strokes

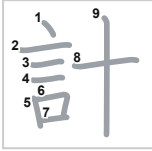
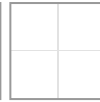
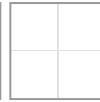
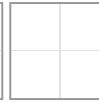
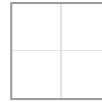
ON ヒン ホン KUN しな

Three mouths 口 stacked in a pyramid, one on top and two below. A crowd of mouths tasting and grading the goods; what they all approve is a quality article.

商品 しょうひん merchandise; product

品物 しなもの goods; article

食品 しょくひん food products



plan / measure

#162

G2

9 strokes

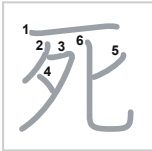
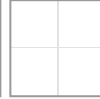
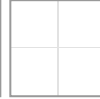
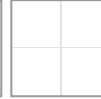
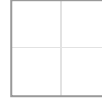
ON ケイ KUN はか・る はか・らう

Words 言 standing next to ten 十. You count out loud up to ten, and counting with words is how you measure a thing and plan around it.

計画 けいかく plan

時計 とけい clock; watch

計算 けいさん calculation



death / die

#163

G3

6 strokes

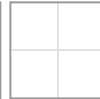
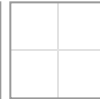
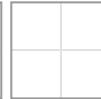
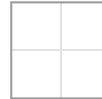
ON シ KUN し・ぬ し・に

On the left 歹, bare bones under a stroke; on the right 匕, a person bent over kneeling. A living person bowing beside a skeleton is death.

死ぬ しぬ to die

必死 ひっし desperate; frantic

死亡 しぼう death (formal)



person in charge

#164

G3

9 strokes

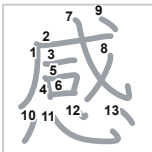
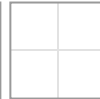
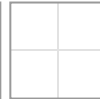
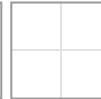
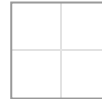
ON ケイ KUN かか・る かかり がかり

A person 亻 beside a thread 系, a strand 丿 hanging over silk 系. The one tied to the thread is the one connected to the matter — the clerk in charge.

関係 かんけい relation; connection

係 かり person in charge; clerk

係員 かりいん staff member; attendant



feeling / emotion

#165

G3

13 strokes

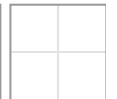
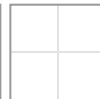
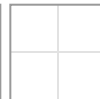
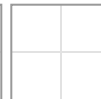
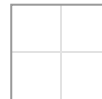
ON カン KUN —

咸 sits on top of a heart 心: a halberd 戈 swung over a mouth 口. Words that strike the heart like a blade — that is a feeling.

感じる かんじる to feel

感謝 かんしゃ gratitude

感動 かんどう being deeply moved



投

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

throw / cast #166 G3 7 strokes

ON トウ KUN な・げる な・げ

A hand 手 beside 受, which is another hand 又 swinging a weapon 几. Wind the arm back and let it fly — to throw.

投げる なげる to throw

投票 とうひょう voting; a ballot

投資 とうし investment

打

1 2 3 4 5

strike / hit #167 G3 5 strokes

ON ダ ダース KUN う・つ う・ち ぶ・つ

A hand 手 next to a nail 丁, which is a nail head with the shaft hanging down. The hand drives the nail — to strike.

打つ うつ to hit; to strike

打ち合わせ うちあわせ meeting; briefing

打ち上げ うちあげ launch; wrap-up party

男

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

man / male #168 G1 7 strokes

ON ダン ナン KUN おとこ お

Strength 力 under the rice field 田. The one who put his muscle into the paddy was the man of the house.

男 おとこ man

男性 だんせい male; man (formal)

男の子 おとこのこ boy

始

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

begin / start #169 G3 8 strokes

ON シ KUN はじ・める はじ・まる

A woman 女 next to 台, a small stand made of 厶 over 口. Every life starts from a woman; she is the platform it all begins on.

始める はじめる to begin (something)

始まる はじまる to begin (of itself)

開始 かいし start; commencement

島

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

island #170 G3 10 strokes

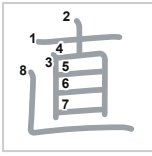
ON トウ KUN しま

A bird 鳥 with its legs cut off, sitting on a mountain 山. The seabird lands on the peak that pokes out of the water — an island.

島 しま island

半島 はんとう peninsula

島国 しまぐに island country



straight / fix

#171 G2 8 strokes

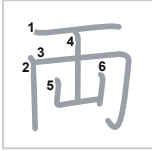
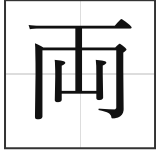
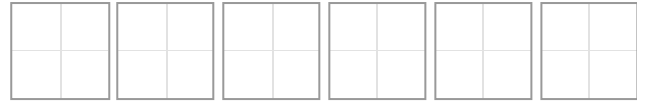
ON チョク ジキ ジカ KUN ただ・ちに なお・す なお・る

Ten 十 eyes 目 sighting along a line, with the line drawn under them. When ten eyes check it, the thing is straight and honest.

直す なおす to fix; to correct

直る なおる to be fixed; to be repaired

正直 しょうじき honest



both / two

#172 G3 6 strokes

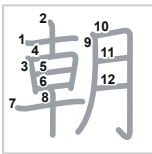
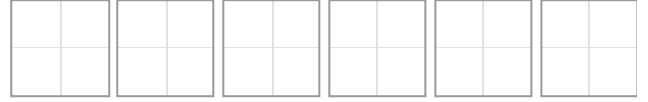
ON リョウ KUN てる ふたつ

One line 一 across the top, then a frame 冂 split down the middle into two matching halves. Two equal weights hanging on one beam 一 both sides.

両親 りょうしん parents

両方 りょうほう both

両手 りょうて both hands



morning

#173 G2 12 strokes

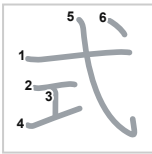
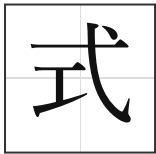
ON チョウ KUN あさ

The sun 日 caught between the grasses on the left, and the moon 月 still hanging on the right. Sun already up, moon not yet gone — that is morning.

朝 あさ morning

今朝 けさ this morning

毎朝 まいあさ every morning



ceremony / style

#174 G3 6 strokes

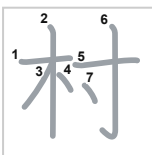
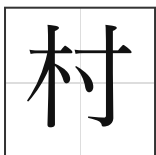
ON シキ KUN 一

A carpenter's tool 工 tucked under a stake 弋 with its dot. The fixed way the work is done — the proper form, and so the ceremony.

式 しき ceremony

結婚式 けっこんしき wedding

卒業式 そつぎょうしき graduation ceremony



village

#175 G1 7 strokes

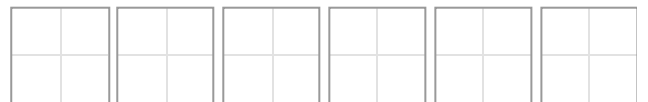
ON ソン KUN むら

A tree 木 beside a measure 寸, the hand with a mark at the pulse. Land paced out tree by tree and shared among neighbors — a village.

村 むら village

市町村 しちょうそん municipalities

村人 むらびと villager



運

10 1 2 3 9 5 4 6 7 11 8 12 運

carry / luck

#176

G3

12 strokes

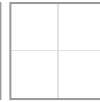
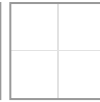
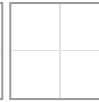
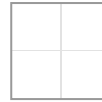
ON ウン KUN はこ・ぶ

An army 軍 — a war chariot 車 under a cover 𠂔 — set on the road 上. Wheeling the wagons down the road is carrying, and where the road takes you is your luck.

運ぶ はこぶ to carry; to transport

運転 うんてん driving; operation

運動 うんどう exercise; movement



終

1 2 7 8 3 9 4 6 10 11 5 終

end / finish

#177

G3

11 strokes

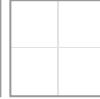
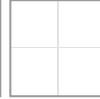
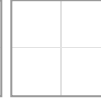
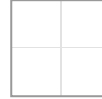
ON シュウ KUN お・わる お・える つい

Thread 糸 on the left, winter 冬 on the right. The thread runs out and the year runs down into winter — the end.

終わる おわる to end; to finish

終わる おえる to finish (something)

最終 さいしゅう last; final



西

1 4 5 2 3 6 西

west

#178

G2

6 strokes

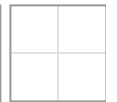
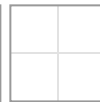
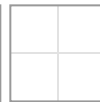
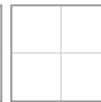
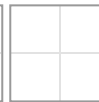
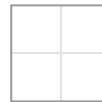
ON セイ サイ ス KUN にし

A bird's nest box with the bird settled inside, its legs showing at the bottom. Birds go to the nest when the sun goes down, and the sun goes down in the west.

西 にし west

西口 にしぐち west exit

関西 かんさい the Kansai region



台

1 2 4 3 5 台

stand / platform

#179

G2

5 strokes

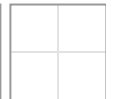
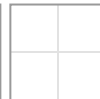
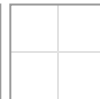
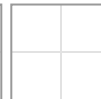
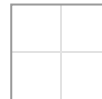
ON タイ タイ KUN うてな われ つかさ

A private mark 厶 resting on a box 口. A little box you set things up on — a stand, and so the counter for machines that sit on wheels.

台所 だいどころ kitchen

台風 たいふう typhoon

一台 いちだい one (machine, vehicle)



広

1 2 3 4 5 広

wide / spacious

#180

G2

5 strokes

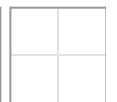
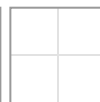
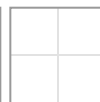
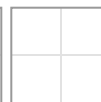
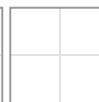
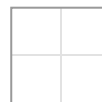
ON コウ KUN ひろ・い ひろ・まる ひろ・める

Under a broad roof 广 there is only a small 厶 and nothing else. A big hall with almost nothing in it feels wide.

広い ひろい wide; spacious

広場 ひろば plaza; open square

広告 こうこく advertisement





electricity #181 G2 13 strokes

ON デン KUN —

Rain 雨 above, and below it the tail of the lightning 电 twisting down out of the cloud. Lightning inside the rain is electricity.

電車 でんしゃ train

電話 でんわ telephone; phone call

電気 でんき electricity; light



reside / live #182 G3 7 strokes

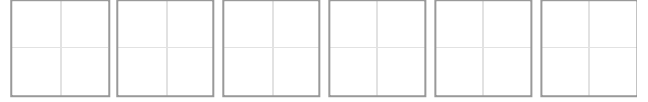
ON ジュウ ズユウ チュウ KUN す・む す・ま
う す・まい

A person 人 standing beside the master 主, a lamp flame 火 above the stand 王. The master of the lit house is the person who lives there.

住む すむ to live; to reside

住所 じゅうしょ address

住民 じゅうみん resident



discuss / talk #183 G3 15 strokes

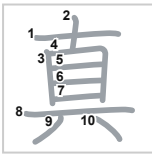
ON タン KUN —

Words 言 beside a blaze 炎, one fire 火 piled on another. People talking around the campfire — a discussion.

相談 そうだん consultation; advice

冗談 じょうだん joke

面談 めんだん interview; meeting in person



true / real #184 G3 10 strokes

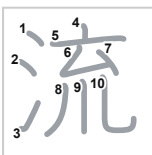
ON シン KUN ま まこと

Ten 十 on top of an eye 目, standing on a small table 几. Look at a thing with ten eyes and you see it as it truly is.

写真 しゃしん photograph

真面目 まじめ serious; diligent

真ん中 まんなか the middle; center



flow / current #185 G3 10 strokes

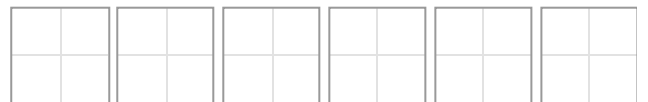
ON リュウ ル KUN なが・れる なが・れ な
が・す

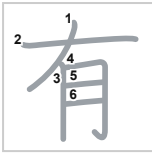
Water 氵 next to 流, a child turned upside down with its hair streaming below. A baby carried head first down the water — the current flows.

流れる ながれる to flow

流す ながす to let flow; to flush

交流 こうりゅう exchange; interaction





have / exist

#186

G3

6 strokes

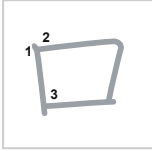
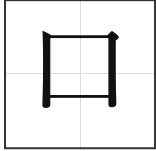
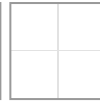
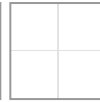
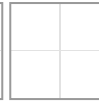
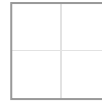
ON ユウ ウ KUN あ・る

A hand reaching in from the upper left over a slab of meat 月. Meat in your hand is something you actually possess.

有名 ゆうめい famous

有料 ゆうりょう paid; not free

有効 ゆうこう valid; effective



mouth

#187

G1

3 strokes

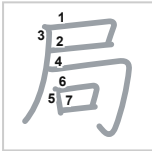
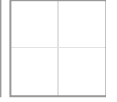
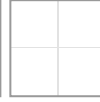
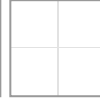
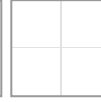
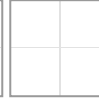
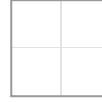
ON コウ ク KUN くち

An open mouth seen from the front, squared off by the brush into three strokes. Anywhere something goes in or out is a 口.

口 くち mouth

入口 いりぐち entrance

出口 でぐち exit



office / bureau

#188

G3

7 strokes

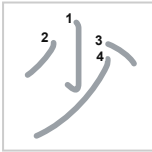
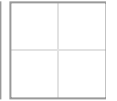
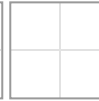
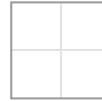
ON キョク KUN つぼね

A low roof 尸 pulled down over a shortened 句, with its mouth 口 at the bottom. A clerk boxed in under a low ceiling, speaking through a hatch — the office.

郵便局 ゆうびんきょく post office

結局 けっきょく in the end; after all

薬局 やっきょく pharmacy



few / a little

#189

G2

4 strokes

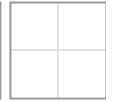
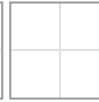
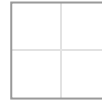
ON ショウ KUN すく・ない すこ・し

Small 小 with one extra stroke 丿 slicing a piece off the side. Take a sliver off something already small and only a little is left.

少し すこし a little; a bit

少ない すくない few; not much

少年 しょうねん boy; youth



release / set free

#190

G3

8 strokes

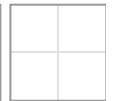
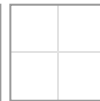
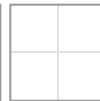
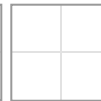
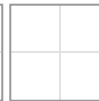
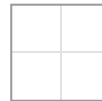
ON ホウ KUN はな・す っぱな・し はな・つ

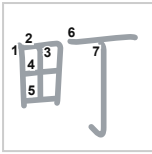
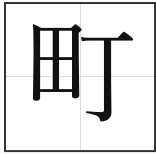
A direction 方 on the left and a hand holding a stick 攴 on the right. Strike the thing and send it off that way — let it go, set it free.

放送 ほうそう broadcast

放す はなす to release; to let go

開放 かいほう opening up; throwing open





town / block

#191

G1

7 strokes

ON チョウ KUN まち

Rice fields 田 laid out beside a nail 丁, straight as a ruled road. Fields cut into straight blocks by streets make a town.

町 まち town; neighborhood

下町 したまち old downtown district

町内会 ちょうないかい neighborhood association



school

#192

G1

10 strokes

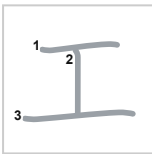
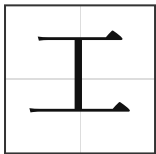
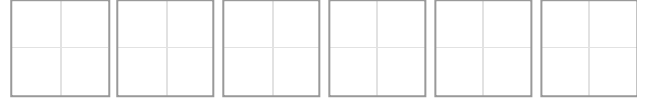
ON コウ キョウ KUN —

Wood 木 next to 交, a figure with its legs crossed. Rows of wooden desks crossing the room — a school.

学校 がっこう school

高校 こうこう high school

校長 こうちょう principal



craft / construction

#193

G2

3 strokes

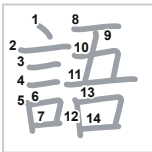
ON コウ ク グ KUN —

A carpenter's ruler seen side on: a flat top, a flat base and the shaft between them. The tool stands for the trade itself.

工事 こうじ construction work

工場 こうじょう factory

工業 こうぎょう industry; manufacturing



language / word

#194

G2

14 strokes

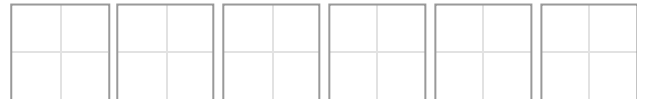
ON ゴ KUN かた・る かた・らう

Words 言 beside 吾, which is five 五 over a mouth 口 and means "I". The words that come out of my own mouth — speech, language.

日本語 にほんご the Japanese language

英語 えいご English

単語 たんご word; vocabulary item



ball / sphere

#195

G3

11 strokes

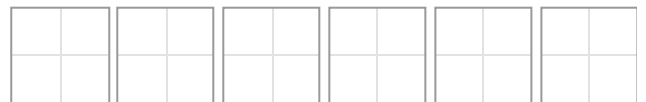
ON キュウ KUN たま

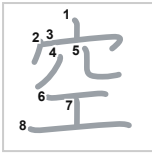
The jewel 王 on the left and 求, to seek, on the right. The polished jade ball everyone wants to get hold of — a sphere.

野球 やきゅう baseball

地球 ちきゅう the Earth

電球 でんきゅう light bulb





sky / empty

#196 G1 8 strokes

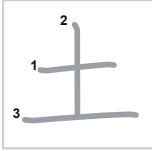
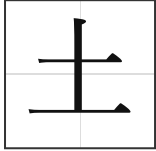
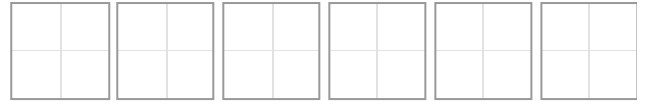
ON クウ KUN そら あ・く あ・き

A cave mouth 穴 above a workman's tool 工. Dig with the tool and what you make is a hole full of nothing; the huge empty hole overhead is the sky.

空 そら sky

空気 くうき air; atmosphere

空港 こうこう airport



soil / earth

#197 G1 3 strokes

ON ド ト KUN つち

A mound of earth heaped on the ground line: the base stroke is the ground, the cross above it is the pile standing on it.

土曜日 どうようび Saturday

土 つち soil; earth

土地 とち land; plot of land



hurry / urgent

#198 G3 9 strokes

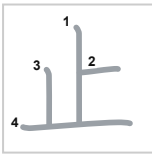
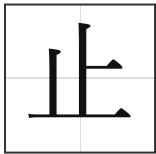
ON キュウ KUN いそ・ぐ いそ・ぎ せ・く

A hand 𠂇 grabbing at someone from behind, with a heart 心 underneath. The heart pounding as the hand closes in — hurry.

急ぐ いそぐ to hurry

急 きゅう sudden; urgent

急行 きゅうこう express train



stop / halt

#199 G2 4 strokes

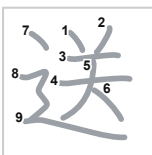
ON シ KUN と・まる ど・まり と・める

A footprint seen from above: the toes across the top and the heel below. The foot planted flat and going no further — stop.

止まる とまる to stop (of itself)

止める とめる to stop (something)

中止 ちゅうし cancellation



send / see off

#200 G3 9 strokes

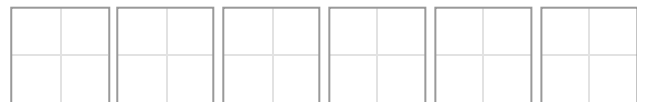
ON ソウ KUN おく・る

关, two hands lifting something up, set on the road 送. Carrying a gift down the road to someone — to send it, or to see them off.

送る おくる to send

放送 ほうそう broadcast

送料 そうりょう postage; shipping fee





role / duty

#201

G3

7 strokes

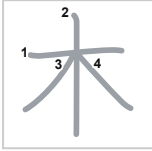
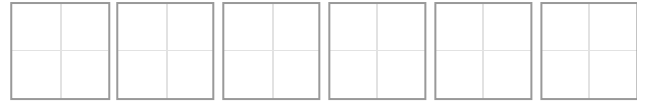
ON ヤク エキ KUN —

The 亻 step radical on the left is a man setting out on the road, and 受 on the right is a hand 又 gripping a weapon. A man marching off on official service — a duty, a post, a role.

役所 やくしょ government office

市役所 しやくしょ city hall

役員 やくいん director; officer



tree / wood

#202

G1

4 strokes

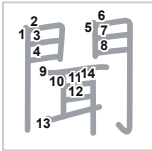
ON ボク モク KUN き こ

A tree drawn whole: the horizontal stroke is the branches, the vertical is the trunk, and the two legs spreading below are the roots going into the ground.

木 き tree

木曜日 もくようび Thursday

木材 もくざい lumber; timber



hear / ask

#203

G2

14 strokes

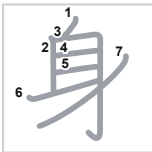
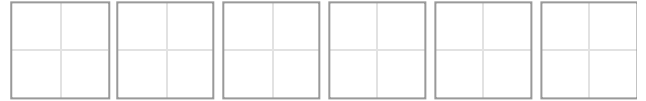
ON ブン モン KUN き・く き・こえる

An 耳 ear set inside a 門 gate. You put your ear to the gate to catch what is being said on the other side — hearing, and asking.

聞く きく to hear; to ask

新聞 しんぶん newspaper

聞こえる きこえる to be audible



body / oneself

#204

G3

7 strokes

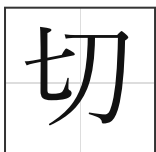
ON シン KUN み

A side view of a person with a rounded, swollen belly — the shape first meant a pregnant woman. From the body it came to mean the person themselves.

身 み body; oneself

自身 じしん oneself

出身 しゅっしん place of origin



cut

#205

G2

4 strokes

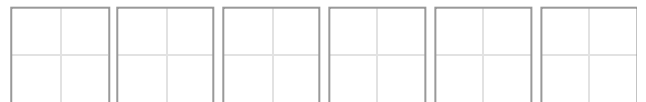
ON セツ サイ KUN き・る き・り ぎ・り

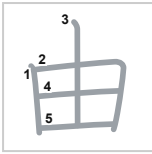
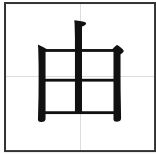
七 on the left marks the spot where the cut goes, and 刀 on the right is the sword itself. Put the blade to the mark and cut.

切る きる to cut

大切 たいせつ important; precious

親切 しんせつ kind





reason / cause #206 G3 5 strokes

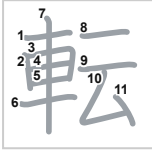
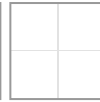
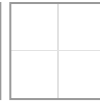
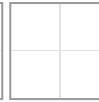
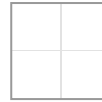
ON ユ ユウ ユイ KUN よし よ・る

It looks like 日 the sun with a stalk | pushing up out of the top — something coming out of the thing it grew from. What a matter comes out of is its reason.

理由 りゆう reason

自由 じゆう freedom

由来 ゆらい origin; derivation



roll / turn #207 G3 11 strokes

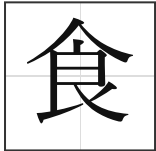
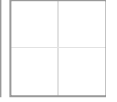
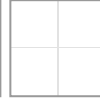
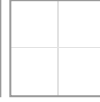
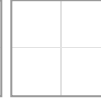
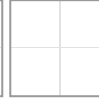
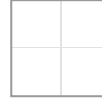
ON テン KUN ころ・がる ころ・げる ころ・がす

A 車 wheel on the left, and 云 on the right — 二 over 厶, a puff of cloud curling round. The wheel goes round and round, so things roll, turn and change.

運転 うんてん driving; operation

自転車 じてんしゃ bicycle

転ぶ ころぶ to fall over



eat / food #208 G2 9 strokes

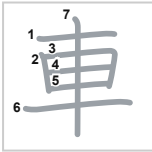
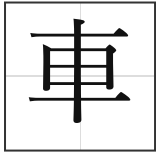
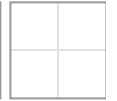
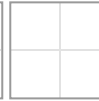
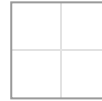
ON ショク ジキ KUN く・う く・らう た・べる

A lid on top and the legs of a stand below, with a heap of cooked grain between them — a covered bowl of food set out on its stand.

食べる たべる to eat

食事 しょくじ meal

食堂 しょくどう cafeteria; dining hall



car / wheel #209 G1 7 strokes

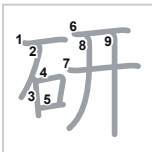
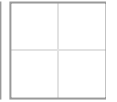
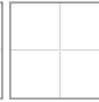
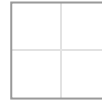
ON シャ KUN くるま

A cart seen from above. The long vertical stroke is the axle, the box in the middle is the cart bed, and the two horizontal strokes are the wheels on either end.

車 くるま car

電車 でんしゃ train

自動車 じどうしゃ automobile



polish / research #210 G3 9 strokes

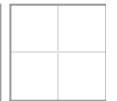
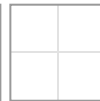
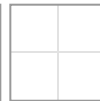
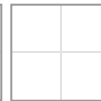
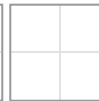
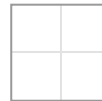
ON ケン KUN と・ぐ

A 石 stone on the left and 开 on the right, two level supports holding a piece flat. You rub it on the stone to grind it smooth — and grinding away at a subject is research.

研究 けんきゅう research

研修 けんしゅう training

研究所 けんきゅうじょ research institute



何

1 3 5 7
2 4 6

what #211 G2 7 strokes

ON カ KUN なに なん

A person 亻 on the left beside 可, which is a 口 mouth with a bent stroke coming out of it. A person opening their mouth to put a question: what?

何 なに what

何時 なんじ what time

何人 なんにん how many people



南

1 2
4 6
3 5 8 9

south #212 G2 9 strokes

ON ナン ナ KUN みなみ

A bell hanging in its frame 冂, with 十 above as the hook and 干 inside as the clapper — a bronze bell of the southern people. Their direction became the word for south.

南 みなみ south

南口 みなみぐち south exit

東南 とうなん southeast



石

1 2
4
3 5

stone #213 G1 5 strokes

ON セキ シャク コク KUN いし

An overhanging cliff at the top left, with a 口 lump lying below it — a stone that has broken off the cliff face and come to rest.

石 いし stone

石油 せきゆ petroleum; oil

宝石 ほうせき jewel; gemstone



足

1 2
3
6 4 5
7

foot / suffice #214 G1 7 strokes

ON ソク KUN あし た・りる た・る

A 口 knee joint on top and 止 a foot planted flat below — the whole leg from knee to sole. Having legs enough to stand on gives the second meaning: to be enough.

足 あし leg; foot

足りる たりる to be enough

不足 ふそく shortage; lack



消

1 5 4 6
2 8
7 9
3 10

extinguish / erase #215 G3 10 strokes

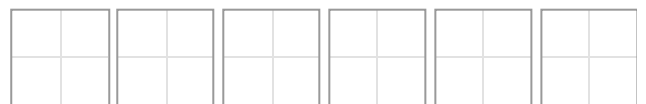
ON ショウ KUN き・える け・す

Water 氵 on the left and 肖 on the right — 𠂇 small over 月 flesh, meaning to whittle down. Water wears a thing down until it is gone, and pours over a fire to put it out.

消す けす to turn off; to erase

消える きえる to disappear; to go out

消費税 しょうひぜい consumption tax



神

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9
神

god / spirit #216 G3 9 strokes

ON シン ジン KUN かみ かん こう

The altar radical 礻 on the left, and 申 on the right — a bolt of lightning splitting the sky, 日 with a line driven through it. The power that speaks in lightning, worshipped at the altar.

神 かみ god; deity

神社 じんじゃ Shinto shrine

神様 かみさま god (polite)

番

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12
番

turn / number #217 G2 12 strokes

ON バン KUN つか・い

采 on top is a hand scattering seed, and 田 below is the field. You sow the plots one after another, in a fixed order — hence turn, and number in a series.

番号 ばんごう number

一番 いちばん the most; number one

交番 こうばん police box

配

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
配

distribute / arrange #218 G3

10 strokes

ON ハイ KUN くば・る

酉 on the left is a tall wine jar, and 己 on the right is a person kneeling beside it. Someone kneeling at the jar, pouring out a share for each guest.

心配 しんぱい worry

配る くばる to hand out

配達 はいたつ delivery

算

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14
算

calculate #219 G2 14 strokes

ON サン KUN そろ

竹 bamboo on top, a 目 eye in the middle, and 扌 two hands below. Hands sliding bamboo counting rods while the eye keeps watch — an abacus at work.

計算 けいさん calculation

予算 よさん budget

算数 さんすう arithmetic

宮

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
宮

shrine / palace #220 G3 10 strokes

ON キュウ グウ ク KUN みや

A roof 宀 spread over 吕, which is two 口 rooms joined one below the other. Room after room under a single roof: a palace, and the halls of a great shrine.

神宮 じんぐう grand shrine

宮 みや shrine

宮殿 きゅうでん palace



investigate / research

#221

G3

7 strokes

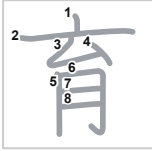
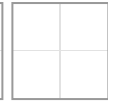
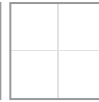
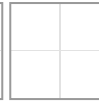
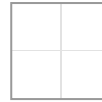
ON キュウ ク KUN きわ・める

穴 a cave on top — a roof 宀 with 八 the opening beneath it — and 九 nine underneath. You go down the hole all nine ways, right to the very bottom of the matter.

研究 けんきゅう research

研究所 けんきゅうじょ research institute

究極 きゅうきょく ultimate



raise / grow up

#222

G3

8 strokes

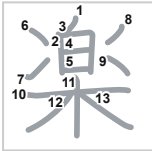
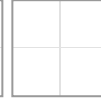
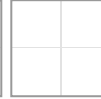
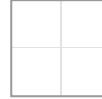
ON イク KUN そだ・つ そだ・ち そだ・てる

The top is a newborn child drawn upside down as it is being born — 𠂔 over 厶 — and 月 below is flesh, the body. A baby being fed until it fills out and grows.

教育 きょういく education

育てる そだてる to raise; to bring up

育つ そだつ to grow up



music / ease

#223

G2

13 strokes

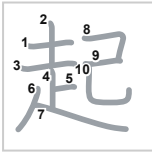
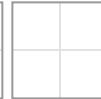
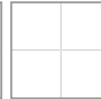
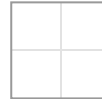
ON ガク ラク ゴウ KUN たの・しい たの・しむ この・む

A wooden 木 frame at the bottom, with 白 a drum on top and 𠂔 two small bells hanging either side of it — a rack of instruments. Music puts people at ease, so it also means comfort.

楽しい たのしい fun; enjoyable

音楽 おんがく music

楽しむ たのしむ to enjoy



get up / occur

#224

G3

10 strokes

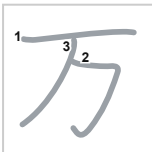
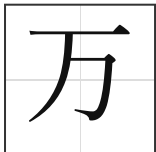
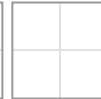
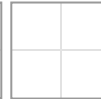
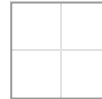
ON キ KUN お・きる お・こる お・こす

走 to run on the left — 土 above 止 a foot — with 己 a curled-up body on the right. Someone lying curled up straightens out and takes off running: they get up.

起きる おきる to get up; to happen

起こす おこす to wake someone; to cause

早起き はやおき getting up early



ten thousand

#225

G2

3 strokes

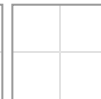
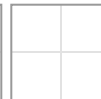
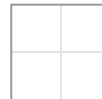
ON マン バン KUN よろず

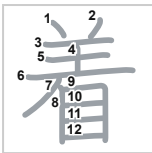
Three strokes starting from 一. The old character showed a swarm of scorpions, a number too big to count — which settled into exactly ten thousand.

万 まん ten thousand

一万 いちまん ten thousand

百万 ひゃくまん one million





wear / arrive

#226 G3 12 strokes

ON チャク ジャク KUN き・る き・せる つ・く

羊 a sheep over 目 an eye. Think of the fleece lying on top and clinging fast. What clings to your body is worn; what sticks to a place has arrived.

着る きる to wear; to put on

着く つく to arrive

到着 とうちゃく arrival



ride / board

#227 G3 9 strokes

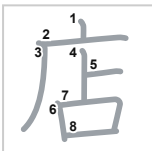
ON ジョウ ショウ KUN の・る の・り の・せる

A person 千 standing up on a 木 tree, with the branch 十 crossing behind them. Someone has climbed up and is sitting astride — riding.

乗る のる to ride; to board

乗り換え のりかえ transfer; change of trains

乗客 じょうきゃく passenger



shop / store

#228 G2 8 strokes

ON テン KUN みせ たな

A lean-to roof 广 over 占, which is ト a divining crack above 口 a mouth — claiming a spot. You claim a place under the roof and set up shop.

店 みせ shop; store

店員 てんいん shop assistant

書店 しょてん bookshop



idea / imagine

#229 G3 13 strokes

ON ソウ ソ KUN おも・う

相 on top is a 木 tree beside a 目 eye — looking hard at something — and 心 the heart sits underneath. You look, and your heart forms a picture. That picture is a thought.

想像 そうそう imagination

予想 よそう prediction

感想 かんそう impressions; thoughts



line

#230 G2 15 strokes

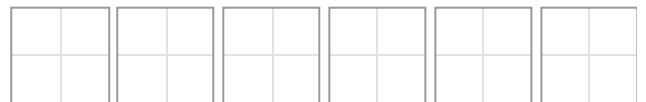
ON セン KUN すじ

糸 thread on the left, 泉 a spring on the right — 白 a white welling-up over 水 water. Water running out of a spring draws a long thin line, like a stretched thread.

線 せん line

新幹線 しんかんせん bullet train

線路 せんろ railway track



病

1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10

illness #231 G3 10 strokes

ON ビョウ ヘイ KUN や・む や・み やまい

疒 is a person stretched out on a sickbed, and 丙 inside it is the legs of that bed. Someone laid up flat under the sickness roof.

病気 びょうき illness

病院 びょういん hospital

病人 びょうにん sick person; patient

農

1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10
11
12

agriculture #232 G3 13 strokes

ON ノウ KUN ー

曲 a bent frame on top and 辰 below, which is a big clam shell — the blade of the old farmer's hoe. Bending over the field with a hoe is farming.

農業 のうぎょう agriculture

農家 のうか farmer; farmhouse

農村 のうそん farming village

州

1
2
3
4
5
6

state / province #233 G3 6 strokes

ON シュウ ス KUN す

The three flowing strokes of 川 a river, with a 丶 dot dropped into each channel — sandbanks standing up out of the current. Land in the water became a district, then a state.

州 しゅう state; province

九州 きゅうしゅう Kyushu

本州 ほんしゅう Honshu

声

1
2
3
4
5
6
7

voice #234 G2 7 strokes

ON セイ ショウ KUN こえ こわ

士 on top with the hanging frame below it — a stone chime hung up and struck. In the old form an ear sat beneath, catching the sound. What a person sends out is their voice.

声 こえ voice

大声 おおごえ loud voice

音声 おんせい audio; sound

待

1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9

wait #235 G3 9 strokes

ON タイ KUN ま・つ ま・ち

イ the crossroads step on the left, and 寺 a temple on the right — 土 earth above 寸 a hand. You stop on the road at the temple and stand there waiting.

待つ まつ to wait

期待 きたい expectation; hope

待ち合わせ まちあわせ meeting up

族

1 5 6
2 4 3 7 8
9 10 11

family / tribe

#236 G3 11 strokes

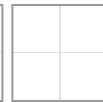
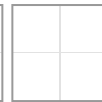
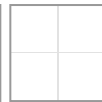
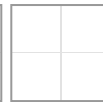
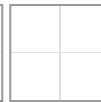
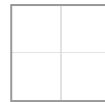
ON ゾク KUN —

方 with 𠂇 above it is a banner on its pole, flapping in the wind, and 矢 below is an arrow. The people who gather under one flag with their arrows are one clan.

家族 かぞく family

民族 みんぞく ethnic group; people

親族 しんぞく relatives



銀

1 2 12 9
3 5 10 11
4 6 7 13
8 14

silver

#237 G3 14 strokes

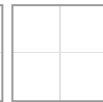
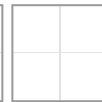
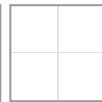
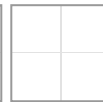
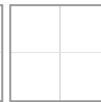
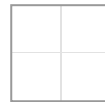
ON ギン KUN しろがね

金 metal on the left and 艮 on the right, an eye that stops and stares fixedly. The metal that catches the eye and holds it: silver.

銀行 ぎんこう bank

銀 ぎん silver

銀色 ぎんいろ silver color



助

2 7
1 3 6
4 5
8

help / assist

#238 G3 7 strokes

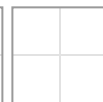
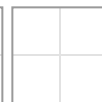
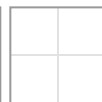
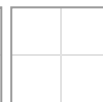
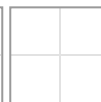
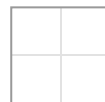
ON ジョ KUN たす・ける たす・かる す・ける

且 on the left is a pile of offerings stacked one on another, and 力 on the right is a straining arm. You add your strength to someone else's pile — that is help.

助ける たすける to help; to rescue

助かる たすかる to be saved; to be a help

助手 じょしゅ assistant



早

2 3
1 4
5 6

early / fast

#239 G1 6 strokes

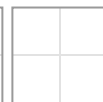
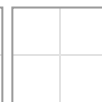
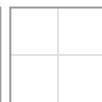
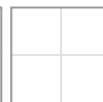
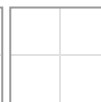
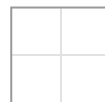
ON ソウ サツ KUN はや・い はや はや・まる

The 日 sun resting just above 十, a marker post on the horizon. The sun only barely up is the early part of the day.

早い はやい early; fast

早起き はやおき early rising

早朝 そうちょう early morning



親

1 10 11
2 4 12
3 7 13
5 6 8 9 14 15 16

parent / close

#240 G2 16 strokes

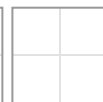
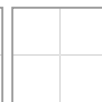
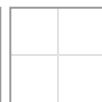
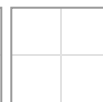
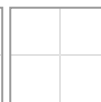
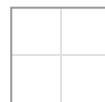
ON シン KUN おや した・しい した・しむ

立 standing on top of a 木 tree on the left, and 見 to look on the right. Someone climbs up to stand and keep watch over the household — the parent, and by extension anyone close to you.

親 おや parent

両親 りょうしん both parents

親切 しんせつ kindness





chase / pursue #241 G3 9 strokes

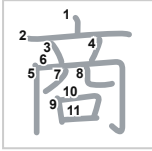
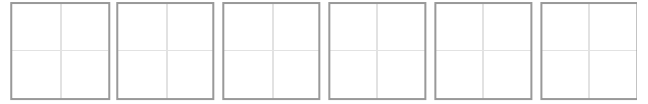
ON ツイ KUN お・う

The road radical 辶 underneath means going, and 自 on top is a heap of piled earth — you run along the road past the mound, chasing after someone.

追う おう to chase; to pursue

追加 つか addition; extra

追いかける おいかける to run after



commerce / trade #242 G3 11 strokes

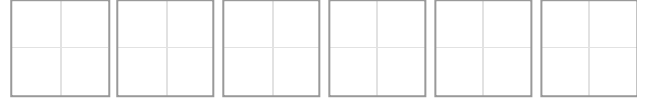
ON ショウ KUN あきな・う

A 立 stands on top of a wide 冂 enclosure with 口 tucked inside it: the merchant stands at his stall and calls prices out of the little window.

商品 しょうひん goods; merchandise

商売 しょうばい business; trade

商店 しょうてん shop; store



leaf #243 G3 12 strokes

ON ヨウ KUN は

Grass 艹 sits on 葉, which is 世 (generation) over 木 (tree): the tree puts out a fresh crop of leaves generation after generation.

葉 は leaf

言葉 ことば word; language

葉書 はがき postcard



shape / form #244 G2 7 strokes

ON ケイ ギョウ KUN かた がた かたち

On the left 开 is a frame standing on 干, a flat base; the three strokes 丿 on the right are the shading a painter adds so the frame reads as a shape.

形 かたち shape; form

人形 にんぎょう doll

形式 けいしき format; formality



fall / drop #245 G3 12 strokes

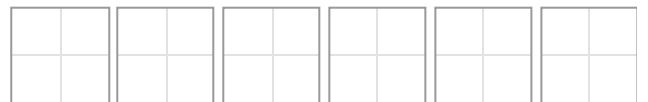
ON ラク KUN お・ちる お・ち お・とす

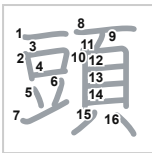
Grass 艹 over 洛, which is water 氵 beside 各 (夕 over 口): rain runs off the leaves and everything comes down.

落ちる おちる to fall; to drop

落とす おとす to drop (something)

落ち着く おちつく to calm down; to settle





head #246 G2 16 strokes

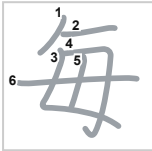
ON トウ ズ ト KUN あたま かしら がしら

豆, a bean-shaped offering stand, on the left; 頁 on the right is the old picture of a head 一目 (eyes) with 八 (legs) beneath the face.

頭 あたま head

頭痛 ずつう headache

先頭 せんとう the lead; the front



every #247 G2 6 strokes

ON マイ KUN ごと ごと・に

The hairpin stroke 乚 sits on 母, the old form of mother: mother puts her pin in and does the same round of chores every single day.

毎日 まいにち every day

毎週 まいしゅう every week

毎朝 まいあさ every morning



doctor / medicine #248 G3 7 strokes

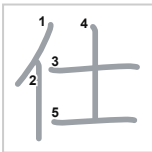
ON イ KUN い・やす い・する くすし

An arrow 矢 (itself 天 over 大 in shape) shut inside the box 匚: the old doctor's job was pulling arrows out and locking them away.

医者 いしゃ doctor

医療 いりょう medical care

医学 いがく medical science



serve / do #249 G3 5 strokes

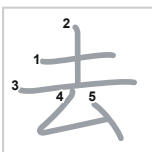
ON シ ジ KUN つか・える

A person 亼 standing beside 士, the scholar-official: the person who attends on the official, and by extension the work he does.

仕事 しごと work; job

仕方 しかた way of doing

仕上げる しあげる to finish up



leave / past #250 G3 5 strokes

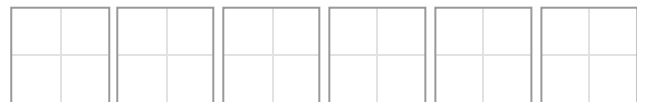
ON キョ コ KUN さ・る

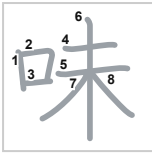
Earth 土 above and 厶 below: a person turns away from the ground he stood on and goes off, so the place becomes the past.

去る さる to leave; to depart

去年 きょねん last year

過去 かこ the past





taste / flavor #251 G3 8 strokes

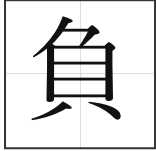
ON ミ KUN あじ あじ・わう

The mouth 口 next to 未, a tree 木 with an extra short branch on top meaning not-yet: the mouth testing fruit that is not yet ripe.

味 あじ taste; flavor

意味 いみ meaning

趣味 しゅみ hobby



lose / bear #252 G3 9 strokes

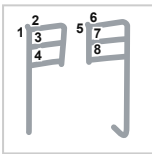
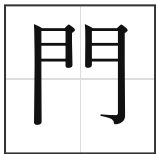
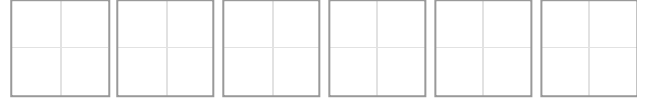
ON フ KUN ま・ける ま・かす お・う

A person bending forward 欠 over 貝, a shell of money (目 with 八 legs): you carry the load on your back, and if you cannot, you lose.

負ける まける to lose; to be beaten

負う おう to bear; to carry

負担 ふたん burden; cost share



gate #253 G2 8 strokes

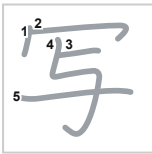
ON モン KUN かど と

Two tall doors facing each other, each with its hinge post and panel. Draw the left leaf first, then the right; nothing else goes inside.

門 もん gate

専門 せんもん specialty; major

正門 せいもん main gate



copy / photograph #254 G3 5 strokes

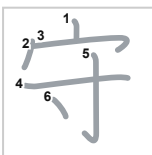
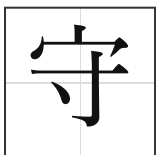
ON シャ ジャ KUN うつ・す うつ・る うつ

A cover 冂 over 与 (to give): what is under the cover is handed over again exactly as it was, so it is a copy.

写真 しゃしん photograph

写す うつす to copy; to photograph

写る うつる to be photographed



protect / keep #255 G3 6 strokes

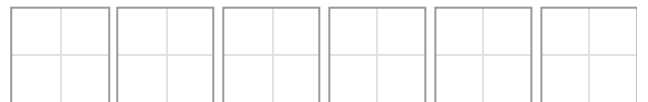
ON シュ ス KUN まも・る まも・り もり

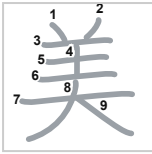
A roof 宀 with 寸, a hand measuring, underneath: one hand kept under the roof of the house, guarding it.

守る まもる to protect; to keep

留守 るす absence; not at home

留守番 るすばん house-sitting





beautiful

#256 G3 9 strokes

ON ビ ミ KUN うつく・しい

羊, a sheep seen from the front, sitting on 大, a big person with arms out: a big fat sheep was the picture of something fine, hence beautiful.

美しい うつくしい beautiful

美術 びじゅつ art; fine arts

美人 びじん beautiful woman



life / command

#257 G3 8 strokes

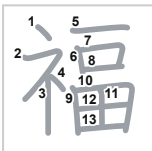
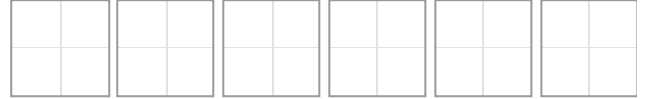
ON メイ ミョウ KUN いのち

人 with 一 makes the roof of an order coming down; 口 is the mouth that gives it and 卩 is the person kneeling to receive it — the order handed to you is your life.

命 いのち life

生命 せいめい life (as a force)

命令 めいれい order; command



fortune / blessing

#258 G3 13 strokes

ON フク KUN ー

The altar radical 礻 on the left, and on the right 畐 — and 口 over 田 — a jar filled to the brim. A full jar set on the altar brings blessings.

幸福 こうふく happiness

福祉 ふくし welfare

祝福 しゅくふく blessing



arrange / tidy

#259 G3 16 strokes

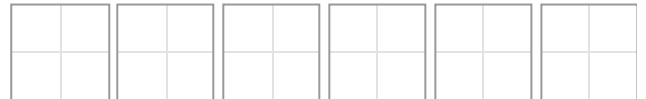
ON セイ KUN ととの・える ととの・う

On top a bundle 束 with a hand and stick 攴 tapping it; below, 正 standing straight. You knock the bundle level until everything is correct.

整理 せいり sorting; tidying

整える ととのえる to put in order

調整 ちょうせい adjustment



side / horizontal

#260 G3 15 strokes

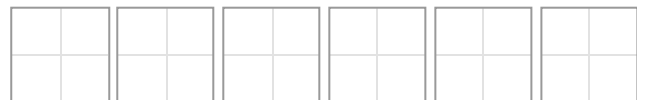
ON オウ KUN よこ

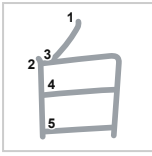
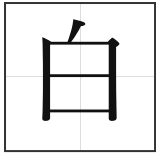
Wood 木 on the left and 黄 (yellow) on the right, itself 𠂔 over 由 over 八: a yellowed beam of timber laid across sideways.

横 よこ side; horizontal

横断歩道 おうだんぽどう pedestrian crossing

横断 おうだん crossing over





white

#261

G1

5 strokes

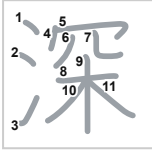
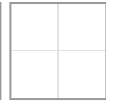
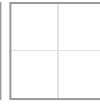
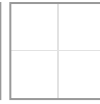
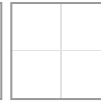
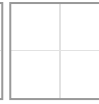
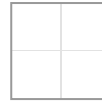
ON ハク ビヤク KUN しろ しら しろ・い

The sun 日 with one short stroke added on top: the first white flash of light above the rising sun.

白い しろい white

白 しろ white (the color)

面白い おもしろい interesting; funny



deep

#262

G3

11 strokes

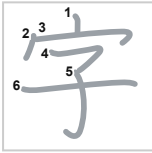
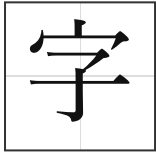
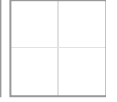
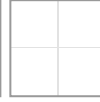
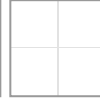
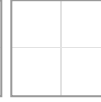
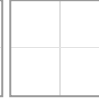
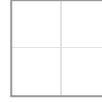
ON シン KUN ふか・い ぶか・い ふか・まる

Water 氵 beside a cave mouth 冫 with 儿 legs below it and 木 at the bottom: you reach down through the hole to touch the wood at the bottom, so the water is deep.

深い ふかい deep

深さ ふかさ depth

深夜 しんや late at night



character / letter

#263

G1

6 strokes

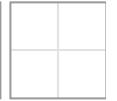
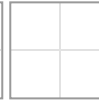
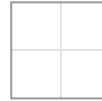
ON ジ KUN あざ あざな な

A child 子 under the roof 宀 of the house: the child sits indoors learning to write characters.

字 じ character; letter

漢字 かんじ kanji

文字 もじ letter; script



answer

#264

G2

12 strokes

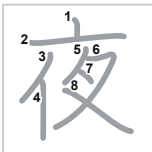
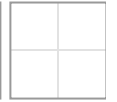
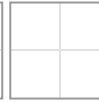
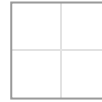
ON トウ KUN こた・える こた・え

Bamboo 竹 over 合 (人, 一 and 口 fitting together): the reply written on a bamboo slip that fits the question exactly.

答える こたえる to answer

答え こたえ answer

回答 かいとう reply; response



night

#265

G2

8 strokes

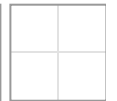
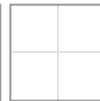
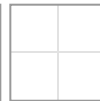
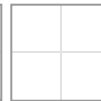
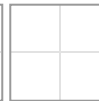
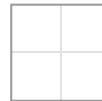
ON ヤ KUN よ よる

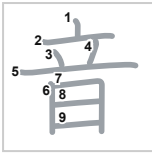
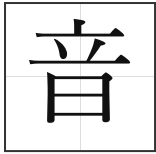
A lid 丷 for the sky, a person 亻 tucked under it, and 夕, the evening moon, on the right: a person standing out under the night sky.

夜 よる night

今夜 こんや tonight

夜中 よなか middle of the night





sound / noise

#266

G1

9 strokes

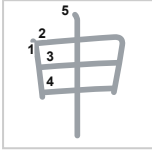
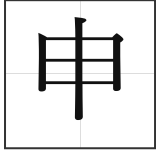
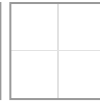
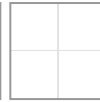
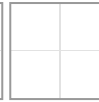
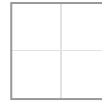
ON オン イン ノン KUN おと ね

The same 立 top as 言, but the mouth below is sealed shut into 日 with a bar across it: nothing articulate comes out, only sound.

音 おと sound

音楽 おんがく music

発音 はつおん pronunciation



report / state humbly

#267

G3

5 strokes

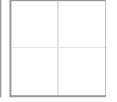
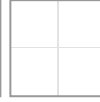
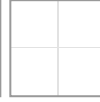
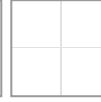
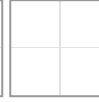
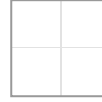
ON シン KUN もう・す もう・し さる

A box 日 with one line | driven straight through top to bottom: the message goes right through, spoken up plainly to those above.

申す もうす to say (humble)

申請 しんせい application (to authorities)

申し込む もうしこむ to apply for



manner / Mr. Ms.

#268

G3

14 strokes

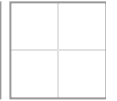
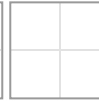
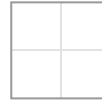
ON ヲウ ショウ KUN さま さん

Wood 木 on the left; on the right a sheep 羊 with its 𦍋 horns above flowing water 水: a pattern in the grain, and so a way or manner.

様子 ようす appearance; situation

皆様 みなさま everyone (polite)

お客様 おきゃくさま customer; guest



harbor / port

#269

G3

12 strokes

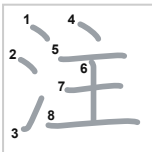
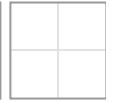
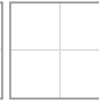
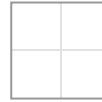
ON コウ KUN みなと

Water 氵 beside 巷, which is 共 (together, 八 under the top bars) over 己: the place by the water where everyone comes together.

港 みなと harbor; port

空港 こうこう airport

港町 みなとまち port town



pour / focus on

#270

G3

8 strokes

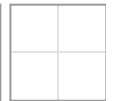
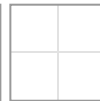
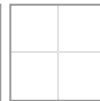
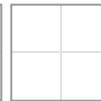
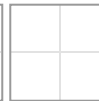
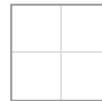
ON チュウ KUN そそ・ぐ さ・す つ・ぐ

Water 氵 next to 主, a lamp stand 王 with the flame 丶 on top: water poured steadily like oil kept in a burning lamp.

注意 ちゅうい caution; attention

注文 ちゅうもん order (for goods)

注ぐ そそぐ to pour



帰

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

return home

#271 G2 10 strokes

ON キ KUN かえ・る かえ・す おく・る

On the right a broom 帚 — the hand 𠄎 over 冂 over the cloth 巾 — held beside the short left post: you come back home and take up the broom.

帰る かえる to go home; to return

帰り かえり the way back

帰化 きか naturalization



谷

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

valley

#272 G2 7 strokes

ON コク KUN たに きわ・まる

A mouth 口 at the bottom with two pairs of strokes playing open above it: the slopes part and the valley opens its mouth.

谷 たに valley

谷間 たにま ravine; gorge

溪谷 けいこく gorge; canyon



古

1 2 3 4 5

old

#273 G2 5 strokes

ON コ KUN ふる・い ふる ふる・す

Ten 十 over a mouth 口: a story that has passed through ten mouths is an old one.

古い ふるい old (of things)

中古 ちゅうこ used; secondhand

古着 ふるぎ secondhand clothes



天

1 2 3 4

heaven / sky

#274 G1 4 strokes

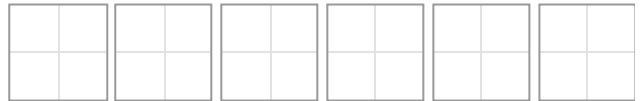
ON テン KUN あまつ あめ あま

A big person 大 with one long line — drawn above his head: what is over everybody, the sky.

天気 てんき weather

天皇 てんのう the Emperor

天国 てんごく heaven; paradise



階

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12

floor / stair

#275 G3 12 strokes

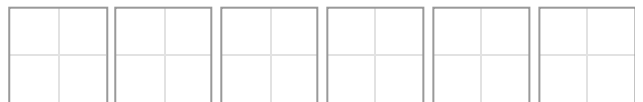
ON カイ KUN きざはし

The hill 阝 on the left is a bank cut into steps; 皆 on the right is 比 (people side by side) over 白 — everyone climbing the steps together, one floor at a time.

階段 かいだん stairs

階 かい floor; story

二階 にかい second floor



歌

1 3 5 11
2 4 12
6 8 10 13
7 9 14

song / sing

#276 G2 14 strokes

ON カ KUN うた うた・う

哥 on the left is 可 stacked twice, the same phrase called out again and again; 欠 on the right is a person with the mouth wide open.

歌 うた song

歌う うたう to sing

歌手 かしゅ singer

買

1 2 4
3 5 7
6 8 9
10 11 12

buy

#277 G2 12 strokes

ON バイ KUN か・う

A net 罟 laid over a shell of money 貝 (目 with 八 legs): you take your money out and net the goods with it.

買う かう to buy

買い物 かいもの shopping

売買 ばいばい buying and selling

光

1 2 3
4 5 6

light / ray

#278 G2 6 strokes

ON コウ KUN ひか・る ひかり

㚒 on top is a small fire held up, 兀 below is 一 over 儿, a person's legs: someone kneeling with a torch raised over their head.

光 ひかり light

光る ひかる to shine

観光 かんこう sightseeing

路

1 2 8 9
3 4 10
5 6 11
7 12 13

road / route

#279 G3 13 strokes

ON ロ ル KUN じ みち

The foot 足 on the left and 各 on the right, itself a foot 夊 coming down onto 口: each foot that sets out takes the road.

道路 どうろ road; street

線路 せんろ railway track

通路 つうろ aisle; passage

悪

1 3 5 6
2 4
7 8 9 10 11

bad / evil

#280 G3 11 strokes

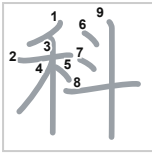
ON アク オ KUN わる・い わる あ・し

亜 on top is a squared foundation dug into the ground, 二 and 一 boxing in a 口; the heart 心 is pinned underneath it. A heart crushed flat turns bad.

悪い わるい bad

悪口 わるぐち bad-mouthing

最悪 さいあく the worst



department / course #281 G2

9 strokes

ON カ KUN ー

Grain (禾) being measured out with a dipper (斗). You sort the harvest into measured lots, and sorting things into lots is what a department or a course of study does.

科学 かかく science

教科書 きょうかしょ textbook

科目 かもく subject; course



thin / fine #282 G2 11 strokes

ON サイ KUN ほそ・い ほそ・る こま・か

Thread (糸) beside a rice field (田). Seen from far away the field is a grid of hair-thin lines, so 細 means thin, fine, minutely detailed.

細かい こまかい fine; detailed; small

細い ほそい thin; narrow

詳細 しょうさい details

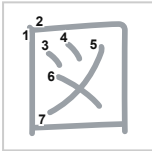
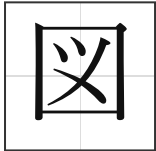
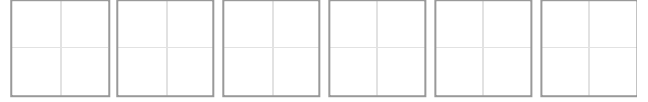


diagram / plan #283 G2 7 strokes

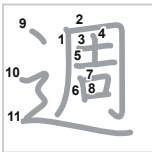
ON ズ ト KUN え はか・る

A border wall (口) with the sketched marks of a survey inside it. Draw the land inside its outline and you have a map, a diagram, a plan.

図 ず diagram; figure

地図 ちず map

図書館 としょかん library



week #284 G2 11 strokes

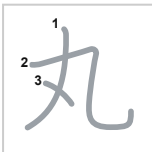
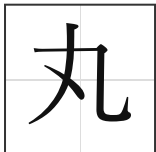
ON シュウ KUN ー

A full circuit (周) travelled on the road (い). You go all the way around and come back to the same day: that lap is a week.

週 しゅう week

今週 こんしゅう this week

来週 らいしゅう next week



round / circle #285 G2 3 strokes

ON ガン KUN まる まる・める まる・い

The nine (九) shape with a dot tucked into its curve: a person bent over into a ball. Three strokes that curl in on themselves, so the meaning is round.

丸 まる circle; a round mark

丸い まるい round

丸める まるめる to roll up; to crumple



他

1 4
2 3 5
他

other #286 G3 5 strokes

ON タ KUN ほか

A person (イ) standing next to 也. Not this person here, but that other one over there.

他 ほか other; besides

他人 たにん other people; a stranger

その他 そのた the rest; et cetera

室

1
2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9
室

room #287 G2 9 strokes

ON シツ KUN むろ

Under a roof (宀) sits 至, arrive. A room is the place inside the house where you finally arrive and stop.

教室 きょうしつ classroom

会議室 かいぎしつ meeting room

待合室 まちあいしつ waiting room

太

1 2 3 4
太

thick / fat #288 G2 4 strokes

ON タイ タ KUN ふと・い ふと・る

Big (大) with one extra dot added underneath. Big plus a little more is thick, stout, fat.

太い ふとい thick; fat

太る ふとる to gain weight

太陽 たいよう the sun

橋

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16
橋

bridge #289 G3 16 strokes

ON キョウ KUN はし

Wood (木) plus 喬, tall, which holds a big (大) figure up high. A tall wooden thing arching over the water is a bridge.

橋 はし bridge

歩道橋 ほどうきょう pedestrian bridge

石橋 いしばし stone bridge

歩

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8
歩

walk #290 G2 8 strokes

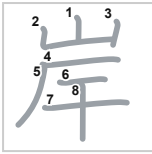
ON ホ フ KUN ある・く あゆ・む

A footprint (止) on top and a second foot below it. Left foot, then right foot: that is walking.

歩く あるく to walk

散歩 さんぽ a walk; a stroll

歩道 ほどう sidewalk



shore / bank

#291 G3 8 strokes

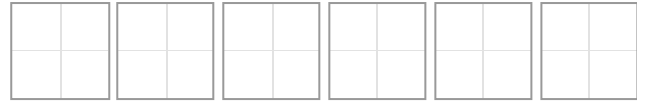
ON ガン KUN きし

A mountain (山) above a cliff (厩) with 干 beneath. Where the high rock breaks off and the water stops is the shore.

岸 きし shore; bank

海岸 かいがん coast; seashore

川岸 かわぎし riverbank



guest / customer

#292 G3 9 strokes

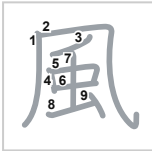
ON キャク カク KUN —

Under a roof (宀) sits 各, which is a foot (夊) coming down toward a mouth (口). Feet arrive at your door and you feed them: a guest.

客 きゃく guest; customer

お客さん おきゃくさん customer; guest (polite)

乗客 じょうきやく passenger



wind / style

#293 G2 9 strokes

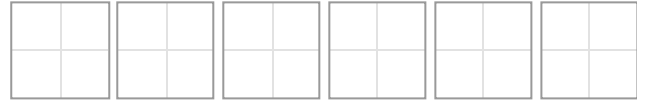
ON フウ フ KUN かぜ かざ

A sail-like frame (几) with an insect (虫) shut inside. The old belief was that wind was born from creatures stirring, so the bug sits in the middle of the gust.

風 かぜ wind

台風 たいふう typhoon

風邪 かぜ a cold (illness)



paper

#294 G2 10 strokes

ON シ KUN かみ

Thread (糸) beside the clan sign 氏. Paper is fiber pounded flat, a family of threads pressed into one sheet.

紙 かみ paper

手紙 てがみ letter

用紙 ようし form; blank sheet



climb / register

#295 G3 12 strokes

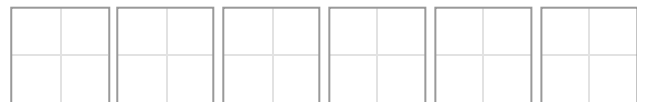
ON トウ ト ドウ KUN のぼ・る あ・がる

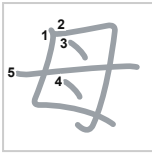
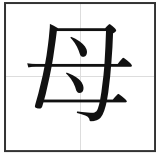
Two feet stepping outward (𠂔) above a raised stand (豆). You put one foot then the other on the platform and climb.

登る のぼる to climb

登録 とうろく registration

登山 とざん mountain climbing





mother #296 G2 5 strokes

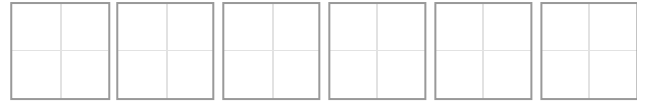
ON ボ KUN はは も

The 母 frame of a woman seated, with two dots added for the breasts that feed the child. Those two dots are what make her the mother.

母 はは mother (my own)

お母さん おかあさん mother (polite)

母親 ははおや mother



black #297 G2 11 strokes

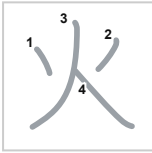
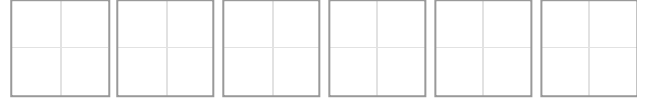
ON コク KUN くら くら・ずむ くら・い

A village grid (里, itself 日 over 土) sitting on the four dots of fire (火). Smoke rises through the flue and blackens everything above it.

黒 くら black

黒い くらい black (adjective)

黒板 こくばん blackboard



fire #298 G1 4 strokes

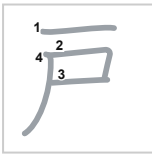
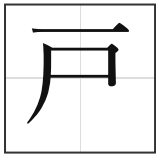
ON カ KUN ひ び ほ

A pure picture: a central flame with two sparks flying off to the sides. Draw the two short outer strokes first, then the tall body of the blaze.

火 ひ fire

火曜日 かようび Tuesday

花火 はなび fireworks



door #299 G2 4 strokes

ON コ KUN と

Half of the gate 門: one single leaf hanging on its hinge. Because one household has one door, it also counts houses.

戸 と door

戸籍 こせき family register

井戸 いど well



fast #300 G3 10 strokes

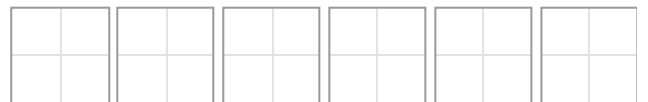
ON ソク KUN はや・い はや はや・める

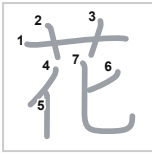
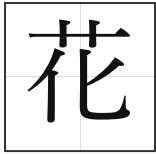
A tied bundle (束, wood 木 bound at the middle with 口) moving down the road (辵). Load is strapped tight so nothing spills, and you can go fast.

速い はやい fast (in speed)

速度 そくど speed

高速 こうそく high speed; expressway





flower #301 G1 7 strokes

ON カ ケ KUN はな

Grass (艹) over 化, change, which is a standing person (亻) beside a bent one (乚). The plant transforms, and the change it makes is a flower.

花 はな flower

花見 はなみ cherry-blossom viewing

花火 はなび fireworks



spring (season) #302 G2 9 strokes

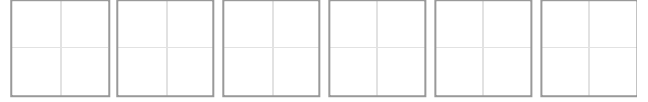
ON シュン KUN はる

Three shoots crowding up (𡗗, a 三 crossed by a big 大) with the sun (日) underneath. Plants pushing up over the warming sun is springtime.

春 はる spring

春休み はるやすみ spring vacation

青春 せいしゅん youth



center #303 G3 5 strokes

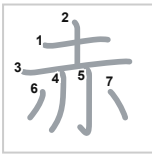
ON オウ KUN ー

A person (大) standing inside a frame with the vertical stroke (丨) running straight through the middle of them. Dead center.

中央 ちゅうおう center; middle

中央口 ちゅうおうぐち central exit

中央部 ちゅうおうぶ central part



red #304 G1 7 strokes

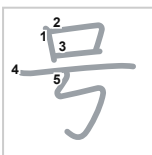
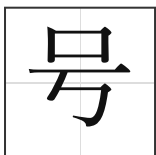
ON セキ シャク KUN あか あか・い あか・らむ

Originally a big person (大) standing over a fire; the brush flattened the top into 土 and splayed the flames below. A body lit red by the blaze.

赤 あか red

赤い あかい red (adjective)

赤ちゃん あかちゃん baby



number / title #305 G3 5 strokes

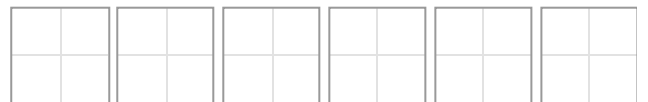
ON ゴウ KUN さけ・ぶ よびな

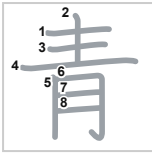
A mouth (口) on top with a breath forced out below it. Calling out loud, and what you call out is the name or the number.

号 ごう issue; number

番号 ばんごう number

信号 しんごう traffic light; signal





blue / green

#306 G1 8 strokes

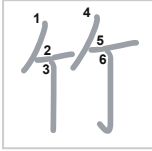
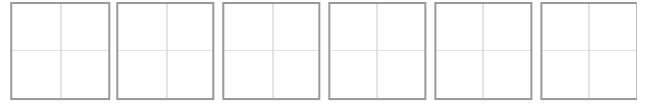
ON セイ ショウ KUN あお あお・い

A young sprout (𪔐) growing above 月. Fresh growth is the blue-green color, which is why 青 covers both blue and the green of a traffic light.

青 あお blue

青い あおい blue (adjective)

青空 あおぞら blue sky



bamboo

#307 G1 6 strokes

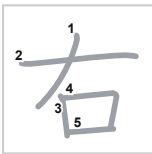
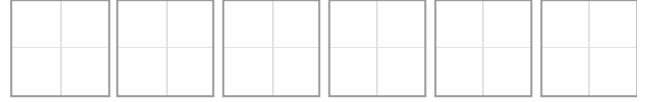
ON チク KUN たけ

Two bamboo stalks side by side, each with a short leaf drooping off the top. The same pair squashed flat becomes the 竹かんむり lid on other kanji.

竹 たけ bamboo

竹の子 たけのこ bamboo shoot

竹林 ちくりん bamboo grove



right (side)

#308 G1 5 strokes

ON ウ ユウ KUN みぎ

A hand (ナ) reaching down to a mouth (口). The hand you feed yourself with is the right hand. Note the first stroke sweeps left, unlike 左.

右 みぎ right

右手 みぎて right hand

右側 みぎがわ the right side



forest

#309 G1 12 strokes

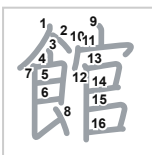
ON シン KUN もり

One tree (木) on top and a whole grove (林) beneath it. Three trees stacked up is more than woods, it is a forest.

森 もり forest; woods

森林 しんりん forest; woodland

森林公園 しんりんこうえん forest park



public building

#310 G3 16 strokes

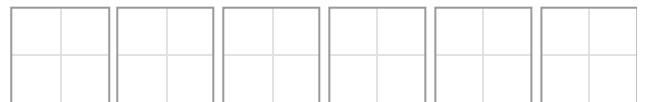
ON カン KUN やかた たて

Food (食) beside an official (官, a roof 宀 over a seal). The state building where guests are housed and fed: a hall, a museum, an embassy.

図書館 としょかん library

映画館 えいがかん cinema

大使館 たいしかん embassy





roof / shop

#311

G3

9 strokes

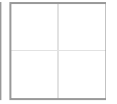
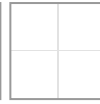
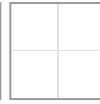
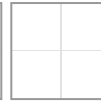
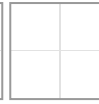
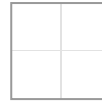
ON オク KUN や

A flat body of roof (戸) laid over 至, arrive. The place you come home to and lie down under, and by extension the shop that sells one thing.

部屋 ヘや room

屋根 やね roof

本屋 ほんや bookstore



read

#312

G2

14 strokes

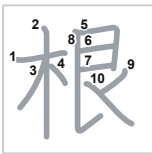
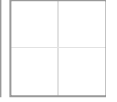
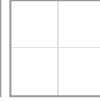
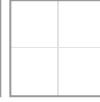
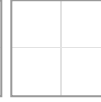
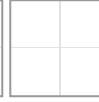
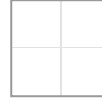
ON ドク トク トウ KUN よ・む よ・み

Words (言) next to 売, sell. The street seller reads his notice out loud to the crowd, so 読 is to read.

読む よむ to read

読書 どくしょ reading (books)

読み方 よみかた how to read it



root

#313

G3

10 strokes

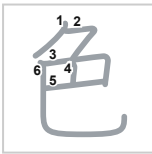
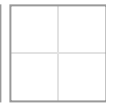
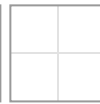
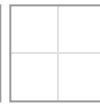
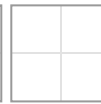
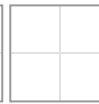
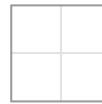
ON コン KUN ね

A tree (木) beside 艮, which means to stay put and not move. The part of the tree that never moves is the root.

根 ね root

大根 だいこん daikon radish

屋根 やね roof



color

#314

G2

6 strokes

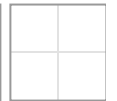
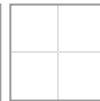
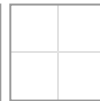
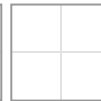
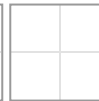
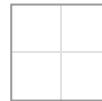
ON ショク シキ KUN いろ

A person bending over (ク) above the kneeling figure 巴. The old sense was the flush that rises in a face, and the color of the face became color itself.

色 いろ color

色々 いろいろ various

茶色 ちゃいろ brown



friend

#315

G2

4 strokes

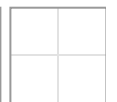
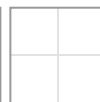
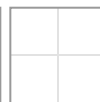
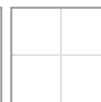
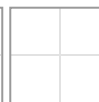
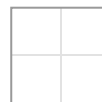
ON ヨウ KUN とも

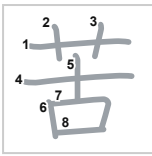
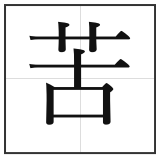
One hand (ナ) laid over another hand (又). Two hands reaching for each other, helping each other out: that is a friend.

友 とも friend

友達 ともだち friend

友人 ゆうじん friend (formal)





bitter / hard

#316 G3 8 strokes

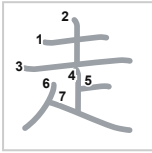
ON ク KUN くる・しい ぐる・しい くる・しむ

Grass (艹) over old (古, ten 十 mouths 口 telling the same story). Grass left to go old turns bitter, and bitter widens into hardship.

苦しい くるしい painful; hard to bear

苦い にがい bitter

苦手 にがて not good at



run

#317 G2 7 strokes

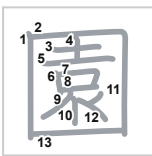
ON ソウ KUN はし・る

A swinging body on top (written like 土) above a foot (走) below. Arms up, legs pumping underneath: running.

走る はしる to run

競走 きょうそう a race

走行 そうこう travel; driving



garden / park

#318 G2 13 strokes

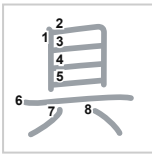
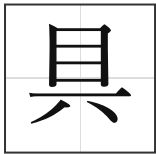
ON エン KUN その

A fence all the way around (口) enclosing 袁, a long robe of earth (土) and cloth (衣). Ground wrapped in a wall is a garden.

公園 こうえん park

動物園 どうぶつえん zoo

保育園 ほいくえん day care center



tool / ingredient

#319 G3 8 strokes

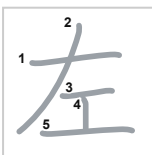
ON グ KUN そな・える つぶさ・に

An eye-like box (目, once a shell of money) held up by two hands (乚) at the bottom. Something you hold up in both hands to use: a tool.

道具 どうぐ tool

家具 かぐ furniture

具合 ぐあい condition; how one feels



left (side)

#320 G1 5 strokes

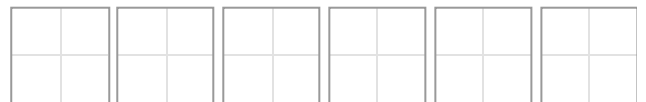
ON サ シャ KUN ひだり

A hand (ナ) holding a carpenter square (工). The hand that steadies the tool is the left one. Its first stroke runs down, where 右 sweeps across.

左 ひだり left

左手 ひだりて left hand

左側 ひだりがわ the left side



秋

秋

autumn #321 G2 9 strokes

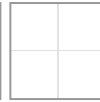
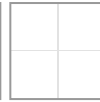
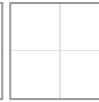
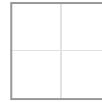
ON シュウ KUN あき とき

Grain (禾) standing next to fire (火). Autumn is when the grain is cut and the leftover stubble is burned off in the field.

秋 あき autumn

秋風 あきかぜ autumn breeze

秋晴れ あきばれ clear autumn weather



馬

馬

horse #322 G2 10 strokes

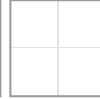
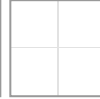
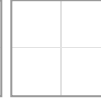
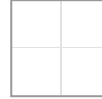
ON バ メ マ KUN うま ま

A picture of a horse turned on its side: the mane bristles along the top, the body follows, and the four dots of fire (火) at the bottom are its legs and tail.

馬 うま horse

競馬 けいば horse racing

乗馬 じょうば horseback riding



休

休

rest / day off #323 G1 6 strokes

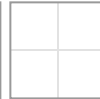
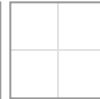
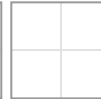
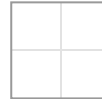
ON キュウ KUN やす・む やす・まる やす・める

A person (人) leaning against a tree (木). Stop walking, put your back on the trunk, and rest.

休む やすむ to rest; to take off

休み やすみ break; day off

休日 きゅうじつ holiday; day off



父

父

father #324 G2 4 strokes

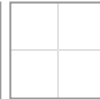
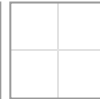
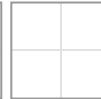
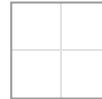
ON フ KUN ちち

A hand gripping a stone axe: two slanting strokes on top like the raised arms, and the crossed strokes below like the blade. Father is the one who swings it.

父 ちち (my) father

お父さん おとうさん father (polite)

父親 ちちおや father (as a parent)



林

林

grove / woods #325 G1 8 strokes

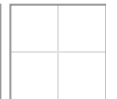
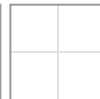
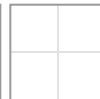
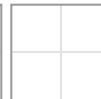
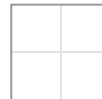
ON リン KUN はやし

Two trees (木) standing side by side. One tree is a tree; two is a grove.

林 はやし woods; grove

森林 しんりん forest

林業 りんぎょう forestry



夏

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

summer #326 G2 10 strokes

ON カ ガ ゲ KUN なつ

A head (自, with 一 across the top) above feet that drag slowly (女). Summer is walking home with a heavy head and slow feet in the heat.

夏 なつ summer

夏休み なつやすみ summer vacation

真夏 まなつ midsummer

鉄

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13

iron #327 G3 13 strokes

ON テツ KUN くろがね

Metal (金) beside 失 lose. Iron is the one metal a country cannot afford to lose. Write the gold radical, then 失 with its slanting top stroke.

鉄 てつ iron

鉄道 てつどう railway

地下鉄 ちかてつ subway

顔

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18

face #328 G2 18 strokes

ON ガン KUN かお

彦, a handsome man (立 standing over 尸 with 彡, three strokes of flowing hair), plus 眞, a head. The face is the good-looking side of the head.

顔 かお face

笑顔 えがお smile

顔色 かおいろ complexion; how one looks

王

1 2 3 4

king #329 G1 4 strokes

ON オウ ノウ KUN ー

Three horizontal lines - heaven, earth and the people between - joined by one vertical stroke. The king is the one who links all three.

王 おう king

王様 おうさま king (polite)

女王 じょおう queen

返

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

return / send back #330 G3 7 strokes

ON ヘン KUN かえ・す かえ・る

The road radical (辶) under 反, a hand (又) turning back beneath a cliff (厂). Turn around on the road and hand the thing back.

返す かえす to give back; return

返事 へんじ reply; answer

返信 へんしん reply (letter, mail)



short #331 G3 12 strokes

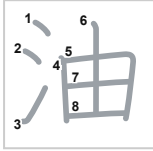
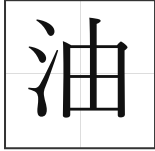
ON タン KUN みじか・い

An arrow (矢) beside a bean (豆). Short lengths were once measured with an arrow and small amounts with a bean - both stand for something short.

短い みじかい short

短期 たんき short term

短所 たんしょ weak point; fault



oil #332 G3 8 strokes

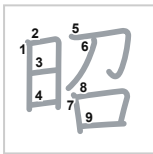
ON ユ ユウ KUN あぶら

Water (氵) beside 由, a jar with a spout coming out of the top. The liquid that pours from the jar is oil.

油 あぶら oil

石油 せきゆ petroleum

醤油 しょうゆ soy sauce



shining / bright #333 G3 9 strokes

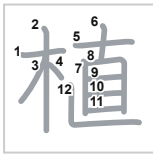
ON ショウ KUN —

The sun (日) beside 召, calling out - a knife (刀) over a mouth (口). Sunlight that calls out to you: bright, clear, shining.

昭和 しょうわ Showa era (1926-1989)

昭和の日 しょうわのひ Showa Day (April 29)

昭和時代 しょうわじだい the Showa period



plant (verb) #334 G3 12 strokes

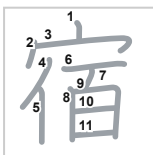
ON ショク KUN う・える う・わる

A tree (木) set straight (直, ten 十 eyes 目 looking straight down a line). To plant is to stand the tree up straight in the ground.

植える うえる to plant

植物 しょくぶつ plant; vegetation

植木 うえき garden plant; potted tree



inn / lodging #335 G3 11 strokes

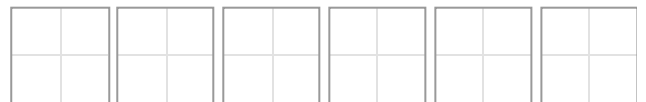
ON シュク KUN やど やど・る やど・す

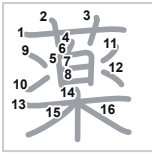
Under a roof (宀), a person (イ) and a hundred (百). A hundred travellers sleeping under one roof - an inn.

宿 やど inn; lodging

宿題 しゅくだい homework

宿泊 しゅくはく staying overnight





medicine #336 G3 16 strokes

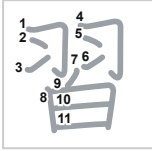
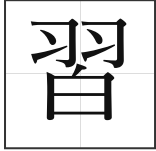
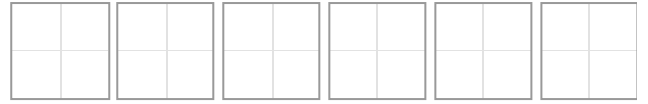
ON ヤク KUN くすり

Grass (艹) over 楽, comfort and music. The plant that makes you feel good again is medicine.

薬 くすり medicine

薬局 やっきょく pharmacy

目薬 めぐすり eye drops



learn #337 G3 11 strokes

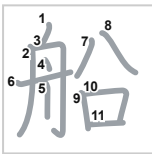
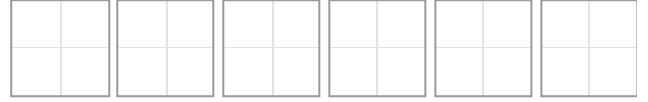
ON シュウ ジュ KUN なら・う なら・い

Wings (羽) over 白, white. A young bird flapping its pale wings again and again above the nest until it can fly - learning by repetition.

習う ならう to learn; take lessons

練習 れんしゅう practice

学習 がくしゅう study; learning



ship / boat #338 G2 11 strokes

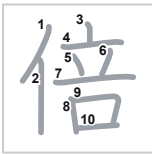
ON セン KUN ふね ふな

A boat (舟) beside 台, a gully where water runs down (八 over 口). A boat riding along the flowing water.

船 ふね ship; boat

船長 せんちょう ship's captain

風船 ふうせん balloon



double / times #339 G3 10 strokes

ON バイ KUN ー

A person (亻) beside 音, something standing (立) over a mouth (口) and splitting in two. One person split into two is twice as many.

倍 ばい double; twice

二倍 にばい twice; double

三倍 さんばい three times



station #340 G3 14 strokes

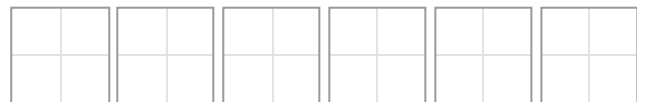
ON エキ KUN ー

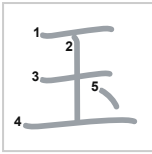
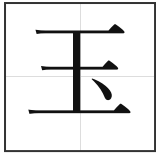
A horse (馬) beside 尺, a measure. Post stations stood a measured distance apart along the highway, and you changed horses at each one.

駅 えき station

駅前 えきまえ in front of the station

駅員 えきいん station attendant





ball / jewel

#341 G1 5 strokes

ON ギョク KUN たま だま

The king (王) with one extra dot - the jade bead he wears. Originally three discs of jade threaded on a string.

玉 たま ball; bead; jewel

玉子 たまご egg

目玉 めだま eyeball; main attraction



wave

#342 G3 8 strokes

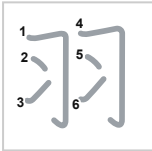
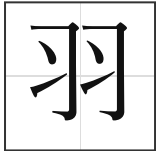
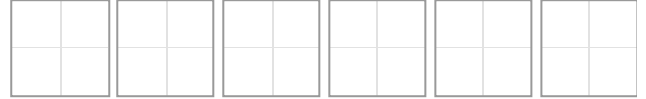
ON ハ KUN なみ

Water (氵) beside skin (皮). Waves are the skin of the sea, wrinkling in the wind.

波 なみ wave

津波 つなみ tsunami

電波 でんぱ radio signal



feather / wing

#343 G2 6 strokes

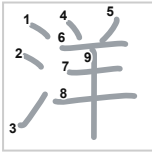
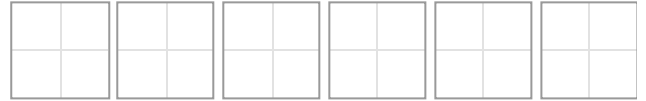
ON ウ KUN は わ はね

Two wings drawn side by side, each with the feather lines marked inside. Everything about the shape is doubled, because a bird has two.

羽 はね feather; wing

一羽 いちわ one bird

羽根 はね blade; feather



ocean / Western

#344 G3 9 strokes

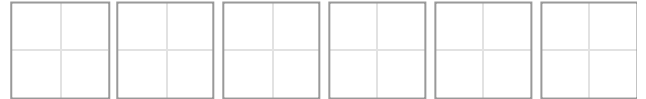
ON ヨウ KUN —

Water (氵) beside a sheep (羊). A sea so wide that sheep-herding lands lie on the far side of it - hence the ocean, and the West.

洋服 ようふく Western clothes

西洋 せいよう the West

太平洋 たいへいよう the Pacific Ocean



travel

#345 G3 10 strokes

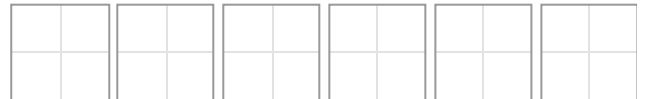
ON リョ KUN たび

A banner on its pole (方 with 辶 at the top) and people (亻) walking behind it. A group moving along under one flag is a journey.

旅 たび trip; journey

旅行 りょこう travel; a trip

旅館 りょかん Japanese inn





class / rank

#346 G3 9 strokes

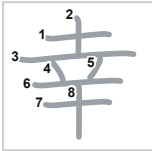
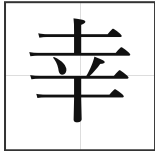
ON キュウ KUN —

Thread (糸) beside 及, a hand (又) reaching to catch the person ahead. Threads sorted by quality, one grade reaching up to the next.

級 きゅう grade; level

高級 こうきゅう high class; luxury

上級 じょうきゅう advanced level



happiness / fortune

#347 G3 8 strokes

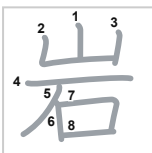
ON コウ KUN さいわ・い さち しあわ・せ

Earth (土) piled on top of 干. The old shape was a pair of handcuffs: to be spared them was the greatest luck, so the sign came to mean good fortune.

幸せ しあわせ happiness; happy

幸福 こうふく happiness; well-being

幸運 こううん good luck



rock / boulder

#348 G2 8 strokes

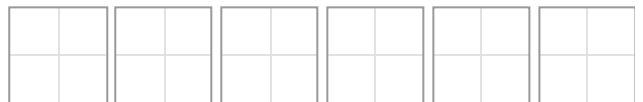
ON ガン KUN いわ

A mountain (山) sitting on a stone (石). A stone the size of a mountain is a boulder.

岩 いわ rock; boulder

岩石 がんせき rock (as material)

溶岩 ようがん lava



train / refine

#349 G3 14 strokes

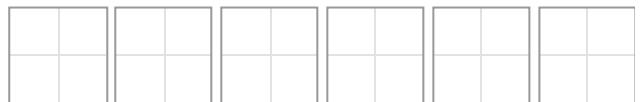
ON レン KUN ね・る ね・り

Thread (糸) beside 東, a bundle tied at both ends. Raw silk is boiled and worked over and over until it softens - that repetition is training.

練習 れんしゅう practice

訓練 くんれん drill; training

練る ねる to work out; knead



light (in weight)

#350 G3 12 strokes

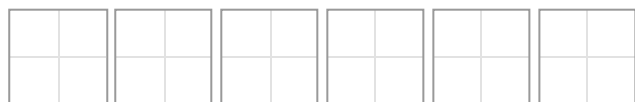
ON ケイ キョウ キン KUN かる・い かる・やか かる・んじる

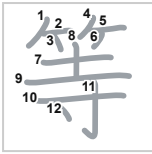
A cart (車) beside 圣, a hand (又) over earth (土), the straight warp threads of a loom. A cart built straight and plain is a light, quick one.

軽い かるい light; not heavy

気軽 きがる freely; without hesitation

手軽 てがる easy; simple





equal / class

#351 G3 12 strokes

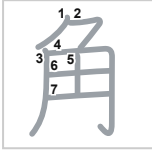
ON トウ KUN hito・shii など ら

Bamboo (竹) over a temple (寺). Bamboo strips at the temple were cut to exactly the same length, so the sign means equal, and then the grades things are sorted into.

等しい hitoshii equal

平等 biyōdō equality

一等 ittō first prize; first class



corner / horn

#352 G2 7 strokes

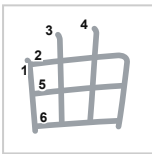
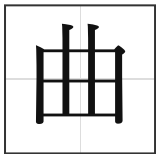
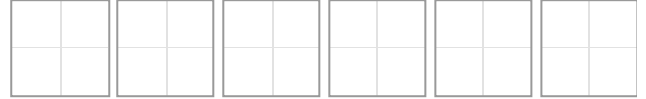
ON カク KUN kado つの

A picture of an animal's horn, with the ridges drawn as lines across the inside. A horn comes to a point, so the sign also means angle and corner.

角 kado corner

三角 sankaku triangle

四角 shikaku square



bend / tune

#353 G3 6 strokes

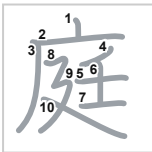
ON キョク KUN ma・garu ma・geru くま

A bamboo box seen from the side, bent out of shape; the strokes inside are the bends in the weave. From bending comes the melody, which bends up and down.

曲がる まがる to turn; to bend

曲 きょく tune; piece of music

作曲 さっきょく composing music



garden / yard

#354 G3 10 strokes

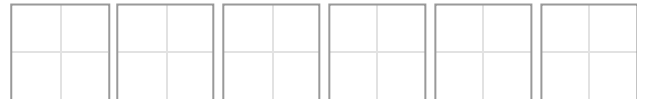
ON テイ KUN niwa

A roof (厂) over 廷, the court where officials stand. The open ground in front of the hall is the yard.

庭 niwa garden; yard

家庭 katei household; family

校庭 kōutei schoolyard



pond

#355 G2 6 strokes

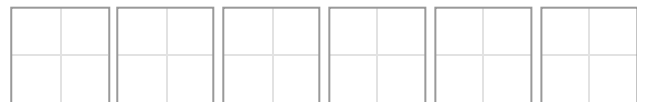
ON チ KUN ike

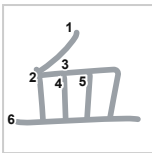
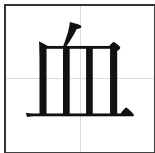
Water (氵) beside 也. Water that settles and stays instead of running away is a pond.

池 ike pond

電池 denchi battery

乾電池 kandenchi dry cell battery





blood #356 G3 6 strokes

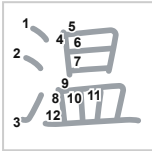
ON ケツ KUN ち

A dish (皿) with one short stroke above it - the drop of blood caught in the offering bowl.

血 ち blood

血液 けつえき blood

出血 しゅっけつ bleeding



warm #357 G3 12 strokes

ON オン KUN あたた・か あたた・かい あたた・まる

Water (氵) beside a sun (日) sitting over a dish (皿). A bowl of water left in the sun turns warm.

温かい あたたかい warm (to the touch)

温泉 おんせん hot spring

気温 きおん air temperature



star #358 G2 9 strokes

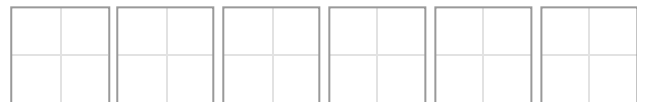
ON セイ ショウ KUN ほし ぼし

A sun (日) that is born (生) into the night sky. Stars are little suns.

星 ほし star

星空 ほしぞら starry sky

火星 かせい Mars



warehouse #359 G3 10 strokes

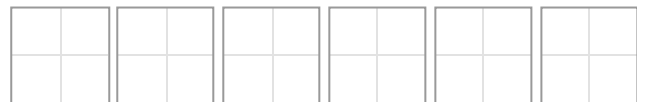
ON コ ク KUN くら

A cart (車) parked under a roof (广). The shed where the wagon is kept became the word for any storehouse.

冷蔵庫 れいぞうこ refrigerator

金庫 きんこ safe; vault

車庫 しゃこ garage



slope / hill #360 G3 7 strokes

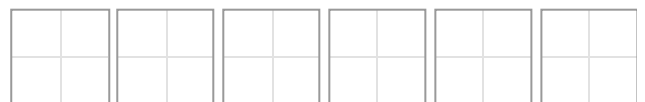
ON ハン KUN さか

Earth (土) beside 反, a hand (又) turning back under a cliff (厂). Ground that turns back on itself and rises is a slope.

坂 さか slope; hill

坂道 さかみち sloping road

上り坂 のぼりざか uphill slope





clothes / obey

#361

G3

8 strokes

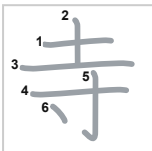
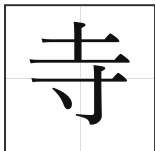
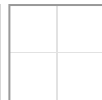
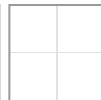
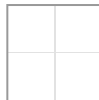
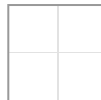
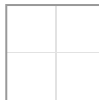
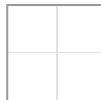
ON フク KUN —

The 月 on the left is the flesh-and-body radical; on the right a kneeling person 𠂔 has a hand 又 laid over them, pulling the garment on. Clothing goes onto a body, and the one who kneels obeys.

服 ふく clothes

洋服 ようふく Western clothes

制服 せいふく uniform



Buddhist temple

#362

G2

6 strokes

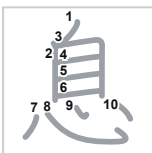
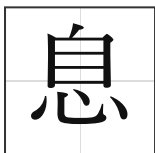
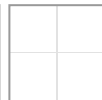
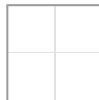
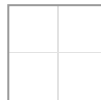
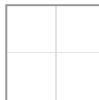
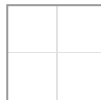
ON ジ KUN てら

Ground 土 on top and the measuring hand 寸 below: land carefully measured off and set aside. The plot that was marked out became the temple.

寺 てら temple

お寺 おてら temple (polite)

寺院 じいん Buddhist temple



breath / son

#363

G3

10 strokes

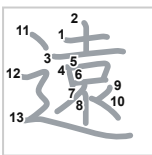
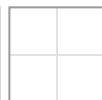
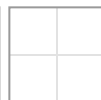
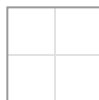
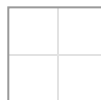
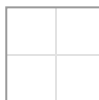
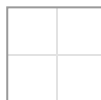
ON ソク KUN いき

自 was originally a drawing of a nose, and it sits right on top of the heart 心. Air from the nose down to the heart is breath.

息 いき breath

息子 むすこ son

ため息 ためいき sigh



distant / far

#364

G2

13 strokes

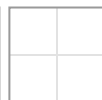
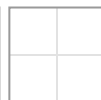
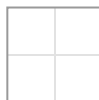
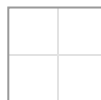
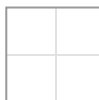
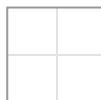
ON エン オン KUN とお・い

The road radical 辶 runs under 衰, a long robe: 衣 with 土 and a collar 口 packed inside it. You put on the long robe before setting out down a long road.

遠い とおい far

遠く とおく far away

遠足 えんそく field trip



picture / painting

#365

G2

12 strokes

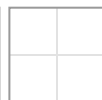
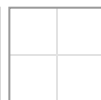
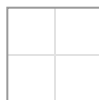
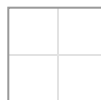
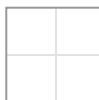
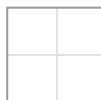
ON カイ エ KUN —

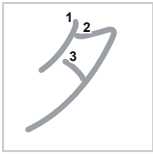
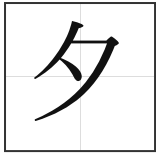
Thread 糸 on the left and 会, to meet, on the right. Colored threads meeting on one piece of cloth make a picture.

絵 え picture

絵本 えほん picture book

絵画 かいが painting





evening

#366

G1

3 strokes

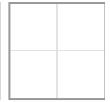
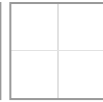
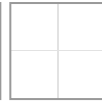
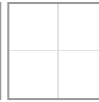
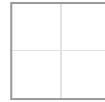
ON セキ KUN ゆう

The moon 月 with one stroke rubbed out — the moon only half showing, faint in the sky just as the light goes. That is evening.

夕方 ゆうがた early evening

夕食 ゆうしょく dinner

夕日 ゆうひ setting sun



board / plank

#367

G3

8 strokes

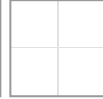
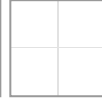
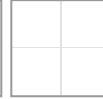
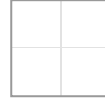
ON ハン バン KUN いた

Wood 木 beside 反, to turn over: a cliff 厂 with a hand 又 flipping something. Turn a log over flat and you have a plank.

板 いた board; plank

黒板 こくばん blackboard

看板 かんばん signboard



row / line

#368

G3

6 strokes

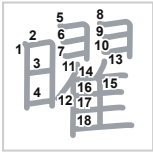
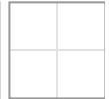
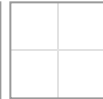
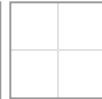
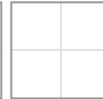
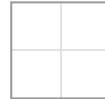
ON レツ レ KUN —

On the left 歹, bare bones — a stroke — over 夕 — and on the right the knife 刂. Bones cut apart and laid out side by side in a neat row.

列 れつ row; line

列車 れっしゃ train

行列 ぎょうれつ queue



day of the week

#369

G2

18 strokes

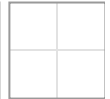
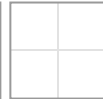
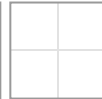
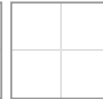
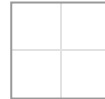
ON ヨウ KUN —

The sun 日 on the left, and on the right wings 羽 over a short-tailed bird 隹. The sun takes wing and flies past, one day after another, around the week.

曜日 ようび day of the week

日曜日 にちようび Sunday

月曜日 げつようび Monday



play

#370

G3

12 strokes

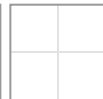
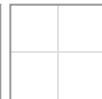
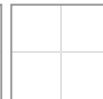
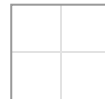
ON ヨウ ヌ KUN あそ・ぶ あそ・ばす

On the road 辶 goes 旂: a banner 方 with its streamer 夂 and a child 子 underneath. A child following the flag out of the house is going off to play.

遊ぶ あそぶ to play

遊び あそび play; fun

遊園地 ゆうえんち amusement park





you / ruler #371 G3 7 strokes

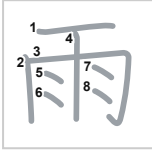
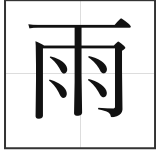
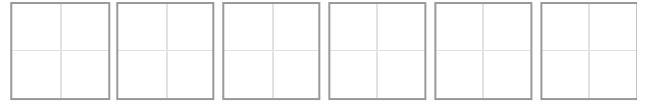
ON クン KUN きみ ぎみ

On top 尹, a hand 𠂔 gripping a staff of office, and under it a mouth 口 giving the order. The one who holds the staff and speaks is the ruler; the word softened into a familiar way of saying you.

君 きみ you (familiar)

君たち きみたち you (plural)

諸君 しょくん everyone; gentlemen



rain #372 G1 8 strokes

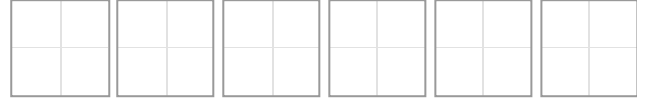
ON ウ KUN あめ あま さめ

The flat line on top is the sky, the box under it is the cloud, and the four dots inside are the drops coming down. Draw the sky, hang the cloud, then let the drops fall.

雨 あめ rain

大雨 おおあめ heavy rain

梅雨 つゆ rainy season



weak #373 G2 10 strokes

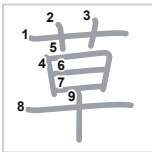
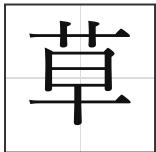
ON ジャク KUN よわ・い よわ・る よわ・まる

Two bows 弓 side by side, each with two little marks 丿 like feathers or cracks. A bow that has gone slack and decorative is no longer strong.

弱い よわい weak

弱る よわる to weaken

弱気 よわき timid; faint-hearted



grass / weeds #374 G1 9 strokes

ON ソウ KUN くさ ぐさ

The grass crown 艹 planted on top of 早, early — the sun 日 already over the ten 十. Grass is the thing that is up early everywhere.

草 くさ grass; weeds

草花 くさばな flowering plants

雑草 ざっそう weeds



drink #375 G3 12 strokes

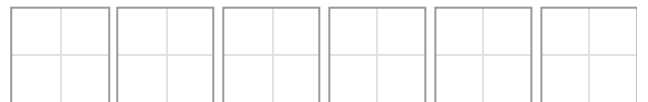
ON イン オン KUN の・む の・み

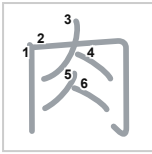
Food 食 on the left and 欠 on the right, a person with the mouth thrown wide open. Bring the food-jar to a gaping mouth and you are drinking.

飲む のむ to drink

飲み物 のみもの drink; beverage

飲み会 のみかい drinking party





meat / flesh

#376

G2

6 strokes

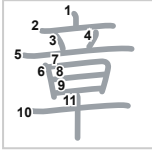
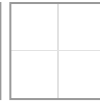
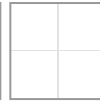
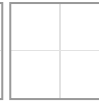
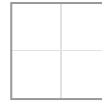
ON ニク KUN しし

A cut of meat drawn from the side: the outer frame is the slab and the two bent strokes inside are the grain and sinew running through it.

肉 にく meat

牛肉 ぎゅうにく beef

豚肉 ぶたにく pork



chapter / badge

#377

G3

11 strokes

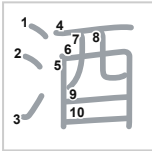
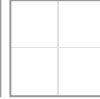
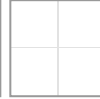
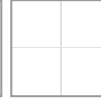
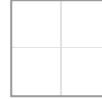
ON ショウ KUN ー

音, sound, with a stroke 十 ruled underneath it: the place where a piece of music or writing is cut into parts. A chapter, and by extension the badge that marks a rank.

文章 ぶんしょう writing; sentence

章 しょう chapter

憲章 けんしょう charter



sake / alcohol

#378

G3

10 strokes

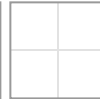
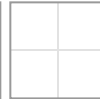
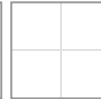
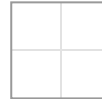
ON シュ KUN さけ さか

Water 氵 beside 酉, a picture of a narrow-necked jar with a lid and a line of liquid inside. Water kept in a fermenting jar is sake.

お酒 おさけ alcohol; sake

日本酒 にほんしゅ sake

居酒屋 いざかや izakaya; pub



sad / grieve

#379

G3

12 strokes

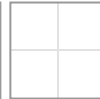
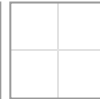
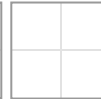
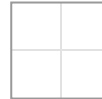
ON ヒ KUN かな・しい かな・しむ

非, two wings turning away from each other and meaning not, sits on top of the heart 心. A heart saying no to what has happened is a grieving heart.

悲しい かなしい sad

悲しむ かなしむ to grieve

悲鳴 ひめい scream



second (time)

#380

G3

9 strokes

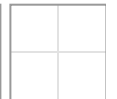
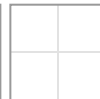
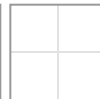
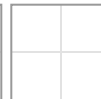
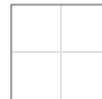
ON ビョウ KUN ー

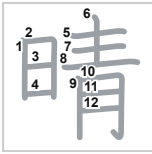
A grain plant 禾 next to 少, a small amount. The finest tip of an ear of grain stands for the smallest slice you can measure: one second.

秒 びょう second

数秒 すうびょう a few seconds

毎秒 まいびょう per second





clear up / fine #381 G2 12 strokes

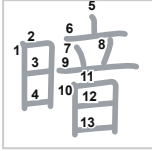
ON セイ KUN は・れる は・れ ば・れ

The sun 日 on the left and 青, blue — the plant sign 艹 over 月 — on the right. Sun plus blue sky is exactly what it means for the weather to clear.

晴れる はれる to clear up

晴れ はれ fine weather

晴天 せいてん fine weather



dark #382 G3 13 strokes

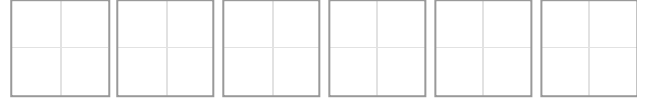
ON アン KUN くら・い くら・む くれ・る

The sun 日 next to 音, sound. When the sun is shut out and you have only sounds to go by, it is dark.

暗い くらい dark

暗記 あんき memorization

暗証番号 あんしょうばんごう PIN number



bird #383 G2 11 strokes

ON チョウ KUN とり

A whole bird seen from the side: the short slash on top is the head, the line under it the eye, the body strokes are the folded wing, and the four dots 丶 at the bottom are the tail feathers.

鳥 とり bird

小鳥 ことり small bird

焼き鳥 やきとり grilled chicken skewers



strive / exert #384 G3 10 strokes

ON ベン KUN つと・める

免, to be excused or get away, with strength 力 added under it. Throw your strength at the task so you can finally be let off: that is studying hard.

勉強 べんきょう study

勉強会 べんきょうかい study group

勤勉 きんべん diligent



sun / positive #385 G3 12 strokes

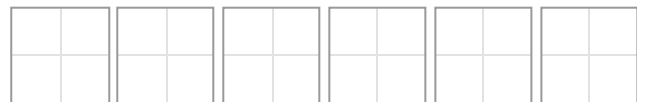
ON ヨウ KUN ひ

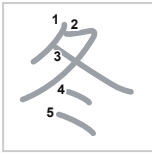
The hill 阝 on the left, and on the right 易: the sun 日 above the horizon line — with rays 勿 streaming down from it. The sunlit side of the hill.

太陽 たいよう the sun

陽気 ようき cheerful

夕陽 ゆうひ setting sun





winter #386 G2 5 strokes

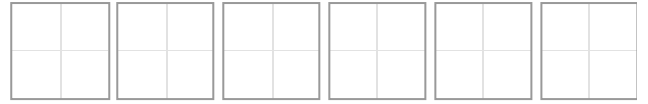
ON トウ KUN ふゆ

On top 夂, a pair of trailing feet marking the end of the year, and under it the two ice marks 冫. The year drags to a close and everything freezes.

冬 ふゆ winter

冬休み ふゆやすみ winter vacation

真冬 まふゆ midwinter



skin / hide #387 G3 5 strokes

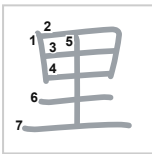
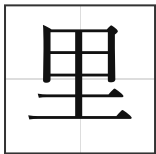
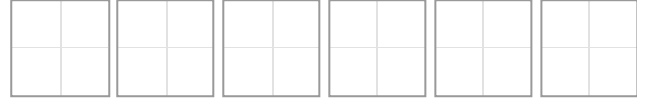
ON ヒ KUN かわ

A hand at the lower right is pulling downward on the covering above it. Someone stripping the hide off an animal in one motion.

皮 かわ skin; peel

皮膚 ひふ skin

毛皮 けがわ fur



village / home town #388 G2 7 strokes

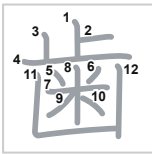
ON リ KUN さと

A field 田 resting on the earth 土. Where the fields are worked, people settle down — the village, and the home place you go back to.

里 さと village; parents' home

里帰り さとがえり visit to one's parents

里親 さとおや foster parent



tooth #389 G3 12 strokes

ON シ KUN よわい は よわい・する

止 sits on top just to lend the sound; underneath, the open mouth 凵 holds rows of teeth drawn as 米. Draw the mouth, then fill it with teeth.

歯 は tooth

歯医者 はいしゃ dentist

虫歯 むしば cavity



daytime / noon #390 G2 9 strokes

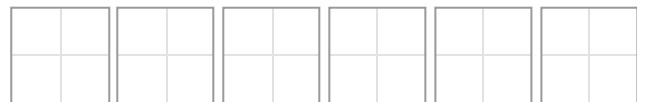
ON チュウ KUN ひる

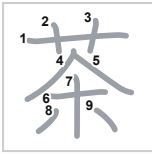
尺, a hand measuring a span, laid over 旦 — the sun 日 sitting on the horizon 一. Measuring off the stretch of the day the sun is up gives you midday.

昼 ひる noon; daytime

昼休み ひるやすみ lunch break

昼食 ちゅうしょく lunch





tea #391 G2 9 strokes

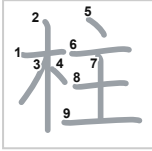
ON チャ サ KUN —

The grass crown 艸 over a person 人 standing under a tree 木. Leaves picked from the bush and carried home to be brewed: tea.

お茶 おちゃ tea

茶色 ちゃいろ brown

紅茶 こうちゃ black tea



pillar / post #392 G3 9 strokes

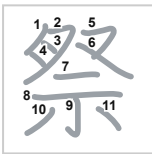
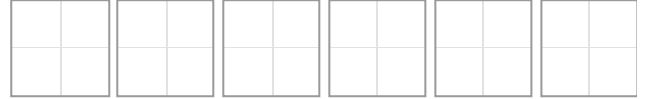
ON チュウ KUN はしら

Wood 木 beside 主, master — a lamp flame 火 above the stand 王. The piece of timber that is master of the house is the pillar holding it up.

柱 はしら pillar; post

電柱 でんちゅう utility pole

大黒柱 だいこくばしら breadwinner; main pillar



festival / rite #393 G3 11 strokes

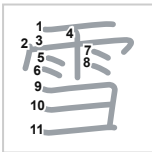
ON サイ KUN まつ・る まつ・り

A piece of meat 月 and a hand held above the altar 示. Meat set on the altar by hand is an offering, and the offering is the festival.

祭り まつり festival

祭る まつる to enshrine

夏祭り なつまつり summer festival



snow #394 G2 11 strokes

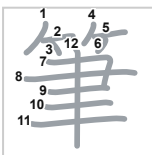
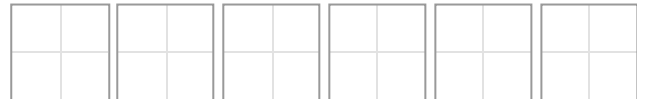
ON セツ KUN ゆき

Rain 雨 on top and the hand-with-a-broom 冫 underneath. Snow is the rain you have to sweep off the path.

雪 ゆき snow

大雪 おおゆき heavy snow

初雪 はつゆき first snow



writing brush #395 G3 12 strokes

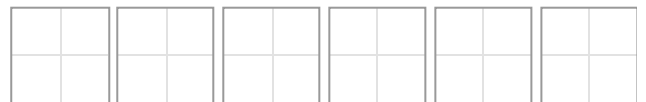
ON ヒツ KUN ふで

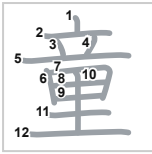
Bamboo 竹 on top and 聿 below: a hand 扌 gripping an upright shaft 丨. A hand holding a bamboo shaft is a writing brush.

筆 ふで writing brush

鉛筆 えんぴつ pencil

筆記 ひっき writing; note-taking





child #396 G3 12 strokes

ON ドウ KUN わらべ

立, a person standing, set on top of 里, the village. The small ones standing about in the village are the children.

児童 じどう children; pupils

童話 どうわ fairy tale

童謡 どうよう children's song



younger brother #397 G2 7 strokes

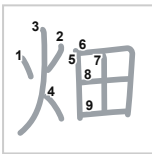
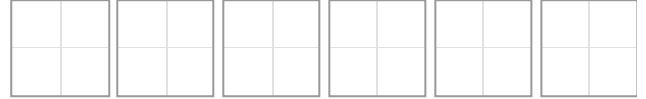
ON テイ ダイ デ KUN おとうと

A cord wound in order around a stake, the loops shown by 弓 and 丨 and the little tail 丿 at the end. Things wound in order gave the sense of the one who comes next: the younger brother.

弟 おとうと younger brother

兄弟 きょうだい siblings

弟子 でし pupil; apprentice



dry field / farm #398 G3 9 strokes

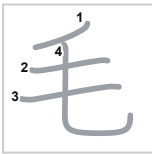
ON ー KUN はた はたけ ばたけ

Fire 火 beside a field 田. Land cleared by burning it off grows vegetables and wheat rather than rice. This character was made in Japan.

畑 はたけ field; farm plot

田畑 たはた fields and paddies

花畑 はなばたけ flower field



hair / fur #399 G2 4 strokes

ON モウ KUN け

Three strokes of a tuft, and the last one bends and curls up at the tip. That flick at the end is what makes it hair rather than a straight line.

毛 け hair; fur

毛布 もうふ blanket

髪の毛 かみのけ hair (on the head)



green #400 G3 14 strokes

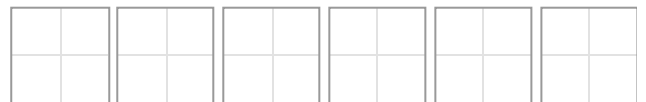
ON リョク ロク KUN みどり

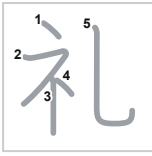
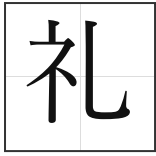
Thread 糸 beside 冪: a hand 𠂇 squeezing a plant so the juice 氷 runs out below. The dye pressed out of leaves colors the thread green.

緑 みどり green; greenery

緑色 みどりいろ green (color)

緑茶 りょくちゃ green tea





bow / thanks

#401 G3 5 strokes

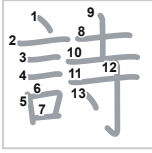
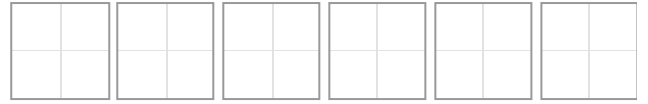
ON レイ ライ KUN —

The altar radical 礻 on the left, and on the right 乙, a figure bent over at the waist. Bowing before the altar is what courtesy and thanks look like.

礼 れい thanks; a bow

お礼 おれい thanks; a thank-you gift

失礼 失れい rudeness; excuse me



poem

#402 G3 13 strokes

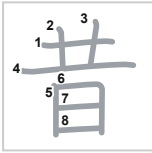
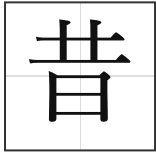
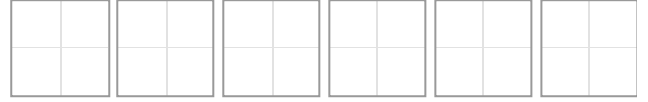
ON シ KUN うた

Words 言 on the left, temple 寺 on the right — earth 土 sitting above a hand 寸. Words measured out and chanted at a temple: a poem.

詩 し poem; poetry

詩人 しじん poet

詩集 ししゅう poetry collection



long ago

#403 G3 8 strokes

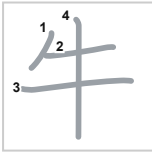
ON セキ シャク KUN むかし

A sun 日 at the bottom with strokes piled on top of it — 艹 crossed by 十. Day stacked on day on day until they add up to the distant past.

昔 むかし long ago; the past

昔話 むかしばなし folk tale; old story

大昔 おおむかし ancient times



COW

#404 G2 4 strokes

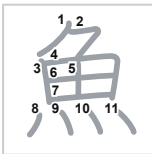
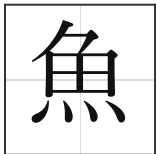
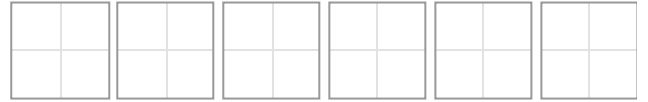
ON ギュウ KUN うし

A cow seen head-on: one horn slanting off to the left, the other horn as the crossbar, and the body running straight down. It is 午 with the top stroke pushed to the side.

牛 うし cow; cattle

牛乳 ギュウにゅう milk

牛肉 ギュウにく beef



fish

#405 G2 11 strokes

ON ギョ KUN うお さかな ざかな

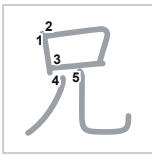
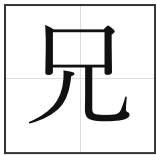
The head is the 夕 on top, the scaly body is the 田 in the middle, and the tail fins spread out as the four dots 丶 at the bottom.

魚 さかな fish

焼き魚 やきざかな grilled fish

金魚 きんぎょ goldfish





older brother

#406 G2 5 strokes

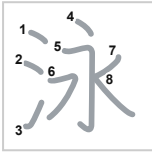
ON ケイ キョウ KUN あに

A mouth 口 sitting on top of a pair of legs 儿. The one in the family who stands up and does the talking is your big brother.

兄 あに older brother

お兄さん おにいさん older brother (polite)

兄弟 きょうだい siblings; brothers



swim

#407 G3 8 strokes

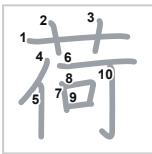
ON エイ KUN およ・ぐ

Water 氵 beside 永 'long', which is itself water 水 with an extra drop added on top. Moving a long way through the water is swimming.

泳ぐ およぐ to swim

水泳 すいえい swimming

泳ぎ およぎ swimming; a swim



load / luggage

#408 G3 10 strokes

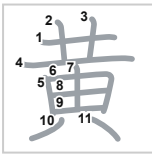
ON カ KUN に

Grass 艹 laid over 何 'what' — a person 人 next to 可. What is that person carrying on their back? A load.

荷物 にもつ luggage; package

手荷物 てにもつ hand luggage

荷 に load; cargo



yellow

#409 G2 11 strokes

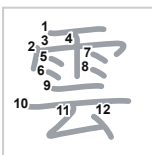
ON コウ オウ KUN き こ

艹 across the top, a stalk in a field 由 through the middle, and 人 spread out below like two legs. Stand it up and picture a farmer in ripe, yellow grain.

黄色 きいろ yellow

黄色い きいろい yellow (adjective)

黄身 きみ egg yolk



cloud

#410 G2 12 strokes

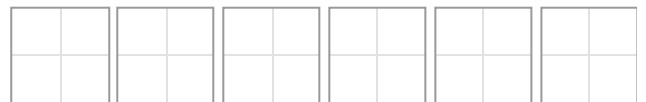
ON ウン KUN くも ぐも

Rain 雨 on top of 云 — a 二 with 厶 tucked under it, the old drawing of vapor curling upward. The cloud is what the rain sits inside.

雲 くも cloud

雨雲 あまぐも rain cloud

入道雲 にゅうどうぐも thunderhead





cry / ring

#411

G2

14 strokes

ON メイ KUN な・く な・る な・らす

A mouth 口 beside a bird 鳥, whose tail feathers are the four dots 丶, underneath. A bird opening its mouth: it sings, and anything else that sounds off.

鳴る なる to ring; to sound

鳴く なく to chirp; to cry (animal)

鳴らす ならす to ring (something)



arrow

#412

G2

5 strokes

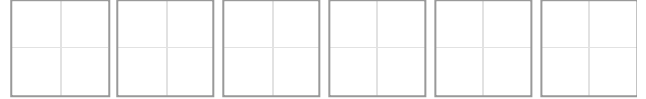
ON シ KUN や

Almost 大, but with a short stroke laid across the top: that is the notch and the feathers, and the long stroke down the middle is the shaft.

矢 や arrow

矢印 やじるし arrow (symbol)

弓矢 ゆみや bow and arrow



charcoal / coal

#413

G3

9 strokes

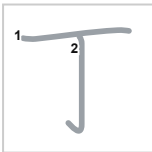
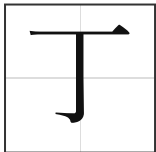
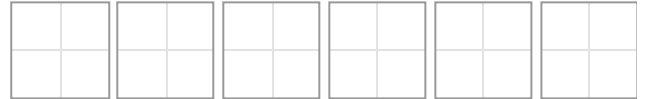
ON タン KUN すみ

A mountain 山 sitting on top of ash 灰 — a cliff 厂 with fire 火 burning under it. Fire under the hillside leaves charcoal behind.

炭 すみ charcoal

石炭 せきたん coal

炭火 すみび charcoal fire



block / ward

#414

G3

2 strokes

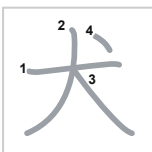
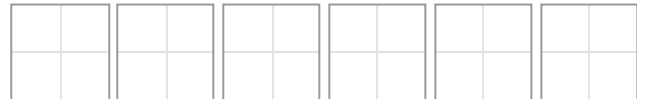
ON チョウ テイ チン KUN ひのと

A single line 一 with a hook 丿 dropping from the middle: a nail seen from the side. Towns are nailed down into numbered blocks.

丁目 ちょうめ city block (in an address)

丁寧 ていねい polite; careful

包丁 ほうちょう kitchen knife



dog

#415

G1

4 strokes

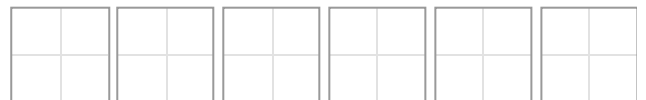
ON ケン KUN いぬ

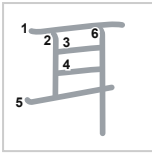
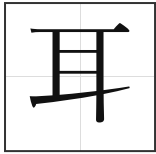
A big 大 with a dot added at the shoulder — the ear flicked up, or the tag on its collar. That one dot is all that separates a dog from 大.

犬 いぬ dog

子犬 こいぬ puppy

番犬 ばんけん guard dog





ear #416 G1 6 strokes

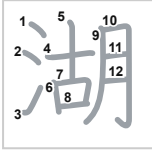
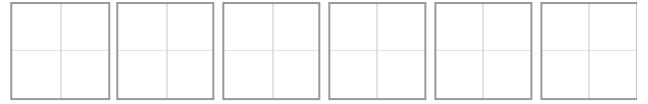
ON ジ KUN みみ

A picture of an ear: the long stroke down the right is the outer rim, and the crossbars inside are the folds of cartilage.

耳 みみ ear

耳鼻科 じびか ENT clinic

初耳 はつみみ news to me



lake #417 G3 12 strokes

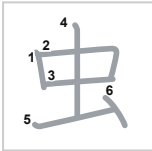
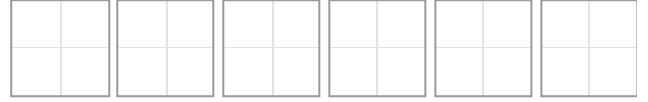
ON コ KUN みずうみ

Water 氵 beside 胡 — old 古, a ten 十 over a mouth 口, standing next to a moon 月. Old water lying still enough to hold the moon.

湖 みずうみ lake

湖畔 こはん lakeside

湖水 こすい lake water



insect #418 G1 6 strokes

ON チュウ キ KUN むし

It began as a coiled snake. Now write 中 and add the short stroke on the right: a small creature curled around a center point.

虫 むし insect; bug

虫歯 むしば cavity; tooth decay

昆虫 こんちゅう insect (formal)



hot water #419 G3 12 strokes

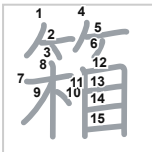
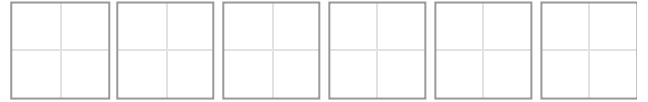
ON トウ KUN ゆ

Water 氵 beside 湯: the sun 日 rising above the horizon line — with its rays 勿 streaming down. Sun-heated water is hot water.

湯 ゆ hot water

お湯 おゆ hot water (polite)

湯気 ゆげ steam



box #420 G3 15 strokes

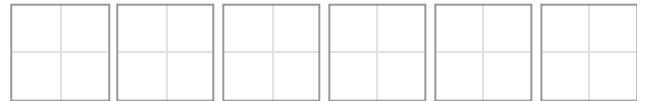
ON ソウ KUN はこ

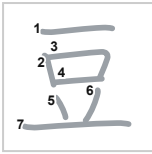
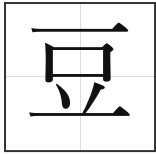
Bamboo 竹 over 相 — a tree 木 beside an eye 目. Bamboo strips woven into a chest, and an eye kept on what is inside it.

箱 はこ box

ゴミ箱 ごみばこ trash can

本箱 ほんばこ bookcase





bean

#421

G3

7 strokes

ON トウ ズ KUN まめ

Originally a footed serving dish: a lid across the top, the bowl drawn as a mouth 口, and the stand underneath. What was served in it — beans — took over the character.

豆 まめ bean

大豆 だいず soybean

納豆 なっとう natto



hot (weather)

#422

G3

12 strokes

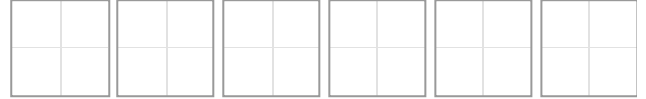
ON ショ KUN あつ・い

The sun 日 sitting right on top of 者 'person' — the 𠂔 top over earth 土. The sun beating down on someone out in the open: summer heat.

暑い あつい hot (weather)

暑さ あつさ the heat

蒸し暑い むしあつい humid and hot



younger sister

#423

G2

8 strokes

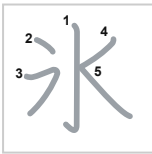
ON マイ KUN いもうと

A woman 女 beside 未 'not yet' — a tree 木 whose top branch is still short and unfinished. The girl in the family who has not yet grown up.

妹 いもうと younger sister

妹さん いもうとさん your younger sister

姉妹 しまい sisters



ice

#424

G3

5 strokes

ON ヒョウ KUN こおり ひ こお・る

Water 水 with one extra stroke added at the top left — a crack, or a splinter, frozen into the surface.

氷 こおり ice

かき氷 かきごおり shaved ice

氷水 こおりみず ice water



cold

#425

G3

12 strokes

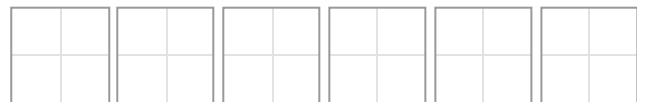
ON カン KUN さむ・い

Under a roof 宀 someone has stuffed straw for insulation — the 冫 crossed by strokes with 八 below — and two ice marks 冫 sit at the very bottom. Ice indoors: freezing.

寒い さむい cold

寒さ さむさ the cold

寒気 さむけ chills; the shivers





notebook / ledger

#426

G3

11 strokes

ON チョウ KUN とばり

A cloth 巾 that is long 長. First a long hanging curtain, then the long folded cloth you keep your accounts on.

手帳 てちょう pocket notebook

通帳 つうちょう bankbook

記帳 きちょう making an entry; updating a passb...



older sister

#427

G2

8 strokes

ON シ KUN あね はは

A woman 女 beside a market 市 — a lid 丷 over a cloth 巾. The older girl is the one trusted to go to the market.

姉 あね older sister

お姉さん おねえさん older sister (polite)

姉妹 しまい sisters



pick up

#428

G3

9 strokes

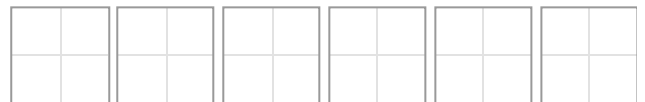
ON シュウ ジュウ KUN ひろ・う

A hand 扌 beside 合 'to fit together' — a lid 人 over — over a mouth 口. Your hand closes over something on the ground and lifts it.

拾う ひろう to pick up

拾い物 ひろいもの a find; lucky find

収拾 しゅうしゅう bringing under control



China / Han

#429

G3

13 strokes

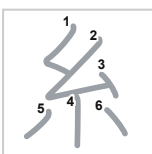
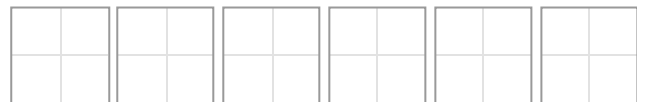
ON カン KUN —

Water 氵 on the left for the Han river; on the right grass 艹 over a mouth 口 over a man 夫. From that river came the name of the Han people and their writing.

漢字 かんじ kanji

漢方 かんぼう Chinese herbal medicine

漢語 かんご Sino-Japanese vocabulary



thread

#430

G1

6 strokes

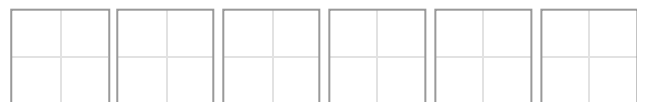
ON シ KUN いと

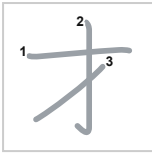
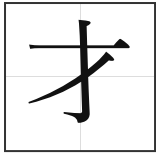
A skein of silk: the little loops twisted at the top, and the loose ends hanging down as the three short strokes below.

糸 いと thread

毛糸 けいと wool yarn

糸口 いとぐち clue; opening





talent / years old

#431 G2 3 strokes

ON サイ KUN —

Almost the hand radical 扌, but the hook ㇿ cuts straight through the crossbar: a sprout pushing up out of the ground. Ability that was there from the start.

才能 さいのう talent

天才 てんさい genius

才 さい years old



wheat / barley

#432 G2 7 strokes

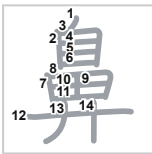
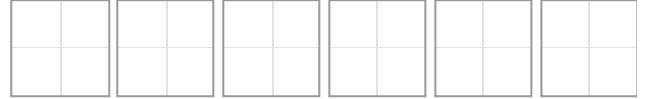
ON バク KUN むぎ

𥝵 on top — the ear of grain, three strokes crossed by a vertical — and a foot 夊 stepping below. Winter wheat is the crop you walk out and tread down.

麦 むぎ wheat; barley

小麦 こむぎ wheat

麦茶 むぎちゃ barley tea



nose

#433 G3 14 strokes

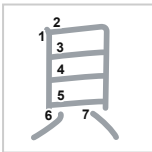
ON ビ KUN はな

自 on top was itself the original drawing of a nose. Once 自 was taken over to mean 'self', a base was built under it: a field 田 on a stand 升.

鼻 はな nose

鼻水 はなみず runny nose

鼻血 はなぢ nosebleed



shellfish / shell

#434 G1 7 strokes

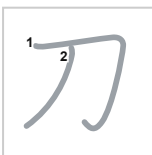
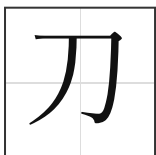
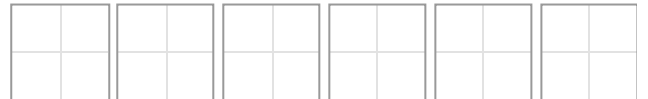
ON バイ KUN かい

An eye 目 standing on two legs 八 — really a cowrie shell, its slit down the middle and its feelers trailing below. Shells were money, which is why 貝 hides inside 賈 and 貨.

貝 かい shellfish; shell

貝殻 かいがら seashell

巻貝 まきがい spiral shell; snail



sword

#435 G2 2 strokes

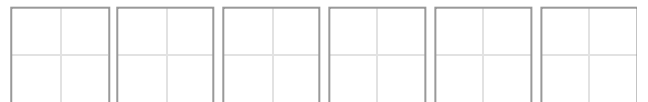
ON トウ KUN かたな そり

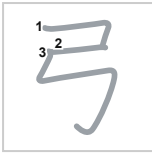
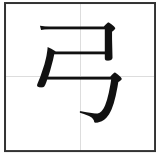
Two strokes only: the curved back of the blade, and the handle hooking down from it. Squeeze the same shape thin and it becomes the 刂 on the right of 切 and 別.

刀 かたな sword

日本刀 にほんとう Japanese sword

小刀 こがたな small knife





bow (archery)

#436

G2

3 strokes

ON キュウ KUN ゆみ

The curve of a bow seen from the side, drawn in three strokes. The string is left off so you can see the wood bending.

弓 ゆみ bow (weapon)

弓道 きゅうどう Japanese archery

弓矢 ゆみや bow and arrow

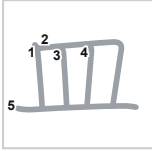
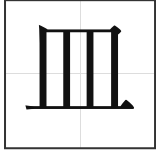
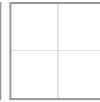
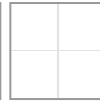
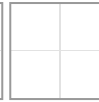
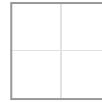


plate / dish

#437

G3

5 strokes

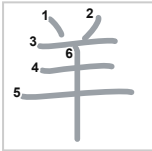
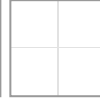
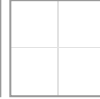
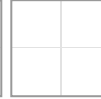
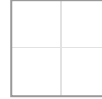
ON ベイ KUN さら

A dish seen from the side: the flat rim across the top, the two walls coming down, and the base line closing it underneath.

皿 さら plate; dish

お皿 おさら plate (polite)

小皿 こさら small plate



sheep

#438

G3

6 strokes

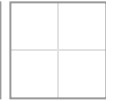
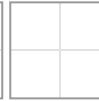
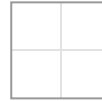
ON ヨウ KUN ひつじ

Two horns 𠂇 curling outward at the top, then the body: three crossbars strung on a spine. A sheep seen head-on.

羊 ひつじ sheep

羊毛 ようもう wool

子羊 こひつじ lamb



flute / whistle

#439

G3

11 strokes

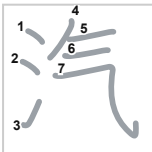
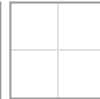
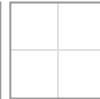
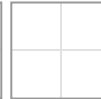
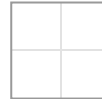
ON テキ KUN ふえ

Bamboo 竹 over 由: a length of bamboo with a hole bored through it. That hole is the whole reason it makes a sound.

笛 ふえ flute; whistle

口笛 くちふえ whistling

警笛 けいてき horn; warning whistle



steam

#440

G2

7 strokes

ON キ KUN ー

Water 氵 next to 气, breath rising in three trailing strokes under its 冫 top. Water turned into breath: steam.

汽車 きしゃ steam train

汽船 きせん steamship

汽笛 きてき steam whistle

